NATURAL HEALTH MINISTRIES

Module 3
Level 1

Guidebook for NHMEC Students
SECULAR



THE HERBALIST'S PATH:

A COMPLETE GUIDE TO MASTERING HERBAL KNOWLEDGE

Instructor
Penny Lane Whittemore CNC BCNWP CHGp RHCH

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THE HERBALIST'S PATH:

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Book Overview

This book serves as a guide for students of the NHMEC to become a Holistic Christian Herbalist from a Christian viewpoint. It does not intend to prescribe, diagnose, or offer medical treatment. Instead, its goal is to educate readers on utilizing natural resources like herbs, fields, and trees for promoting good health. While herbs do not cure ailments, they do support our bodies and assist in the natural healing process. Ultimately, God is seen as the ultimate healer in this context. The book is designed for educational purposes and is presented from a Christian standpoint.

The author, with over 30 years of experience across various modalities and training, incorporates all her knowledge into her teachings. Her extensive involvement in resources, ministries, companies, books, and classes is reflected in her instructional content.

Holistic Christian Herbalists



Biblically Based

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This course covers herbalism from a Christian perspective. The author, Penny Lane Whittemore CNC. BCNWP, CHGp, RHCH is a certified nutritional consultant and a member of various organizations, including the American Association of Nutritional Consultants, Herbalists without Borders, and the Natural Health Ministries Education Center.

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COURSE OUTLINE

DIRECTIONS

MODULES

- MODULE 1 - WELCOME & OREINTATION
- MODULE 2 - CHRISTIAN HERBALIST
- MODULE 3 - THE HERBALIST'S PATH
- MODULE 4 - HOLISTIC NUTRITION
- MODULE 5 - BIBLICAL NUTRITION & WELLNESS
- MODULE 6 - NATURAL HEALTH
- MODULE 7 - BIBLICAL FAITH & HEALTH CONNECTION

Each module is rich in content and will include its own guidebook. However, please ensure that you complete the course through CANVAS CLASSROOM, as not all information can be contained within this guidebook.
Just know that any future updates, corrections, or additions may not be included in the Guidebook.

DIRECTIONS

Please adhere to the Guidebook, as it contains the assignments, questions, and activities. Remember to:

1. Upon purchase of the Program of Study (Course) you should have received the link to enroll in the Holistic Christian Herbalist Course. If you do not notice the link please check your email.
2. PLEASE READ & REVIEW THE STUDENT HANDBOOK found in the Welcome & Orientation Module.
3. Complete the course as it is assigned by each module. The order of modules are important. Some modules contain an entire class while as some contain a link to a course. There are classes and courses within the Program of Study.
4. complete your internship & training
5. receive your accredited diploma of completion via mail

Utilize note-taking, highlighting, sticky notes, etc., to support your learning process. You can export all content to a PDF annotation app, including Canva.

UPON COMPLETION OF THIS COURSE YOU WILL RECEIVE CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETIONs & ELIGBLE FOR A DIPLOMA OF COMPLETION.



When you see this icon it means that you need to refer to the CANVAS COURSE for the Assignment.

STUDENT INFO

STUDENT NUMBER (LOCATED ON YOUR STUDENT ID CARD) _____

NAME _____

CANVAS STUDENT LOGIN _____

PASSWORD _____

ENROLLED DATE _____
START DATE _____

NOTES;

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HOLISTIC CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

Penny Lane Whittemore CNC BCNWP CHGp RHCH

Module 3

The Herbalist Path





Please consult the CANVAS COURSE to fulfill these assignments. Following the CANVAS COURSE CLASSROOM closely is crucial for completing the course in its entirety.
As the course is being updated more will be available.
MODULE - Guide to Herbal Medicine - Secular

Assignments:

- Link- Studyopedia
- Link- Monographs
- Link- Herbal Encyclopedia textbook
- Basic Herbalist Level 1
  - Link- Pocket Guide to Herbal Medicine
  - Link- Workbook
  - Understand What Herbalism Is
  - Biology of Herbs
  - Chemistry of Herbs
  - Constituents & Phytonutrients of Plants
  - Safety Comes First
  - Basic Plant Identification
  - Herbal Preparation Methods
    - Link- Herbal Supplies List
  - The Importance of Dosage
    - Link- Safety First Herb Chart
    - Link- Children's Dangerous Herb List
  - Respect for Nature of Harvest
  - Understanding Herbal Energetics
    - Link-Measuring Chart
  - Building a Home Apothecary- First Aid
    - Link- First Aid Herb chart
    - Link- Create a First Aid Cabinet
  - Record Keeping
    - Link- GSM
    - Link- Dispensing Practices
  - Learning from Tradition & Science
    - Link- Basic Skills & Principles eBook
    - Link- Herbal Basics
    - Link- Herbal Recipes for Vibrant Health
- Intermediate Herbalist Level2
  - Understanding Anatomy& Physiology
    - Link- Integrated Holistic Anatomy & Physiology Course
  - Advanced Herbal Preparations
    - Link- Medicinal Herbs eBook
  - herbal Formulation Skills
  - Energetic Matching



Assignments:

- Herbal Safety & Contraindications
  - Link- Drug Interaction Chart
- Seasonal & Local Herbalism
- Materia Medica Development
- Ethnobotany & Cultural Context
- Sourcing & Quality Control
- Client Communication & Ethics
  - Link-Guide to Intake

- Advanced Herbalist Level 3
  - Link- Biblical Medicine Book
- Holistic Herbalism
- Herbal Terminology
- Phytochemistry & Pharmacology
- Advanced Energetics & Diagnostics
  - Face Readings
  - Fingernail Investigations
  - Tongue Analysis
  - Iridology Basics
  - Ear Seeds
- Research & Evidence- Based Practice
- Herbal Formulation Mastery
  - Video
- Legal & Professional Considerations
  - Link- Dispensing Practices
- Teaching & Mentorship
- Community & Clinical Herbalism
- Sustainability & Herbal Activism
- Continual Learning & Integration
  - Link- Guide to Functional Lab Tests
  - link- Clinical Skills

HOLISTIC CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

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Module 3

BEGINNERS HERBALISZ LEVEL 1



The Herbalist's Path: A Complete Guide to Mastering Herbal Knowledge

Introduction

Becoming an herbalist is a journey of discovery, patience, and deep connection with nature. This guide outlines the stages of learning herbs—from beginner to advanced—highlighting the essential knowledge and skills required at each level. Whether studying for personal wellness or professional practice, understanding the progression of herbal education ensures a strong foundation and confident mastery.

Chapter 1: The Beginner Herbalist

Overview

The beginner stage focuses on building a relationship with plants, understanding basic herbal principles, and developing safe, practical skills. This is the time to explore, observe, and learn the language of herbs.

Ten Essential Facts for Beginners

1. Understanding What Herbalism Is
    a. Herbalism is the study and use of plants for healing, nourishment, and balance within the body and environment.
2. Safety Comes First
    a. Always identify plants correctly before use. Misidentification can lead to harmful or toxic reactions.
3. Basic Plant Identification
    a. Learn to recognize common herbs by their leaves, flowers, and growth patterns using field guides and local plant walks.
4. Herbal Preparation Methods
    a. Master simple preparations such as teas, infusions, decoctions, and tinctures.
5. The Importance of Dosage
    a. Understand that herbs are powerful; correct dosage ensures safety and effectiveness.
6. Respect for Nature
    a. Practice ethical wildcrafting—harvest sustainably and with gratitude.
7. Understanding Herbal Energetics
    a. Learn basic energetics such as warming, cooling, drying, and moistening properties of herbs.
8. Building a Home Apothecary
    a. Start with a few versatile herbs like chamomile, peppermint, and lavender.
9. Record Keeping
    a. Keep a herbal journal to document experiences, recipes, and observations.
10. Learning from Tradition and Science
    a. Study both traditional uses and modern research to gain a balanced understanding. How to study, & what resources that are included in the course.

UNDERSTANDING WHAT HERBALISM IS

IMPORTANT CONSIDERATIONS BEFORE STARTING YOUR LEARNING JOURNEY

Before you begin your learning adventure with us, it's essential to keep a few key points in mind.

- Interpretation of Practices: As you may know, the use of alternative and energetic medicine, along with coaching, often relies on the practitioner's interpretation. Therefore, it's vital to approach the application of your new knowledge with discernment and caution.
- Legal and Ethical Compliance: Always adhere to the laws and regulations of your country. Maintain professional ethics at the heart of your practice and prioritize the well-being of your clients.
- Educational Nature of Courses: Our courses aim to be informative and educational, but they do not substitute for professional medical or scientific advice from qualified experts.
- Referral to Professionals: It's crucial to respect the limits of your role and refer clients to healthcare professionals when necessary.
- Subjectivity of Training: Given the subjective nature of these fields, our training may also reflect the trainer's interpretation. Remember, our trainers are human and may make mistakes, sharing only their perspective.
- Error Reporting: Despite our efforts to minimize errors and provide quality training, should you encounter any inaccuracies, please inform us so we can address them promptly.
- Personal Responsibility: Ultimately, you are responsible for how you apply the knowledge you gain.

By following these guidelines, you will not only enhance your professional growth but also cultivate a relationship built on trust and respect with your clients.

Understanding What Herbalism Is

Herbalism, often referred to as botanical medicine or phytotherapy, is the study and utilization of plants for their therapeutic properties. This ancient practice focuses on harnessing the natural benefits of plants to promote healing, nourishment, and balance both within the body and the surrounding environment.

At its core, herbalism is rooted in a profound understanding of the synergy between nature and human health. Herbalists believe that plants possess unique properties that can support the body's inherent ability to heal itself. This practice involves not just the consumption of herbs, but also an appreciation for their role in maintaining ecological balance.

Historically, herbalism has been a cornerstone of traditional medicine systems across the globe, from Traditional Chinese Medicine to Ayurveda. Each culture has contributed its own unique knowledge and methodologies, enriching the field with a diverse array of techniques and applications.

Today, herbalism continues to thrive, bridging ancient wisdom with modern scientific research. People increasingly turn to herbal remedies as a natural alternative or complement to conventional medicine. Whether it's using chamomile for relaxation, ginger for digestion, or aloe vera for skin healing, the applications of herbalism are vast and varied.

In essence, herbalism is not merely a practice but a holistic approach to wellness, emphasizing a harmonious relationship between people and plants. Through this connection, individuals can achieve a balanced state of health, nurturing both body and soul.

BRIEF HISTORY OF HERBS

Herbal Medicine in the US

Native Americans were considered savages except when it came to herbal medicine using their backyard herbs. Many colonists suffered and witnessed the plagues, pestilence that they experienced in Europe. Europeans became eager students of the Native Americans herbal medicine and foraging (wild harvesting) for herbs.

In 1536, a Native American gave sick explorers a tea brewed from yellow cedar bark and leaves to aid in what they called scurvy. They all recovered.

Native Americans introduced white settlers to so many valuable herbs: black cohosh, black haw, boneset, cascara sagrada, Echinacea, chaparral, goldenseal, lobelia, Oregon grape, sarsaparilla, slippery elm, wild cherry, and witch hazel to name just a few.

Exploration and Exportation

Herbs were also a major colonial export. Furs, tobacco, and cotton made the most money but nothing beat ginseng-the herb native to Asia. Ginseng was the ultimate tonic. The French began shipping ginseng to China in the early 1700s. Then ginseng spread to 13 colonies. The price was $1.00 a pound.

Believe it or not the searches for ginseng lead the exploration to discover Pennsylvania, West Virginia, Kentucky, and Tennessee. Our native ginseng collector was Daniel Boone. Constantine S. Rafinesque, a European botanist, came to the Mississippi Valley to study with the Indian healers. He became a botanist professor at a college in KY. Samuel Thompson studies with Native Americans and midwife healers. Thomson's daughter became seriously ill. Doctors pronounced her incurable, but with a hot bath and some herbs she was cured. He created a System of Botanic Practice of Medicine.

In 1820, two-thirds of the treatments in the U.S. were botanical by 1880 the amount was three-quarters. By the 20th century herbal medicine was replaced with pharmaceutical drugs. However some of these drugs are derived from herbs.

History of Herbalism

The use of plants as medicines dates as far back as the Earth began. Through trial and error Adam and Eve and descendants discovered that some plants are good for food, that some are poisonous, and that some produce bodily changes such as increased perspiration, bowel movement, urination, relief of pain, hallucination, and healing. Over time these observations were passed from generation to generation. Every culture has developed a body of herbal knowledge as part of its tradition.

Every culture has their own specific knowledge of herbal medicine along with the common names being carried over the generations. One culture may use for example. Mistletoe for treating cancer while other cultures may not.

Mesopotamia

The first written known record of herbal medicine was made over five thousand years ago by the Sumerians, in ancient Mesopotamia (present day Iraq.)

China

The roots of Chinese medicine, which is based largely on herbalism, also date back approximately 5,000 years.

BRIEF HISTORY OF HERBS

India

The Indian system of medicine was called the Ayurveda. The Indian materia medica, or list of herbs used as medicines was extreme.. Indian herbalism or Ayurveda is still practiced today.

Greeks and Romans

The Greek physician Hippocrates c.460 - 377 BC, who is often called as the "Father of Modern Medicine" was an herbalist. He is known for having written, "Let your Foods be your medicines, and your medicines your food."

Middle Ages, Europe and America

During the Middle Ages the knowledge of medicinal plants was furthered by monks in Europe who studied and grew medicinal plants, and of course translated the information down from generation to generation.

When the Europeans first came to America, they discovered that the Native Americans had knowledge of the herbs. This type of knowledge is referred to as shamanism. A priest, or shaman. Some say when Lewis and Clark made their famous expedition westward from the Mississippi River; one of their duties was to learn from the Native Americans about their herbs.

Nicholas Culpepper

'A man for all seasons' first opened an apothecary in 1640. He sold low-cost botanical medicine. He published two works, The English Physician People's Herbal and an English translation of the Latin Pharmacopeia.

The Shakers

Ann Lee, an English Shaker, was known for her medicinal herbs. Her motto was 'hands to work, heart to God.' Shakers sold herbs by catalogs. The Shakers also invented the modern pill by packing in the powdered herb into a wooden mold, selling millions.

Thomas Botanic Medicine

Samuel Thomson studies with midwives and Indian healers. Thomson' daughter became ill and the medical doctors gave her up, but Thomson healed her with an herbal bath. His approach was called heroic medicine by using laxatives, bloodletting, and the use of mercury.

Herbalism in Ancient Civilizations: Egypt, Greece, and Rome

Herbalism has played a pivotal role in shaping the medical systems of ancient civilizations, leaving an enduring impact on modern medical practices. The ancient societies of Egypt, Greece, and Rome each contributed uniquely to the development of herbal medicine, laying the groundwork for contemporary phytotherapy and pharmacology.

In ancient Egypt, the practice of herbalism was deeply intertwined with the religious and medical practices of the time. Priest-physicians, revered for their knowledge, utilized an extensive array of over 700 plant-based remedies. These remedies were meticulously documented in texts such as the Ebers Papyrus, showcasing their mastery in preparing medications in various forms. The Egyptian approach to herbal medicine was both systematic and innovative, highlighting their commitment to healing through nature.

Moving to ancient Greece, the significance of medicinal plants was further emphasized by luminaries like Hippocrates, who advocated for their use in restoring the balance of humors—an essential concept in Greek medicine. Theophrastus, a student of Aristotle, authored "History of Plants," detailing over 500 plant species and their medicinal applications. His work contributed significantly to the understanding and classification of plants, setting a precedent for future botanical studies.

Another notable figure from Greece, Dioscorides, compiled the monumental work "De Materia Medica." This encyclopedia cataloged over 600 medicinal plants and served as a vital reference for more than 1,500 years, influencing both contemporary and future generations of herbalists and physicians.

In Rome, the legacy of Greek herbalism was further advanced by Galen, a prominent physician and philosopher. He refined the art of preparing medications, a practice later known as "galenic" medicine. By codifying pharmaceutical forms and methods for extracting active principles from plants, Galen's contributions greatly enhanced the precision and effectiveness of herbal remedies.

The herbalism practices of these ancient civilizations reflect a profound desire to rationalize the use of medicinal plants through empirical observation and systematic classification. Their collective efforts have laid a solid foundation for modern phytotherapy and pharmacology, underscoring the timeless value of their insights and innovations. As we continue to explore and utilize medicinal plants today, the legacy of ancient herbalism remains a testament to humanity's enduring quest for healing through nature.

Herbalist Traditions in China, India, and Tibet

The herbal traditions of China, India, and Tibet present a holistic and complementary approach to Western herbalism, deeply rooted in their unique cosmologies and philosophies.

In China, traditional medicine is centered around the concept of Qi, the life force, and the balance between Yin and Yang. Plants are meticulously classified by their nature, flavor, and tropism, which relate to their effects on different organs and systems within the body.

In India, the practice of Ayurveda focuses on maintaining equilibrium among the three doshas: Vata, Pitta, and Kapha. Remedies are carefully selected based on each individual's unique constitution, ensuring a personalized approach to health and wellness.

Tibetan medicine, influenced by both Ayurveda and Chinese traditions, emphasizes the importance of balancing the three humors and achieving harmony between body, mind, and environment. This integration of diverse influences results in a comprehensive system that addresses health on multiple levels.

These traditions share a common vision of health as a dynamic state of balance, reflecting the harmony between the individual and their environment. They regard plants as vital allies in maintaining or restoring this balance across physical, emotional, and spiritual dimensions.

Incorporating this ancestral knowledge into modern herbalism enriches our understanding of the therapeutic potential of plants. It offers more tailored and comprehensive solutions for health, allowing practitioners to draw from a vast reservoir of wisdom to enhance the well-being of those they serve.

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Prehistoric Origins of the Use of Medicinal Plants

The use of medicinal plants traces back to the dawn of humanity, long before the establishment of writing and structured medical systems. Archaeological discoveries provide compelling evidence of prehistoric humans recognizing and utilizing the healing properties of plants. For instance, medicinal flower pollen found in a Neanderthal burial site at Shanidar in Iraq, alongside micro-plant remains in the dental tartar of human fossils, highlight this ancient practice.
This knowledge was accumulated through generations, shared orally, and was shaped by careful observation, experimentation, and memorization. This process created a symbiotic relationship between humans and nature. The transition to sedentary lifestyles and the onset of agriculture during the Neolithic period further enhanced the understanding of medicinal plants. Archaeological sites reveal evidence of plant storage, dating back over 8,000 years, underscoring their importance in early societies.
Medicinal plants transcended their practical applications, embodying symbolic and spiritual significance. They played crucial roles in healing rituals, shamanic practices, and religious beliefs, reflecting an ancient holistic perspective on health and well-being.
Exploring these prehistoric origins allows us to reconnect with a timeless ancestral wisdom that has profoundly influenced our systems of knowledge and health practices, providing a foundation for traditional herbalism that persists today.

Medieval Herbalism in the West: The Synergy of Monastic and Arabic Knowledge

During the medieval period, herbalism in the West was significantly shaped by the dual influences of monastic and Arabic knowledge. This era marked a pivotal time in the preservation and advancement of medicinal practices.
Monks were instrumental in conserving ancient medicinal wisdom. They not only safeguarded this knowledge but also enhanced it through hands-on experience in monastic herb gardens. These gardens served as vital centers of learning and experimentation, where practical applications of herbal remedies were meticulously recorded and refined.
A notable figure in this tradition is Hildegard of Bingen, a Benedictine abbess renowned for her extensive work in herbalism. Her seminal text, "Physica," catalogues the medicinal properties of over 200 plants, reflecting a deep understanding of botanical therapeutics.
Simultaneously, Arab physicians were developing a comprehensive pharmacopoeia, characterized by the incorporation of exotic plants and innovative galenic formulations. From the 12th century onwards, their encyclopedic treatises were translated into Latin, making this rich body of knowledge accessible to the Western world. The Arab influence is particularly evident in the introduction of new medicinal plants and the enhancement of techniques for preparing and administering remedies.
The melding of monastic and Arabic knowledge gave birth to a unique herbalist tradition in medieval Western Europe. This synergy laid the foundation for a revival of pharmacopoeia that would later flourish during the Renaissance, ushering in an era of renewed interest and innovation in medicinal practices.
Studying medieval herbalism offers a window into a captivating chapter of medical history. It allows us to reconnect with a living tradition that is abundant in invaluable expertise and fosters a profound connection with the plant world. This rich heritage continues to inspire and inform contemporary herbal practices.

The Evolution of Herbalism from the 16th to the 19th Century in Europe

The journey of herbalism throughout Europe from the 16th to the 19th century illustrates a fascinating transformation, deeply intertwined with the broader cultural and scientific shifts of the time. The advent of the printing press in the 15th century marked a pivotal moment, significantly enhancing the accessibility of botanical and medical knowledge. This technological advancement laid the groundwork for the proliferation of herbal texts, democratizing information that was once confined to a select few.

During the Renaissance, there emerged a renewed interest in herbalism, driven by the rediscovery of ancient texts and the burgeoning humanist movement. This era was characterized by innovative approaches, such as Paracelsus's theory of signatures, which posited that the physical characteristics of plants revealed their healing properties. This period was a renaissance not only in art and literature but also in the understanding and application of herbal medicine.

The 17th century witnessed the rise of scientific botany, which introduced a more systematic approach to the study of plants. This period was distinguished by the meticulous description, naming, and classification of plants, adhering to rigorous scientific criteria. Botanical gardens began to flourish, serving as both research hubs and public educational resources, bridging the gap between empirical knowledge and scientific inquiry.

In the 18th century, traditional herbalism began to encounter significant challenges from the burgeoning fields of scientific medicine and pharmaceutical chemistry. These new disciplines questioned the theoretical underpinnings of herbalism and promoted the use of standardized chemical medications. The tension between traditional practices and scientific innovations became increasingly pronounced, reflecting a broader cultural shift towards empirical science.

Despite the decline of traditional herbalism in the 19th century, it was not entirely eclipsed. Herbalists and healers continued to operate, often on the periphery of official medicine, preserving their empirical knowledge and practices. This era underscored a persistent tension between tradition and modernity, as well as between empirical approaches and scientific rationality.

Today, the legacy of traditional herbalism is recognized as a valuable resource, offering insights into our relationship with nature and healthcare. As we continue to rediscover the virtues of medicinal plants, the historical evolution of herbalism provides a rich tapestry of knowledge and perspective that informs contemporary discussions on holistic health and sustainable practices.

The Renewal of Herbalism in the 20th Century and Current Trends

The 20th century witnessed a significant revival of herbalism, driven by a growing skepticism towards conventional medicine and a rising interest in natural, holistic therapeutic alternatives. This resurgence was largely influenced by pioneering figures such as Maurice Mességué in France, John Christopher in the United States, and Rudolf Fritz Weiss in Germany, who were instrumental in popularizing and professionalizing modern herbalism.

A key aspect of this revival is the productive dialogue with traditional medicines worldwide, which has enriched herbalism by incorporating an energetic and constitutional dimension. This cross-cultural exchange has allowed for a more comprehensive understanding and application of herbal practices.

Scientific research on medicinal plants has seen substantial growth, integrating pharmacological studies, clinical trials, and ethnobotanical surveys to better validate traditional uses. This has led to the emergence of ethnopharmacology, a discipline focused on enhancing and preserving traditional knowledge of medicinal plants while providing scientific validation.

Another development in this field is precision herbalism, which tailors the use of plants based on individual profiles using precision medicine tools. This approach ensures that herbal treatments are more effective and personalized.

Furthermore, eco-herbalism has become an important trend, placing the use of medicinal plants within a broader context of biodiversity preservation and ecosystem regeneration. This approach emphasizes the connection between human health and planetary health, advocating for sustainable practices that benefit both.

In summary, the renewal of herbalism in the 20th century and the current trends reflect a dynamic and evolving field that bridges traditional wisdom with modern scientific research, while also addressing environmental concerns.

Herbalism Today

Herbs are often proving to be effective and safe alternatives to dangerous and costly drugs. We are no longer restricted to the herbs that are found in our own region, because we now have access to plants from around the world.

What does the Future hold?

The future for herbalism looks good. The more we teach our upcoming generations about herbalism and preserving our natural ecosystem, herbal medicine will hopefully pass on to the next generations for many years. A lot of other cultures and countries are adapting the use of herbal medicine everyday. That is why I am committed to teaching the community and the upcoming generations about herbs and their uses.

HERBALIST DEFIND

In general, to become an herbalist, one must have a deep understanding of plants and their medicinal properties. This may be obtained through a formal education program or through self-study and apprenticeship. Many herbalists have backgrounds in nutrition, chemistry, biology, or other science-related fields as well.

There are various educational programs available for those interested in becoming an herbalist. These programs may range from short courses to full bachelor's or master's degree programs. Some examples of programs include:

- Herbal Apprenticeships: An apprenticeship is an educational program where a student works closely with an experienced herbalist to learn the ins and outs of herbal medicine. These programs may last anywhere from a few months to a few years, and may be offered by individual herbalists or schools.
- Online Courses: Many schools and herbalists offer online courses in herbal medicine. These may range from introductory courses to more advanced programs, and may be self-paced or have set schedules.
- Traditional Degree Programs: Some universities offer traditional degree programs in fields such as herbal medicine, naturopathy, or integrative medicine.
- Certifications: As mentioned earlier, there are private third party associations that offer certifications or registrations for herbalists. These programs may have specific requirements or qualifications that must be met before a student can become certified.

In addition to education, many herbalists also have hands-on experience working with plants and making herbal preparations. This may involve growing and harvesting herbs, making teas, tinctures, or salves, and working with clients to develop herbal remedies tailored to their specific needs.

Overall, becoming an herbalist requires a combination of education, experience, and passion for the natural world. It is a rewarding career path that allows individuals to help others while also connecting with nature and promoting sustainable living.

The National Certification Commission for Acupuncture and Oriental Medicine (NCCAOM) awards certification in Chinese herbology (www.nccaom.org). However, certification is not the same as a state licensor, which is handled differently in each of the states and in the District of Columbia. In some states, herbalists receive an acupuncture license. They may be required to take a certain number of hours of study from a state-approved school.

Student herbalists can get internships through organizations such as The Herb Research Foundation (www.herbs.org). The American Association of Drugless Practitioners (AADP) provides a list of schools that teach the discipline (www.aadp.net). The school that is recognized that I wish to attend is Indian Board of Alternative Medicines.

It's important to note that regulations and requirements for practicing herbal medicine vary by state and country. It's important to research the laws and regulations in your area before pursuing a career in Chinese herbology or any other form of alternative medicine. Additionally, it's important to seek out credible educational institutions and programs to ensure proper training and certification.

Becoming an herbalist requires time and practice to master the art. While anyone can call themselves an herbalist, not everyone has the proper training or education to produce effective herbal preparations.

There are many variations to being an herbalist, such as adding holism, homeopathy, and Bach remedies to an herbalist consulting business. Each herbalist is unique due to their individualized training, cultural background, and geographical region. Therefore, the products and services offered by herbalists may also differ.

Before consulting as an advanced herbalist, make sure you understand the laws regarding Herbalist Consulting in your state or government.

HERBALIST DEFIND

Herbalists are not permitted to:

- Treat, diagnose, or prescribe an herb as a drug
- Claim that an herb can cure, heal, or prevent
- Claim that herbs are drugs
- Open their practice in certain states and under certain governments without proper registration
- Create and sell herbal preparations without adhering to FDA labeling guidelines and conducting research
- Make claims that an herb can address specific ailments; for instance, stating that Goji berries can prevent cancer is inaccurate.
- Be a doctor or call themselves a doctor unless they are state or government license holder
- Mass market herbal products without proper FDA registration





Herbalist can;

- Consult using herbs as dietary supplements as an herbalist, coach, or consultant
- Write and publish books and or articles
- Instruct or hold classes
- Sale dietary supplements
- Say that an herb can support or aid in a specific body system; for example; Goji berries can support the immune system and or aide in the process of free radical secretion.
- Open a health food store
- Open a school
- Be certified by a third party association
- Create herbals for individual clients

HERBALIST DUTIES

Herbalists are experts in the study of plants and their properties. They have an in-depth understanding of the unique chemistry and botanical information of each plant. In addition to studying botany and biochemistry, herbalists can also delve into other areas such as phytochemistry, aromatherapy, and acupuncture to gain a deeper understanding of how plants can be used to promote wellness.

The vast amount of knowledge an herbalist needs to acquire may seem daunting, but it all comes down to one important tool: their knowledge of the plants they work with. In order to properly prepare and use these plants, herbalists must have a thorough understanding of their properties, growing conditions, and application methods. This knowledge is crucial for their success.

Not only do herbalists need to have a vast amount of knowledge, but they also need to use it wisely and safely. Incorrect application of herbs can be dangerous, so it is important for herbalists to understand how to use their knowledge in a way that promotes health and wellness.

This course will provide a comprehensive understanding of the responsibilities and job roles of an herbalist. You will learn about the different areas of study required to become an expert in the field, and gain an appreciation for the vast amount of knowledge and skill required to be a successful herbalist. By the end of the course, you will have a thorough understanding of the important role that herbalists play in promoting health and wellness through the use of plants.

Consultant as a Teacher

The word "doctor" comes from a Latin word for "teacher," highlighting the important role that doctors should play in educating their patients. In addition to being knowledgeable about the principles of good health, doctors should also be willing to share this knowledge with others. Unfortunately, this task can be challenging in today's technologically-based healthcare system, as doctors may not have enough time to spend with each patient.

One way to bridge this gap and promote greater patient education is through free community lectures and seminars, which can provide valuable information to individuals who may not have access to a healthcare provider. As someone who is passionate about promoting good health in my community, I am committed to organizing community meetings to help educate others on the importance of maintaining a healthy lifestyle.

It's not just doctors who have a responsibility to educate their clients about optimal health. Natural health consultants also have a key role to play in promoting healthy living. However, in today's fast-paced world, it can be difficult for both doctors and natural health consultants to find the time to educate their patients. This is particularly challenging given that optimal health varies from person to person, meaning that there is no one-size-fits-all natural health plan.

Ultimately, the responsibility for maintaining good health rests with each individual. While there are many factors that can affect our health, the majority of these are tied to lifestyle choices. As such, it is up to each of us to take care of our bodies and support our overall well-being through healthy choices and a commitment to living a balanced lifestyle.

HERBALIST RESPONSABILITIES

Understanding natural health and how the body works is essential to making informed decisions about our well-being. When we have a deeper knowledge of these topics, we can make more educated choices that can lead to improved health outcomes. I highly encourage you to dig deep into God's word pertaining to the parts of the body, and the 3 members of the body. There is a faith and health connection, a pathway to disease, spiritual roots of disease, and healings of snares of the soul that can be considered for living a healthful life, and to some non-believers spiritual deliverance.

For example, when it comes to our diet, we can choose to consume a variety of nutrient-rich foods that fuel our body and provide us with the energy we need to get through the day. Additionally, we can incorporate herbal preparations and even supplements into our routine to ensure that we are getting all the essential vitamins and minerals we need to stay healthy.

Exercise is also crucial for maintaining optimal health. Engaging in physical activity regularly can help us maintain a healthy weight, reduce our risk of chronic diseases, help boost our mood, and help balance hormones. We can choose to incorporate different types of exercise into our routine, such as strength training, cardio, or HIIT training to keep our bodies strong and healthy, and the hormones balanced.

Lastly, our thoughts and beliefs can impact our overall well-being. By practicing mindfulness and positive self-talk, we can improve our mental health and reduce stress levels. This can have a ripple effect on our physical health, as stress can often manifest itself in physical symptoms.

In summary, by taking a holistic approach to our health and wellness, we can make choices that lead to improved health outcomes and a better quality of life. We can re-train our brains with the right thinking, eliminating hurtful thoughts, forgiveness, and just letting the rudiments of life go.

Proverbs 23:7
"For as he thinketh in his heart, so is he: Eat and drink, saith he to thee; but his heart is not with thee."
King James Version (KJV)

By embracing these principles, we can foster a more balanced and fulfilling life. It's important to remember that health is not a one-size-fits-all journey; it is a personal and ongoing process that requires patience and dedication. Everyone's path to wellness will look different, and that's perfectly okay.

Consider setting small, achievable goals for yourself. Whether it's drinking more water, taking a daily walk, or spending a few minutes each day in meditation, these small steps can add up to significant improvements over time. Celebrate your progress, no matter how minor it may seem, and be kind to yourself when things don't go as planned.

Community support can also play a vital role in our health journey. Surround yourself with people who uplift and encourage you. Sharing your goals and challenges with a trusted friend or joining a wellness group can provide the motivation and accountability you need to stay on track.

Furthermore, staying informed and continuing to educate yourself about health topics can empower you to make even better decisions. Read books, attend workshops, and consult with healthcare professionals who respect your holistic approach to well-being. Knowledge truly is power when it comes to health.

Remember, your well-being is a precious gift. Treat it with the care and respect it deserves. By nurturing your body, mind, and spirit, you can create a harmonious and vibrant life that reflects your true potential.

NATURAL HEALTH LAY PERSON

A natural health layperson is someone who does not hold a medical degree or state licensure. This means that they are not authorized to practice medicine or perform medical procedures. However, there are legal ways for natural health laypeople to recommend natural health support. It is important to check the laws of natural health in your country, state, and/or county to avoid any legal issues. Natural health laypeople can provide valuable support and guidance to those seeking to improve their health, provided they work within the bounds of the law.

This is where the Systems Approach comes in. The Systems Approach was created to provide a safe, legal, and ethical framework for natural health laypeople to work within. By following this approach, natural health laypeople can effectively help themselves and others improve their health. The Systems Approach is focused on improving the body's natural systems through natural means, such as food consumption changes, food supplements, and herbal supplements. It is important to note that the Systems Approach is not designed to diagnose, prescribe, or treat diseases or illnesses. Instead, it is focused on providing information, education and guidance to support the body's natural systems.

It is important to understand that it is illegal to diagnose, prescribe, or treat any medical condition, disease, or aliment without a license. This means that natural health laypeople must be careful to remain within the bounds of the law. However, by following the Systems Approach, natural health laypeople can still provide valuable support and guidance to those seeking to improve their health in a safe and legal way.

How to Study Herbs

When it comes to studying herbs, the process of delving into each individual herb can truly be a lifelong endeavor. The vast array of herbs available is staggering, and it can be both overwhelming and fascinating to explore the many possibilities. As an herbalist, I personally find great value in utilizing the common backyard herbs that can be easily wild harvested. However, I also understand that different herbalists may have their own unique preferences in terms of how they obtain the herbs they use. Some may opt for the convenience of purchasing herbs from reputable companies, co-ops, or farmer's markets.

It's important to recognize that the motivation behind studying a particular herb can vary from person to person. While some herbalists may embark on a comprehensive and broad study of herbs, others may focus on specific health reasons or symptoms that they wish to address. Regardless of the approach, rest assured that any form of studying will undoubtedly benefit an herbalist in their journey towards becoming a professional and a true master of herbs.

In the process of studying herbs, it is crucial to delve into various aspects of each herb. This includes understanding the benefits that the herb offers, as well as its diverse uses and properties. Additionally, it is essential to be aware of any potential side effects or warnings associated with the herb, as well as the possibility of drug interactions that may occur. Moreover, exploring the synergistic potential of combining different herbs can lead to the development of unique and effective combinations, known as formularies.

So, whether you choose to immerse yourself in the intricate details of each individual herb or take a more targeted approach based on specific health concerns, the journey of studying herbs is one that will undoubtedly enrich your knowledge and expertise as an herbalist.

Exploring Herbal Studies: A Practical Guide to Start at Home

Studying herbs can be a fulfilling journey that enriches your understanding of both culinary arts and natural medicine. The best way to embark on this path is to begin by exploring what's already at your fingertips—right in your own home. Your kitchen is a treasure trove of potential, filled with a variety of dried herbs, plants, vegetables, and fruits that you can start exploring today.

*Step 1: Inventory Your Kitchen**
Begin by taking stock of your kitchen cupboards, spice rack, and refrigerator. Compile a comprehensive list of all the herbs and spices you find. This list will be your starting point, guiding your initial steps into the world of herbal studies.

*Step 2: Dive into Research**
With your list in hand, it's time to dig deeper into the properties and uses of each herb. Consider using an herbal wheel or other resources provided in any courses you might be taking. This will help you organize your research and systematically study each herb.

*Step 3: Engage Your Senses**
As you explore each herb, engage your senses fully. Smell the aroma, taste the flavors, and begin incorporating these herbs into your daily routine. This hands-on approach not only makes the learning process more enjoyable but also enhances your understanding of each herb's unique characteristics.

*Step 4: Understand Nutritional Properties**
It's crucial to study the nutritional properties of each herb, such as their vitamins and minerals, as well as their actions and effects on the body. Even common kitchen herbs and spices can offer surprising health benefits and insights. By starting with familiar ingredients, you create a solid foundation in herbal studies.

*Step 5: Appreciate Culinary and Medicinal Potential**
Ultimately, this method allows you to appreciate the dual potential of herbs—both in culinary delights and medicinal uses. As you become more familiar with each herb's characteristics, you'll not only enhance your cooking but also tap into the holistic benefits they offer.

By following these steps, you can gradually build a robust understanding of herbs, transforming everyday kitchen staples into powerful allies for health and wellbeing. This journey through herbal studies is not only educational but also a delightful way to enrich your lifestyle.

Inventory

Herb Names		

WHAT IS AN HERB?

The dictionary gives the word 'herb' two definitions. (1) a seed producing plant that does not develop woody tissue that dies down at the end of the growing season (2) a plant or plant part valued for its medicinal, savory, and aromatic purposes. The second definition is the one that I will be referring to throughout this course.

A 'plant or plant part or plant material' means that an herb can be a tree, shrub, root, fruit, seed, flower, or any other part of the plant except the dirt, as long as it is used for medicinal purposes.

For the purpose of this course, we are interested in herbs that are used for natural health purposes. I will throughout this course refer to all plants as an herb. I believe that all plants have some sort of medicinal use, bad or good, whether we know a purpose or not.

There are a lot of theories, statements regarding if herbs really do hold any dietary properties. Each herbalist, layperson in the natural health (alternative) world has their own beliefs and teaching when it comes to the uses of the plant and the active component or live component or constituents found in each plant source. For this course it will be stated and known that plants can contain properties that can be used for aiding natural health.

According to Dr. Earl Mindell there are 380,000 species of plants that have been identified, and several hundred thousand that have not yet been discovered. Out of these 380,000 plants about 260,000 have been classified as higher plants, meaning that they contain chlorophyll and perform a certain process called photosynthesis. All of these plants listed in the higher plant group have the potential to offer medicinal benefits. However, only 10 percent have actually been studied for medicinal purposes.

Herbs have been used for centuries by various traditional medicine systems like Ayurveda, Chinese medicine, and indigenous cultures. These systems use herbs and plants for their potential health benefits and preventative abilities. Herbs can be used in different forms like teas, tinctures, capsules, and as whole foods. They can be used to support the immune system, improve digestion, reduce inflammation, improve sleep, alleviate anxiety and depression, and much more.

Many scientific studies have also shown the potential health benefits of herbs. For example, turmeric contains curcumin, which has anti-inflammatory properties and has been shown to reduce the risk of chronic diseases like cancer and Alzheimer's. Ginger has been found to have anti-nausea properties and can be used to alleviate motion sickness.

However, it is important to note that herbs should not be used as a substitute for medical treatment or medication. It is always recommended to consult with a qualified healthcare provider before starting any herbal remedies, especially if you have any pre-existing medical conditions or taking any medications.

Overall, herbs can hold potential dietary properties and can be used as part of a holistic approach to natural health.

The NCCAM is also a great resource to learn about traditional medicines and practices from around the world, and their potential benefits and risks. They offer a variety of information on herbal supplements, including their uses, potential side effects and interactions, and dosages. It is important to note that just because something is natural or derived from a plant, it does not necessarily mean that it is safe or effective without further research and testing.

It is always important to consult with a healthcare professional before starting any new herbal supplement or alternative therapy, especially if you are taking any medications or have any health conditions. While herbs can provide many benefits, they can also interact with medications and cause potential harm, so it is important to approach them with caution and under the guidance of a professional.

In conclusion, while there is still much to learn about the benefits and risks of herbal supplements, the NCCAM is a valuable resource for information and research on these natural remedies. It is always important to seek professional guidance and to approach these supplements with caution, but they can provide a natural and effective way to support our health and wellbeing.

INTRODUCTION OF HERBS

An herb is a plant used for its phytochemicals, which are the active compounds found within the plant. Plants have an almost limitless ability to create aromatic substances, most of which are phenols or their oxygen-substituted derivatives such as tannins. In many cases, these substances, especially alkaloids, serve as plant defense mechanisms. Many of the herbs and spices used by humans to season food yield useful health components as well.

The use of and search for drugs and dietary supplements derived from plants has grown in recent years. Pharmacologists, microbiologists, botanists, and natural-products chemists are combining what could be developed for the treatment of various diseases. The potential benefits of herbal medicine are being explored more and more.

Some herbalists refer to all medicinal plants, trees, vines, weeds, shrubs, mosses, etc., that contain medicinal properties as 'herbs'. Regardless of species or family, some herbalists believe that all plants hold medicinal properties. This belief is based on the idea that plants have evolved over millions of years to produce a wide variety of chemical compounds in order to defend against predators, attract pollinators, and compete with other plants for resources. Thus, even plants that are not traditionally considered medicinal may still have properties that could be useful for human health.

Herbal medicine is a type of complementary and alternative medicine that has been recognized as an effective treatment method by the scientific community. Although herbal remedies are generally considered safe in North America, they are classified as dietary supplements by law, which means that the manufacturing standards for these products are not as stringent as those required for pharmaceutical drugs. As a result, some herbal remedies may not meet the same safety and efficacy standards as pharmaceutical drugs.

However, despite the limitations imposed by law, many manufacturers still advertise the supposed benefits of herbal remedies extensively through third-party advertising in magazines and through company representatives. While manufacturers can only make a few "structure and function" claims, some work around that limitation by using creative marketing techniques to promote their products.

Despite the differences in legal classification and physician training, the public's interest in alternative therapies for general health maintenance and supportive treatment of chronic diseases has increased tremendously. This growing interest has spurred further research into the efficacy and safety of herbal remedies, and has led to the development of new and innovative treatment methods.

As research continues to expand, the integration of herbal medicine into conventional healthcare systems is becoming more prevalent. Many healthcare providers are now recognizing the value of incorporating herbal remedies as part of a holistic approach to patient care. This approach not only treats symptoms but also aims to address the root causes of illnesses and promote overall well-being.

One of the key advantages of herbal medicine is its potential for personalization. Unlike standardized pharmaceutical drugs, herbal treatments can be tailored to the specific needs of an individual, taking into account factors such as age, weight, lifestyle, and even genetic predispositions. This personalized approach can lead to more effective and targeted treatments, reducing the likelihood of side effects.

Moreover, the sustainability of herbal medicine is an important consideration in today's environmentally conscious world. Many herbs can be grown locally, reducing the carbon footprint associated with the production and transportation of pharmaceuticals. Additionally, the cultivation of medicinal plants can support biodiversity and the preservation of endangered species.

Despite the promising potential of herbal medicine, it is important for consumers to approach it with caution. Not all herbal products are created equal, and the lack of stringent regulatory oversight means that some products may be of inferior quality or even contain harmful substances. It is crucial for consumers to seek out reputable sources and consult with qualified healthcare practitioners before starting any herbal treatment.

INTRODUCTION OF HERBS

Education and awareness are also vital in ensuring the safe and effective use of herbal medicine. As more research is conducted and more information becomes available, both healthcare providers and the public must stay informed about the benefits and risks associated with these treatments. By fostering a collaborative environment between traditional and alternative medicine, we can harness the full potential of herbal remedies to improve health outcomes and enhance the quality of life for individuals worldwide.

In conclusion, the resurgence of interest in herbal medicine reflects a growing recognition of its potential benefits. While challenges remain in terms of regulation and standardization, the continued exploration and integration of herbal treatments into mainstream healthcare hold promise for a more holistic and sustainable approach to health and wellness.

DEFINING HERBS

Defining herbs is a crucial aspect of understanding their properties and uses. One way to define an herb is through plant classification, which organizes the characteristics of an herb into smaller categories such as family, genus, species, hybrid, variety, subspecies, form, and cultivar.

The family of an herb refers to a group of related plants, while the genus refers to a group of related species. Species, on the other hand, refers to a group of similar plants. Hybrid, as the name suggests, is a cross between two plants. Variety, subspecies, and form are subdivisions of hybrid species. The cultivar, meanwhile, is a plant produced and maintained by cultivation with the same characteristics of habit, color, and flavor.

When it comes to identifying herbs, the Latin and common names come in handy. Different cultures may have the same herb with a different common name, but the scientific name will remain consistent. This is how we classify herbs consistently across nations.

Overall, understanding the classification of herbs is essential for anyone interested in their properties and uses. By knowing the different categories of herbs and how they are classified, we can better understand their unique characteristics and benefits.

DEFINITIONS HERBALIST SHOULD KNOW

- Herbal Preparation: A time-honored system of healing practiced in every culture in the world. Science has modernized the system using analytical and pharmaceutical testing. The science-based practice of herbal medicine is now called phytomedicine or phytotherapy, which is a system of therapeutics in which diseases and disorders are treated with medicinal plants and preparations made from them using scientific principles.
- 'Medicinal' herbs: Medicinal products whose active ingredients consist exclusively of medicinal plants and preparations made from them. Using modern chemical and pharmaceutical methods, a number of popular herbal remedies are nowadays "standardized" to provide consistent levels of proven identified active compounds.
- Phytochemistry: The study of plant chemistry, including the identification, isolation, analysis, and characterization of plant constituents, and determination of the chemical structures of plant constituents.
- Pharmaceutical biology: The field of research concerned with the extraction and development of biogenic drugs from plants and other living organisms, as well as the processing and application of these drugs.
- Phytopharmacology: The study of the uptake, distribution, and effect of herbal preparations and of their elimination from the body.
- Active principles: Substances or substance groups definable by chemical analysis that essentially contribute to the therapeutic action of a medicinal herbal preparation. These active principles can be isolated and used for developing new pharmaceutical drugs.
- Active ingredients of medicinal herbal preparations: Plant ingredients in their natural states and preparations made from them. These ingredients are the basis for the therapeutic effects of herbal medicine.
- Minor constituents: Substances that have an indirect or slight effect on the therapeutic action of an herbal drug. Although they may not be as potent as active principles, they can still contribute to the overall therapeutic effect of herbal preparation.
- Single-herb herbal preparation: Herbal medicinal preparation from one medicinal plant. These preparations are often used in traditional herbal medicine practices.
- Target constituents: Herbal drug preparation constituents definable by chemical analysis that are used as parameters of in-process quality control and may contribute to a characteristic pharmaceutical property. Identifying and controlling target constituents in herbal preparations is important for ensuring their quality and efficacy.
- Species, genus, family: Taxonomic terms classifying a plant. A genus may include one or more species, and a family may include one or more genera. Understanding the taxonomy of plants is important for identifying and using medicinal plants in herbal medicine.

WHAT BIBLICAL EVIDENCE THAT HERBS WORK?

The use of herbs for herbal preparation purposes has been around for centuries, and it has been documented in various cultural and religious texts, including the Bible. The Bible offers an insightful perspective on the use of herbs and confirms their efficacy in treating various ailments.

Firstly, there are numerous biblical references to the use of herbs for health & wellness purposes. Ezekiel 47:12 mentions the leaves of the trees being for medicine, while Isaiah 38:21 talks about the use of figs as a plaster for boils. Psalms 104:14-15 highlights the use of herbs for the service of man, and Judges 9:9 talks about the olive tree's oil that honors both God and man. Other biblical references include Jeremiah 8:22, Proverbs 24:13, Luke 10:34, 1 Timothy 5:23, and Revelation 22:2.

Although some may question the relevance of these biblical references, it is clear that herbs and other natural substances were recommended for injury and illness in the Bible and were used by God's people in therapeutic ways. In addition, Jewish tradition documents that Solomon, Ezra, and Nehemiah were well versed in the virtues of herbs and the qualities of roots, with Solomon considered to have taught how to cure diseases by natural means.

Secondly, the value of successful herbal use is demonstrated in historical and traditional records. Anecdotal evidence, although not as reliable as controlled scientific studies, is consistent over time in many different parts of the world for the same health conditions. This consistency has some clinical value and should not be ignored.

Thirdly, when historical and traditional herb use is confirmed by modern clinical studies. Today, more and more clinical studies are confirming the value of certain herbs, and Christians should be joyful and confident to use the natural herbal preparations created by the greatest physician in the universe. In fact, many modern medicines were created directly or indirectly using medicinal herbs, such as aspirin, digitalis, atropine, morphine, and many others.

In conclusion, the use of herbs for health & wellness purposes has been documented over the centuries and validated by various cultural and religious texts, including the Bible. When used correctly, herbs can provide significant benefits in supporting & aiding various concerns. While some may question the relevance of anecdotal evidence, it is essential to recognize that it has some clinical value, especially when consistent over time. In addition, with modern clinical studies confirming the value of certain herbs, it is clear that herbs have a vital role to play in modern health & wellness. As Christians, we should embrace the natural health & wellness support created by God and be confident in HIS ability to heal and improve our overall well-being.

This study session introduces the Good Samaritan, who is a perfect example of an early God-loving herbalist. In Luke chapter 10, Jesus teaches us what a "good neighbor" should be like, and as we will learn today, the good Samaritan serves as a model for our attitude toward hurting people and the use of herbals as a ministry of Jesus living through us.

The Good Samaritan story is a well-known parable that has been taught and retold for centuries. It is a story of compassion, kindness, and selflessness. The man on the side of the road was beaten, robbed, and left for dead. Two men passed him by, a priest and a Levite, who were respected members of the Jewish community. However, it was the Samaritan, who was considered a social outcast by the Jews, who came to the man's aid. He took care of his wounds, brought him to an inn, and paid for his care.

This story has many lessons that we can apply to our lives today, especially as Christian herbalists. We must be willing to help those who are hurting, regardless of their background, race, or religion. We must be knowledgeable, skilled, and well-trained to use herbs properly and safely for each situation. And we must be willing to use our own resources, time, and money to start and grow our healing ministries.

THINKING LIKE AN HERBALIST HOLISTICALLY

As herbalists, it is crucial that we have a comprehensive understanding of all the regulations, stage guidelines, local guidelines, and laws that are relevant to our practice of herbalist consulting. Being knowledgeable about these aspects of our profession allows us to provide the best possible service to our clients, while also ensuring that we are in compliance with all relevant requirements at all times. This includes being aware of any changes or updates to these guidelines over time, as well as staying up-to-date on any new laws or regulations that may be introduced. By staying informed and always striving to improve our knowledge of these critical aspects of our work, we can continue to grow as herbalists and provide the highest level of service to our clients.

In the beginning of this course, I mentioned holism. If you refer back to that, you'll see that it starts with the whole person, including the physical body, the soul, and the spirit. A person has three parts but one body. Balancing these parts can be challenging without the help of the Holy Spirit. As I mentioned earlier, a Christian is a temple of the Holy Spirit.

In my theory of holism, the physical body's foundation is the gut, while the soul's foundation is the mind (the heart of the soul). For the spiritual foundation, it is the inner heart that no man knows but God. The inner heart represents the true essence of oneself without the contribution of other members. It is important for this inner heart to be a temple of the Holy Ghost, and for our physical and soul aspects to be brought into subjection daily.

As an herbalist, we consider the wholeness of a person, the constituents of herbs, and the anatomy and physiology of the human body. We also take into consideration the mind and soul, examining how each functions and whether there is a balance that needs to be restored. This may involve creating a pathway for healing, renewal, and restoration, which can be facilitated by applying the atonement of the blood of Jesus, the life giving blood.

I encourage you to learn about the body's physiological processes and relate them to the teachings of God's word. Many scriptures offer insights on various parts of the body. As an herbalist, it is important to understand the relationship between herbs' constituents, phytonutrients, and their effects on the human body. You should know how the brain communicates with the body, how the veins supply blood, how the vertebrae reflect the mind's thoughts, and more. Even the smallest details in pathways can be the key to providing clients with effective herbal preparations.

An herbalist can rely on many resources when it comes to protocols for herbal preparations. A protocol is a guide to follow for each body system, detailing which herb to use, what preparation method to use, what process to follow, and what to formulate. Alternatively, one can simply follow a trusted, experienced herbalist's recipes.

In the next part I will generally introduce a few common protocols for you to follow. I have a few wholeness wheels of protocol for you to include in your journals as an E-Book. These wheels were designed as quick easy-read sheets that you can glance at then create an herbal preparation. Keep in mind that the wholeness wheels will mention Backyard Herbs & Kitchen Herbs that I use personally and not necessarily western or TCM Herbs.

HOLISTIC METHOD

Holistic methods aim to support the whole person, not just their symptoms. Holistic consultants take into consideration the person's physical, emotional, and spiritual well-being when creating a suggestive care plan. By focusing on the root cause of the illness, rather than just the symptoms, holistic consultants strive to restore balance and harmony to the body. Balancing the tri-parted man which includes the spirit, the soul (mind, will, emotions, & senses), and the physical body (the flesh). This includes addressing lifestyle factors such as diet, exercise, and stress management, in addition to 'pharma' medical treatments.

Holistic consultants recognize that the body has an innate ability to heal itself for that is the way that God designed the body. Furthermore as a Christian that believes that the strips that Jesus bore was for our healing not just spiritually but also physically. Rather than solely relying on medication or invasive treatments, holistic consultants work with the body's natural healing processes to facilitate optimal health. This can include the use of natural remedies, such as herbals, foods, and supplements.

As a believer, I also acknowledge the role of God in the healing process. I believe that Jesus' blood has the power to heal and that prayer can be an important component of a holistic suggested care plan. By addressing the physical, emotional, and spiritual aspects of a person, holistic methods can provide a more comprehensive and effective approach to healing.

In addition to these practices, holistic consultants often encourage patients to engage in mindfulness and meditation activities of reading God's word & prayer sessions. These practices help to reduce stress, promote mental clarity, and enhance emotional stability by renewing of the mind. Techniques such as simple physical & simple breathing exercises can also be integrated into a holistic suggested care plan, offering gentle ways to improve physical strength, flexibility, and overall well-being.

Community support and social connections are another vital aspect of holistic healing. Encouraging clients to build and maintain strong relationships can foster a sense of belonging and emotional support, which is crucial for mental health. Group therapy sessions, support groups, or even community-based activities can be beneficial.

Moreover, education plays a pivotal role in holistic health. Clients are often guided to understand their constitution of health & wellness and the importance of self-care. By providing knowledge and resources, holistic consultants empower individuals to take an active role in their healing journey.

Holistic methods truly encompass a wide range of practices and philosophies, all aimed at coaching the person as a whole. This integrative approach not only seeks to alleviate symptoms but also strives to nurture the body, mind, and spirit, ultimately leading to a more balanced and fulfilling life.

Holistic Christian Herbalist focus mostly on balancing the tri-parted man starting with the renewing of mind, forgiveness, repentance, deliverance, & then inner healing. This method not only addresses the spiritual man but also the soul which leads to the manifestation of healing for the physical body. Herbs, oils, foods, and supplements play a roll in allowing the tri-part man to begin the process of opening the soul for healing, regeneration of the flesh., and the renewing of the spirit.

HOLISTIC METHODS

Holistic methods aim to support the whole person, not just their symptoms. Holistic consultants take into consideration the person's physical, emotional, and spiritual well-being when creating a treatment plan. By focusing on the root cause of the illness, rather than just the symptoms, holistic consultants strive to restore balance and harmony to the body. This includes addressing lifestyle factors such as diet, exercise, and stress management, in addition to traditional medical treatments.

Furthermore, holistic consultants recognize that the body has an innate ability to heal itself. Rather than solely relying on medication or invasive treatments, holistic consultants work with the body's natural healing processes to facilitate recovery. This can include the use of natural remedies, such as herbal supplements or acupuncture.

As a believer, I also acknowledge the role of God in the healing process. I believe that Jesus' blood has the power to heal and that prayer can be an important component of a holistic treatment plan. By addressing the physical, emotional, and spiritual aspects of a person, holistic methods can provide a more comprehensive and effective approach to healing.

In addition to these practices, holistic consultants often encourage patients to engage in mindfulness and meditation activities. These practices help to reduce stress, promote mental clarity, and enhance emotional stability. Techniques such as yoga and tai chi can also be integrated into a holistic treatment plan, offering gentle ways to improve physical strength, flexibility, and overall well-being.

Community support and social connections are another vital aspect of holistic healing. Encouraging patients to build and maintain strong relationships can foster a sense of belonging and emotional support, which is crucial for mental health. Group therapy sessions, support groups, or even community-based activities can be beneficial.

Moreover, education plays a pivotal role in holistic health. Patients are often guided to understand their conditions and the importance of self-care. By providing knowledge and resources, holistic consultants empower individuals to take an active role in their healing journey.

Holistic methods truly encompass a wide range of practices and philosophies, all aimed at treating the person as a whole. This integrative approach not only seeks to alleviate symptoms but also strives to nurture the body, mind, and spirit, ultimately leading to a more balanced and fulfilling life.

MOST POPULAR CULINARY HERBS

Herbs have been treasured for their flavorful and medicinal qualities, enhancing the taste and aroma of our meals. Available in both fresh and dried forms, herbs can enrich dishes in delectable and healthy ways. Mastering their use is essential for culinary excellence. Dive into the world of cooking with herbs to learn about their characteristics, advantages, and ideal applications.

Herbs are a vital element of cooking, available throughout the year in fresh and dried varieties. Here are some of the most commonly used herbs in kitchens around the globe:

- Basil: With its sweet, fragrant aroma, basil is a perfect match for Mediterranean dishes, particularly in tomato-based recipes like bruschetta.
- Rosemary: The strong, pine-like flavor of rosemary pairs beautifully with poultry and grilled vegetables, adding a Mediterranean touch to meals.
- Thyme: This herb's subtle mix of earthy and citrus notes enhances a wide range of dishes, from hearty stews to delicate seafood.
- Parsley: Known for its crisp taste, parsley not only boosts flavor but also adds a pop of color as a garnish.
- Cilantro: A favorite in many international cuisines, cilantro's zesty flavor brightens up dishes such as salsa and curry.
- Mint: Celebrated for its refreshing taste, mint's cooling properties complement both sweet and savory dishes.
- Dill: Dill's delicate, feathery leaves bring subtle yet distinctive flavors, elevating sauces and pickled items.
- Oregano: A staple in Mediterranean cooking, oregano's strong, peppery flavor enhances pizzas and pasta dishes.
- Bay Laurel: Often overlooked, bay leaves provide a gentle, aromatic flavor to slow-cooked meals like soups and sauces.
- Sage: With its earthy aroma and slightly bitter taste, sage adds unique flavor to savory recipes, especially in stuffing and risotto.

COOKING WITH HERBS

Benefits of Adding Herbs to Meals

Incorporating herbs into your daily meals—from breakfast to dinner, snacks, and drinks—offers a host of benefits, including:

- Enhanced flavor: Herbs introduce complex tastes, transforming simple meals into culinary delights.
- Nutritional boost: Packed with antioxidants, vitamins, and minerals, herbs provide numerous health benefits, such as reducing inflammation and supporting heart health.
- Digestive aid: Some herbs, like basil and oregano, not only enhance flavor but also support digestion and gut health.
- Versatility: Herbs can be used in a wide array of dishes, from appetizers to desserts, appealing to various tastes and cooking styles.

Proper storage methods for herbs can heighten their benefits while ensuring food safety.

How to Use Fresh vs. Dried Herbs

Did you know?

As a general guideline, use about one-third the quantity of dried herbs when substituting for fresh herbs in recipes.

While adding herbs to your dishes is usually straightforward, knowing the differences between fresh and dried herbs can help maximize their flavor and aroma in your cooking.

Fresh Herbs

Fresh herbs like cilantro, parsley, and dill provide an explosion of flavor and aroma. They are best added at the end of cooking or used as garnishes to maintain their vibrant qualities.

- Pros: Bright flavors, vivid colors, aromatic, ideal for quick-cooking recipes
- Cons: Short shelf life, can wilt quickly, seasonal availability

Dried Herbs

Dried herbs often have a more concentrated flavor and aroma, meaning you'll use less compared to fresh herbs. They are particularly effective in slow-cooked dishes like stews and soups, allowing their flavors to develop over time. To release their flavor, add dried herbs early in the cooking process.

- Pros: Longer shelf life, intense flavor, convenient and widely available
- Cons: Less vibrant color, may lose potency if not stored properly

COOKING WITH HERBS

Tips for Adding Herbs to Everyday Meals

With their variety of flavors and aromas, herbs can challenge even experienced cooks. The following tips can help you integrate them more easily into your cooking:

- Fresh garnishes: Just before serving, sprinkle freshly chopped parsley or cilantro on your dish to maintain their flavor and freshness in presentation.
- Infused oils and vinegars: Steep fresh herbs like rosemary, thyme, or basil in olive oil or vinegar for an added flavor boost in dressings and marinades.
- Herb butter: Combine finely chopped fresh herbs into softened butter for a tasty topping on grilled meats, roasted vegetables, or bread.
- Herb pesto: Beyond basil, try using other herbs like cilantro, mint, or parsley for a versatile pesto sauce.
- Herb-infused water or tea: Add fresh herbs like mint or basil to water and chill in the fridge for a refreshing drink.
- Herb salad dressings: Blend fresh herbs with olive oil, vinegar, mustard, and honey for a delightful dressing that enhances salads.

Exploring different herbs can enrich your culinary skills, introducing exciting flavor profiles to your dishes. Whether sourced from your thriving herb garden or your pantry's dried collection, meals infused with herbs highlight a diverse range of flavors and culinary creativity, ensuring a satisfying dining experience with every bite.

TOP 6 CULINARY/MEDICINAL HERBS & SPICES

When it comes to stocking your kitchen with essential spices, there are a few key items you don't want to be without. Of course, we all have our own personal preferences, but if you're looking for a great starting point, here are six spices that are sure to add flavor and depth to a wide variety of dishes:

1. Basil - This aromatic herb is a staple in many Italian dishes, and is also a key ingredient in many pesto recipes. Its sweet, slightly peppery flavor is also great in soups, salads, and stir-fries.
2. Cinnamon - Whether you're making sweet or savory dishes, cinnamon is a versatile spice that can add warmth and depth to your recipes. Sprinkle it on oatmeal, add it to roasted vegetables, or mix it with sugar and use it to top your morning toast.
3. Garlic - Known for its pungent smell and flavor, garlic is a must-have in any kitchen. Use it to add depth to pasta sauces, stir-fries, and roasted meats and vegetables.
4. Ginger - This spicy root is a staple in many Asian cuisines, and is also great in sweet dishes like gingerbread and pumpkin pie. It's also great in tea, and can help soothe an upset stomach.
5. Rosemary - This fragrant herb has a woody, slightly bitter flavor that pairs well with roasted meats and vegetables. It's also great in breads and savory baked goods.
6. Turmeric - This bright yellow spice has a warm, slightly bitter flavor that's great in curries, roasted vegetables, and rice dishes. It's also known for its anti-inflammatory properties, making it a great addition to any healthy diet.

BIOLOGY OF HERBS

HERB SUBSTANCES

Herbs are a wonderful and natural source of plant-based nutrition. Within our world, there are a vast array of herbal alternative systems that have been developed throughout history. For instance, some popular types of these systems include European, Native American, Chinese, Ayurvedic, and Western herbalism. All of these systems share a common approach to treating the body as a whole and use the energy of herbs to work in synergy with the natural energy in each individual.

The benefits of incorporating herbs into your daily routine are truly remarkable. By utilizing herbs, you can provide your body with a natural, vital energy to do things you enjoy while also supporting your body's innate immune system. Furthermore, herbs are often high in vitamins, minerals, and other nutrients that nourish and build the body. By consuming herbs, you can also provide your body with the extra support it needs to aid in the normal functions of the human body.

One of the most fascinating things about herbs is how they absorb substances from the soil and convert them into essential nutrients such as vitamins, minerals, carbohydrates, proteins, and fats. These vital nutrients are what our bodies use for nourishment and natural healing. By utilizing whole herbs, we are able to take in all of the vital ingredients they carry. Most herbs contain several active substances, one of which usually dominates and determines its choice as an herbal alternative.

In conclusion, herbs are an incredibly diverse and powerful tool for promoting overall health and well-being. By incorporating herbal alternatives into your daily routine, you can help nourish your body with the vital nutrients it needs to thrive.

BIOLOGICAL BACKGROUND

All plants produce chemical compounds as part of their normal metabolic activities. These compounds can be split into sugars and fats, which are found in all plants, and active components, referred to earlier.

Furthermore, these active components can be found in various parts of the plant, such as leaves, stems, and flowers. For example, some herbs act as toxins to defend against prey or to attract insects for pollination. The Indian Blanket Flower, a type of herb, has little-known medicinal properties but can also repel deer from a garden if planted near the perimeter.

In addition, these active components can have therapeutic actions in humans and can be refined or synthesized to produce drugs. Inulin, for instance, is found in many plants and is the basis of insulin, which is used to manage diabetes. Quinine, derived from the bark of the cinchona tree, is used to treat malaria. Morphine and codeine, both derived from the poppy plant, are used to alleviate pain. Digoxin, found in the foxglove plant, is used to treat heart conditions.

Therefore, it is important to recognize the various functions of these chemical compounds produced by plants and their potential benefits in human health and medicine.

Moreover, the use of plant-derived drugs has a long history in traditional medicine. For example, Native Americans have used the bark of the willow tree, which contains salicylic acid, to relieve pain and fever. Today, salicylic acid is a key ingredient in aspirin, a widely used pain reliever.

Similarly, Chinese traditional medicine has long used ginkgo biloba, a tree native to China, to treat various ailments. Studies have shown that ginkgo biloba extract may improve cognitive function and alleviate symptoms of anxiety and depression.

In recent years, there has been a growing interest in plant-derived drugs as a source of new medications. Researchers are exploring the potential of thousands of plant species and their chemical compounds for various medical applications, such as cancer treatment, pain relief, and anti-inflammatory drugs.

However, it is important to note that plant-derived drugs can have side effects and may interact with other medications. Therefore, it is essential to consult a healthcare professional before using any plant-derived drugs or supplements.

In conclusion, the chemical compounds produced by plants have a wide range of functions and potential benefits in human health and medicine. With further research and development, plant-derived drugs may offer new solutions to various medical challenges.

HERBS WORKING SYNERGISTICALLY

Herbs work together synergistically, so combining them can enhance each herb's properties and bring greater support to the body. For instance, a good mixture to promote relaxation combines Passiflora, valerian, and hops. All three herbs have relaxant properties, but Passiflora specializes in aiding sleep, valerian relaxes muscle tension, and hops have a marked effect on relaxing the nervous system.

Herbs have been used for centuries to promote health and wellness in individuals. It is well-known that combining herbs can enhance their properties and bring greater support to the body. In fact, the synergistic effect of combining different herbs has been noted to be much more effective than using a single herb alone.

For instance, a good mixture to promote relaxation combines Passiflora, valerian, and hops. All three herbs have relaxant properties, but Passiflora specializes in aiding sleep, valerian relaxes muscle tension, and hops have a marked effect on relaxing the nervous system. The combination of these herbs thus provides an overall enhanced benefit for relaxation and stress-reduction.

Moreover, the use of herbal remedies has been gaining popularity in recent years due to their natural and safe effects on the body. The increasing demand for these remedies has led to more research and studies being conducted on the benefits of herbs. This has resulted in the discovery of new combinations of herbs that can provide relief for a variety of health issues such as anxiety, insomnia, and depression.

It is important to note, however, that the use of herbs should always be done with caution and under the guidance of a healthcare professional. While herbs are generally considered safe, they can interact with certain medications and cause adverse effects. Therefore, it is crucial to consult a healthcare professional before trying any new herbal remedy or combining different herbs.

In herbology, herbs are believed to have varying combinations and degrees of qualities. For instance, an herb can be both heating and drying, or heating and moistening. Alternatively, it can be cooling and drying, or cooling and moistening. Furthermore, one herb can be very warming, while another may be only slightly warming. However, both are still considered heating herbs.

Assigning qualities to plants is a simple process. Heating herbs, such as anise and caraway, are believed to produce warmth in the body. Similarly, all aromatic herbs are considered warming. Many bitter herbs, like Oregon grape, are also classified as heating.

Herbs that contain highly volatile oils, such as wintergreen or spearmint, are classified as cooling. Borage is another example of a cooling herb, which is also known as a refrigerant.

Whether an herb is classified as moistening or drying depends on its individual properties. An herb that increases urination, such as bearberry, is considered drying. Astringent herbs, like oak bark or sage, are also called drying. Usually, aromatics like anise or caraway are thought of as drying, but there are exceptions. Fennel, for example, is regarded as moistening because it is said to increase milk production in lactating women. An herb is also considered moistening if it is mucilaginous or demulcent, meaning it has soothing properties. Flax seed, marshmallow, licorice, and slippery elm are good examples of this type of moistening herb.

European herbalists developed a better understanding of herbal properties by identifying which parts of the body were influenced by each herb. They defined specific "centers of activity" in the body for each herb. For example, cayenne pepper, which is classified as a heating herb, affects the circulatory system by increasing the flow of blood, especially to the capillaries near the surface of the skin. This may explain why people who live in hot climates use hot peppers in their cooking. The peppers may help dissipate body heat by circulating it to the skin surface, where it causes cooling as perspiration evaporates and heat radiates into the surrounding air

BIOCHEMISTRY AND PHYTOCHEMISTRY

Biochemistry is the study of chemical processes and substances that occur within living organisms. It explores the molecular mechanisms that underpin biological functions, including metabolism, enzyme action, and DNA replication. Biochemistry bridges the fields of biology and chemistry, providing insights into how life operates at a molecular level.

Phytochemistry, a sub-discipline of biochemistry, focuses on the chemical compounds found in plants. It investigates the roles of these compounds in plant biology and their potential applications in medicine, nutrition, and industry. Phytochemicals are often responsible for the color, flavor, and defense mechanisms of plants, and many have been harnessed for medicinal purposes.

Common Medicinal Herbs and Their Origins

1. Garlic (Allium sativum)
   - Phytochemicals: Allicin, Alliin
   - Uses: Known for its antibacterial and antiviral properties, garlic has been used traditionally to boost the immune system and lower blood pressure.
2. Thyme (Thymus vulgaris)
   - Phytochemicals: Thymol, Carvacrol
   - Uses: Possesses strong antiseptic properties and has been used to treat respiratory infections and bronchitis.
3. Lavender (Lavandula angustifolia)
   - Phytochemicals: Linalool, Linalyl acetate
   - Uses: Renowned for its calming and relaxing effects, lavender is used to alleviate anxiety, depression, and insomnia.
4. Echinacea (Echinacea purpurea)
   - Phytochemicals: Flavonoids, Cichoric acid
   - Uses: Widely used as a natural remedy to enhance immune function and reduce symptoms of colds and flu.
5. St. John's Wort (Hypericum perforatum)
   - Phytochemicals: Hypericin, Hyperforin
   - Uses: Traditionally used to treat mild to moderate depression and mood disorders.
6. Ginseng (Panax ginseng)
   - Phytochemicals: Ginsenosides, Gintonin
   - Uses: Used for its adaptogenic properties, ginseng helps improve stamina, concentration, and overall vitality.
7. Licorice (Glycyrrhiza glabra)
   - Phytochemicals: Glycyrrhizin, Flavonoids
   - Uses: Known for its anti-inflammatory and soothing properties, licorice is used in treating ulcers and sore throats.
8. Valerian (Valeriana officinalis)
   - Phytochemicals: Valerenic acid, Valepotriates
   - Uses: Valerian is used to promote relaxation and improve sleep quality.

These herbs and their phytochemicals have been integral to traditional medicine systems around the world. The study of their biochemistry continues to reveal new applications and benefits, bridging ancient practices with modern scientific research.

CHEMISTRY OF HERBS

CHEMISTRY OF HERBS

An herbalist only needs to have a basic understanding of the pharmacology of herbs, which are used for their phytochemicals. Scientists have studied the components of herbs extensively, organizing them according to chemical groups. Herbs contain a wide variety of chemicals, such as water, inorganic salts, sugars, carbohydrates, proteins, and alkaloids, to name a few.

Organic acids, including citric acid and chain acids, are found in herbs. Plant acids like valeric acid have sedative properties, while ring acids like benzoic acid have antiseptic properties and are found in foods like cranberries, resins, and balsams. Alcohol is also found in herbs, usually in the form of volatile oils or sterols, such as geraniol in attar of rose and menthol in peppermint oil. Volatile oils, which are a combination of molecules like isoprene or isopentane, are mostly found in aromatic plants and are used to manufacture perfumes. Aromatic oils like eucalyptus oil, garlic oil, and thyme oil are antiseptics.

Carbohydrates are found in a variety of foods, including sugar, fructose, glucose, and starches. Pectin in fruits, algin in seaweeds, gums, and mucilage like coltsfoot, plantain, and marshmallow are also carbohydrates. Phenolic compounds, which are found in plants, function as antiseptics, painkillers, and anti-inflammatories, such as salicylic acid. Tannins in herbs act as astringents to protect the skin and mucous membrane and are also used for external applications like treating burns, healing wounds, and reducing inflammation. Coumarins, found in plants like rhubarb, yellow dock, senna, aloe, and buckthorn, are laxatives and natural dyes. Flavones and flavonoids glycosides, found in buckwheat, bioflavonoid, milk thistle, and other plants, can act as anti-spasmodics, diuretics, circulatory and cardiac stimulants. Saponins, found in primrose, mullein, violet, daisy, and other plants, are utilized in the synthesis of cortisone as well as sex hormones. Cardiac glycosides, found in the lily of the valley, squill, foxglove, and strophanthus family, are made of a mixture of sugar and steroidal aglycone. Bitter principles, found in hops, valerian, white horehound, devil's claw, marigold, and other plants, have properties like sedatives, cough remedies, and anti-inflammatory herbs. Finally, alkaloids are the most powerful group of plant components and are found in most herbs, storing excessive nitrogen.

HERBS ARE NOT DRUG SUBSTITUTES!

As more people become aware of the dangerous side-effects of drugs, and with increased awareness of natural and herbal supplements, I am often asked to recommend a natural or herbal supplement as an alternative to a drug.

It is important to note that herbs do not replace prescription or OTC drugs. Herbs and supplements take a while to build up in the body's system in order to provide support, whereas prescription and OTC drugs work quickly. This course is not intended to suggest or recommend any natural or herbal substitute for prescription or OTC drugs. However, a holistic nutritional and health plan can help the body start to heal itself and, hopefully, reduce the need for OTC drugs, or at least the majority of them.

Drugs cover up or suppress symptoms without curing or changing the root cause of the illness. With the symptoms suppressed, the disease or illness is allowed to progress in a modified way.

Natural suggestions and herbal supplements, when used correctly, can address the root cause of the symptoms. Most natural remedies or herbs are not great at suppressing symptoms, and for this reason, they are considered a slower method and a poor substitute for prescription drugs. However, with time, dedication, prayer, and the holistic health and nutrition plan, herbs can support and aid the body in providing the foundation for it to begin to heal itself.

Natural preparations and herbal supplements should be used as part of a complete natural nutrition holistic program that includes lifestyle and diet changes designed to improve overall health. The overall plan should be a special, systemized natural health plan that is created for each individual's needs. The whole individual is supported, meaning the soul, mind, will, emotions, and flesh, not just the symptoms. This is known as "holism."

IS THERE A DIFFERENCE BETWEEN A DRUG AND A MEDICINAL HERB?

Yes, an herb is a plant that is used for medicinal purposes and is prepared in a specific manner. A drug is a synthesized or man-made copy of one chemical component found in a medicinal herb, produced by a chemical process. In this lesson, you will review these components.

Some herbalists prefer using the whole herb, meaning all parts of the plant - the roots, fruit, petals, leaves, etc. They believe that using the natural material helps the body digest and absorb the herbs, resulting in fewer side-effects.

Believe it or not, synthetic drugs can be derived from herbs. Aspirin, for example, came from white willow bark, as did many others. Nowadays, aspirin is synthesized to produce the drug in mass quantities and for longer shelf life, rather than relying on your own white willow tree in your front yard and preparing the bark as needed.

Herbs contain hundreds or even thousands of naturally occurring chemical components. Scientists and herbalists often use the phrase "active component" to refer to the "active" ingredient of an herb. This is useful to scientists when standardizing an herb or when testing it for quality.

Pharmaceutical companies may make the mistake of extracting only the active component from a herb, without extracting the herb's other naturally occurring ingredients, or making a synthetic copy of the active component. The true "three-fold" (meaning having several parts, or, in this case, several active and non-active components that work together) active ingredients may not be present to interact with each other. As a result, the final product may be far from what nature produced and may cause side effects. This is why different pharmaceutical companies have different production processes.

CONSTITUENTS & PHYTONUTRIENTS OF HERBS

CONSTITUENTS AND ACTIVE PRINCIPLES

The distinction between primary and secondary plant metabolism is important in understanding the functions of different plant substances. While primary metabolism products maintain vital plant functions, secondary metabolism products have a protective function against damage, waste storage, and pest and disease control. Some secondary plant substances are also pharmacologically active, making them useful in the development of drugs.

It is worth noting that, while carbohydrates, fats, and proteins are important nutrients for humans and animals, they are not frequently used as pharmacologically active substances. However, they can still have an impact on the efficacy of active principles in drugs.

Secondary plant substances serve a variety of functions. For example, many protect plants from pests, store waste products or act as waste products. Others are pharmacologically active and have potential for use in medicines.

Examples of primary metabolism products include pectins, which are carbohydrates found in many kinds of fruit, especially when unripe. They have a high water-binding capacity and cannot be digested by endogenous intestinal juices. Pectins are useful in the treatment of diarrhea because they lower the pH of the bowel and encourage the growth of beneficial bacteria while producing less favorable living conditions for the pathological bacteria that cause diarrhea. Essential omega-3 and omega-6 fatty acids are fats used in the synthesis of tissue hormones of the eicosanoid, prostaglandin, and thromboxane groups. These hormones are involved in inflammation and related symptoms.

Secondary metabolism products come in many forms. Alkaloids, for example, are pharmacologically active substances found in nightshades such as belladonna, bittersweet, and thornapple, but also in papaveraceae plants (opium poppy, greater celandine), the borage family (coltsfoot, comfrey), and the spea family (Crotalaria). Essential oils, on the other hand, are complex mixtures of compounds found in a variety of plants such as conifers and members of the mint and parsley families. They are used in bath salts and liniments.

Other examples of secondary metabolism products include bitter substances, carotenoids, flavonoids, tannins, glycosides, phytosterols, saponins, mucilage, and mustard oils. Bitter substances stimulate the reflex production of gastrointestinal secretions via lingual taste buds and are indicated for the treatment of dyspeptic complaints and to stimulate appetite and improve digestion and assimilation of nutrients. Carotenoids act as antioxidants and immunomodulators and are vitamin A precursors. Flavonoids have a nonspecific protective effect on the capillaries, stabilize the cell membrane, and have anticonvulsant and diuretic effects, making them useful in the treatment of varicose veins, inflammations, edema, dyspeptic complaints, liver disorders, and to stimulate bile secretion. Tannins, on the other hand, irreversibly link protein chains and have an astringent action on the skin and mucous membranes. They have anti-inflammatory, styptic, counterirritant, and weakly antibacterial effects and prevent the excess secretion of mucus. They are indicated for irritations of the skin and mucous membranes and for acute nonspecific diarrhea. Glycosides contain one or multiple sugar molecules as well as a nonsugar component that determines their pharmacological activity. They are indicated for cardiac failure, constipation, and to improve the circulation. Phytosterins occupy cholesterol receptors and thus lower cholesterol levels. They also stabilize cell walls and inhibit the synthesis of mediators of inflammation. They are indicated to counteract elevated concentrations of lipids and for treatment of benign prostatic hyperplasia. Saponins induce local tissue irritation and reflex expectoration, inhibit the growth of microorganisms, especially fungi, and have partial anti-inflammatory and antiedematous effects. They are indicated to emulsify watery and oily solutions and to promote the dissolution of substances that are not easily absorbed. Mucilage is used to soothe irritated mucous membranes of the mouth, throat, and gastrointestinal tract, to alleviate dry cough, and to regulate the bowels. Mustard oils have antibacterial effects and induce hyperemia of the skin, making them useful in external applications to increase blood flow.

PHYTONUTRIENTS

Phytonutrients are an essential class of protective compounds found in plants that play a vital role in human health. These compounds are present in a wide range of plant-based foods, including herbs, spices, alliums, fruits, and vegetables. They are believed to have health-promoting properties, such as antioxidant and anti-inflammatory effects, which can help reduce the risk of chronic diseases.

Studies have shown that phytonutrients are more beneficial when consumed in whole food and plant form, such as herbs and spices, as opposed to isolated supplements. Whole foods and plants are rich in a variety of phytonutrients that work synergistically to provide optimal health benefits.

Phytonutrients are responsible for giving plants their vibrant colors, which makes them easy to spot in fruits and vegetables. However, they are also present in white foods, such as garlic, onions, and leeks, which are often overlooked as sources of phytonutrients. Consuming a variety of colorful fruits and vegetables is important to obtain a wide range of phytonutrients, which cannot be obtained solely from fruits and vegetables.

In conclusion, phytonutrients are essential compounds that play a crucial role in human health. It is important to consume a variety of plant-based foods in order to obtain the full range of health benefits associated with phytonutrients.

HERBS, SPICES & PHYTONUTRIENTS

This document is a comprehensive list of various compounds found in foods and supplements that are believed to have health benefits. These compounds are known as phytonutrients and can be found in a wide variety of plant-based foods, including fruits, vegetables, herbs, and spices.
Phytonutrients are beneficial for health because they have antioxidant and anti-inflammatory properties, which can help reduce the risk of chronic diseases such as cancer, cardiovascular disease, and diabetes.
Below is a list of some of the most common phytonutrients and their benefits:

- Anthocyanins: Found in berries, cherries, and grapes, these compounds are believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of heart disease, cancer, and cognitive decline.
- Flavanols: Found in cocoa, tea, and wine, these compounds are believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of heart disease, stroke, and cognitive decline.
- Flavones: Found in parsley, thyme, and celery, these compounds are believed to have anti-inflammatory properties that may help reduce the risk of heart disease, cancer, and diabetes.
- Isoflavones: Found in soybeans, these compounds are believed to have estrogen-like effects that may help reduce the risk of breast cancer and osteoporosis.
- Rosemarinic acid: Found in rosemary and sage, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and Alzheimer's disease.
- Kaempferol: Found in kale, broccoli, and green tea, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and heart disease.
- Resveratrol: Found in red wine, grapes, and peanuts, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of heart disease, cancer, and Alzheimer's disease.
- Apigenin: Found in parsley and celery, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Carbazole alkaloid: Found in curry leaves, this compound is believed to have antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer.
- Zeaxanthin: Found in egg yolks and green vegetables, this compound is believed to have antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of age-related macular degeneration.
- Capsaicin: Found in chili peppers, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Curcumin: Found in turmeric, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and Alzheimer's disease.
- Gingerol: Found in ginger, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Daidzein: Found in soybeans, this compound is believed to have estrogen-like effects that may help reduce the risk of breast cancer and osteoporosis.
- Genistein: Found in soybeans, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and heart disease.
- Lycopene: Found in tomatoes, this compound is believed to have antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.

HERBS, SPICES & PHYTONUTRIENTS..

- Cinnamic acid: Found in cinnamon, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Piperine: Found in black pepper, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and Alzheimer's disease.
- Catechins: Found in green tea, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Ellagic acid: Found in berries, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Sulforaphane: Found in broccoli and other cruciferous vegetables, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Thymoquinone: Found in black seed oil, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer.
- Cyanidin: Found in berries, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Carotenoids: Found in carrots, sweet potatoes, and other orange and yellow vegetables, these compounds are believed to have antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Anethole: Found in anise, fennel, and licorice, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Myricetin: Found in berries, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Diosgenin: Found in yams, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Silybin: Found in milk thistle, this compound is believed to have antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of liver damage.
- Lignans: Found in flaxseed, sesame seeds, and whole grains, these compounds are believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Eugenol: Found in cloves and cinnamon, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.
- Coumarin: Found in cinnamon and other spices, this compound is believed to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties that may help reduce the risk of cancer and cardiovascular disease.

Incorporating a variety of these phytonutrients into your diet may help you achieve optimal health and reduce your risk of chronic disease.

THE ACTIONS OF HERBS

If you find it difficult to pronounce these words, use Google Lens to read them to you or simply Google the word for its pronunciation. Don't focus too much on this in the beginning of your studies.

Alterative

Alternatives are herbs that will gradually restore the function of the body. They were at one time known as 'blood cleansers'.

Bladderwrack • Bloodroot • Blue Flag • Bogbean • Burdock • Cleavers • Echinacea • Figwort • Fringetree • Fumitory • Garlic • Guaiacum • Goldenseal • Mountain Grape • Nettles • Pasque Flower • Poke Root • Queen's Delight • Red Clover • Sarsaparilla • Sassafras • Wild Indigo • Yellow Dock.

Analgesic, Anodyne

Analgesics are herbs that reduce pain and are either applied externally or internally.

Figwort • Hops • Jamaican Dogwood • Lady's Slipper • Passion Flower • Poppy • Skullcap • St. John's Wort • Valerian.

Anthelmintic

Anthelmintics will destroy or expel worms from the digestive system.

Aloes • Garlic • Pomegranate • Tansy • Thuja • Wormwood • Rue.

Antibilious

The antibilious herbs help the body to remove excess bile.

Balmony • Barberry • Dandelion • Fringetree • Goldenseal • Mugwort • Vervain • Wild Yam • Wormwood.

Anticatarrhal

The anticatarrhal herbs help the body to remove excess catarrhal buildups.

Bearberry • Boneset • Cayenne • Coltsfoot • Cranesbill • American Echinacea • Elder • Elecampane • Eyebright • Garlic • Goldenseal • Goldenrod • Hyssop • Iceland Moss • Irish Moss • Marshmallow • Mullein • Peppermint • Sage • Thyme • Wild Indigo • Yarrow.

Antiemetic

The anti-emetics can reduce a feeling of nausea and may help to relieve or to prevent vomiting.

Balm • Black Horehound • Cayenne • Cloves • Dill • Fennel • Lavender • Meadowsweet • Peach Leaves Ginger

Anti-inflammatory

The anti-inflammatory herbs help the body to help with inflammation. Reduce inflammation due to fluid build up.

Black Willow • Bogbean • Chamomile • Devil's Claw • Marigold • St. John's Wort • White Poplar • Witch Hazel.

Anti-lithic

The antilithic herbs prevent the formation of stones or gravel in the urinary system and can help the body in their removal.

Bearberry • Buchu • Cornsilk • Couch Grass • Gravel Root • Hydrangea • Pellitory of the Wall • Parsley • Sea Holly • Stone Root • Wild Carrot.

Anti-microbial

The anti-microbial herbs can help the body to destroy or resist pathogenic microorganisms.

Aniseed • Balsam of Peru • Bearberry • Caraway Oil • Cayenne • Clove • Coriander • Echinacea • Elecampane • Eucalyptus • Garlic • Gentian • Juniper • Marigold • Marjoram • Myrrh • Olive • Peppermint • Plantain • Rosemary • Rue • Sage • Southernwood • Thyme • Wild Indigo • Wormwood.

Antispasmodic

The anti-spasmodics can prevent or ease spasms or cramps in the body.

Black Haw • Black Cohosh • Chamomile • Cramp Bark • Eucalyptus • Lady's Slipper • Lime Blossom • Lobelia • Mistletoe • Motherwort • Pasque Flower • Skullcap • Skunk Cabbage • Thyme • Valerian • Vervain • Wild Lettuce • Wild Yam.

Aperient

Aperient herbs are very mild laxatives.

See 'Laxatives

THE ACTIONS OF HERBS

Aromatic

The aromatic herbs have a strong and often pleasant odor and can stimulate the digestive system.

Aniseed •Chinese Angelica • Balm • Basil • Caraway • Cardamom • Celery • Chamomile • Cinnamon • Cloves • Coriander • Dill • Fennel • Hyssop • Ginger • Meadowsweet • Pennyroyal • Peppermint • Rosemary • Valerian • Wood Betony.

Astringent

Astringents bond with tissue by using proteins and can reduce secretions and discharges. They contain tannins.

Agrimony • Avens • Bayberry • Bearberry • Beth Root • Bistort • Black Catechu • Bugleweed • Cranesbill • Elecampane • Eyebright • Goldenrod • Ground Ivy • Kola • Lungwort • Meadowsweet • Mouse Ear • Mullein • Oak Bark • Periwinkle • Pilewort • Plantain • Ragwort • Raspberry • Sage • Rhubarb Root • Rosemary • Slippery Elm • St.John's Wort • Tormentil • Wild Cherry • Witch Hazel • Yarrow.

Bitter

Herbs that taste bitter act as stimulating tonics for the digestive system through a reflex of the taste buds and saliva.

Barberry • Boneset • Chamomile • Centaury • Gentian • Goldenseal • Hops • Rue • Southernwood • Tansy • Horehound • Wormwood.

Cardiac Tonic

Cardiac tonics affect the heart.

Broom • Bugleweed • Cayenne • Hawthorn • Lily of the Valley • Motherwort • Night Blooming Cereus.

Carminative

The carminatives are rich in volatile oils .

Chinese Angelica • Aniseed • Balm • Caraway • Cardamom • Cayenne • Cinnamon • Chamomile • Coriander • Dill • Fennel • Galangal • Garlic • Ginger • Hyssop • Juniper • Mustard • Peppermint • Sage • Thyme • Valerian.

Cholagogue

The cholagogues stimulate the release and secretion of bile from the gall-bladder, and act as a laxative.

Balmony • Barberry • Black Root • Blue Flag • Boldo • Dandelion • Fringetree • Fumitory • Gentian • Goldenseal • Mountain Grape • Wahoo • Wild Yam.

Demulcent

Demulcents are usually rich in mucilage .

Coltsfoot • Comfrey • Corn Silk • Couch Grass • Flaxseed • Irish Moss • Lungwort • Licorice • Mallow • Marshmallow • Mullein • Oatmeal • Parsley • Slippery Elm.

Diaphoretic

Diaphoretics aid the skin in the elimination of toxins and promote sweating.

Chinese Angelica • Bayberry • Black Cohosh • Boneset • Buchu • Cayenne • Chamomile • Elder • Fennel • Garlic • Ginger • Goldenrod • Guaiacum • Lime Blossom • Peppermint • Pleurisy Root • Prickly Ash • Thuja • Thyme • Horehound • Yarrow.

Diuretic

Diuretics increase the secretion and elimination of urine.

Agrimony • Bearberry • Blue Flag • Boldo • Boneset • Borage • Broom • Buchu • Bugleweed • Burdock • Celery Seed • Cleavers • Corn Silk • Couch Grass • Dandelion • Elder • Gravel Root • Hawthorn Berries • Juniper • Kola • Lily of the Valley • Lime Blossom • Night Blooming Cereus • Parsley • Pellitory of the Wall • Pumpkin Seed • Saw Palmetto • Sea Holly • Stone Root • Wild Carrot • Yarrow.

THE ACTIONS OF HERBS

Emetic

Emetics cause vomiting.

Balm • Bloodroot • Boneset • Catnip • Elder Flowers • Ipecacuanha • Lobelia • Senega • Squill.

Emmenagogue

Emmenagogues stimulate the female uterus.

Beth Root • Black Cohosh • Black Haw • Blessed Thistle • Blue Cohosh • Carline Thistle • Chamomile • Chaste Tree • Cramp Bark • False Unicorn Root • Fenugreek • Gentian • Ginger • Goldenseal • Juniper Berry • Lime • Marigold • Motherwort • Mugwort • Parsley • Pasque Flower • Pennyroyal • Peppermint • Raspberry • Rosemary • Rue • Sage • Shepherd's Purse • Southernwood • Squaw Vine • St. John's Wort • Tansy • Thyme • True Unicorn Root • Valerian • Vervain • Wormwood • Yarrow.

Emollient

Emollients are applied to the skin to soften, soothe or protect the skin.

Balm of Gilead • Borage • Chickweed • Coltsfoot • Comfrey • Elecampane • Fenugreek • Flaxseed • Licorice • Mallow • Marshmallow • Mullein • Plantain • Quince Seed • Rose Petals • Slippery Elm.

Expectorant

The expectorants support the body in the removal of excess amounts of mucus from the respiratory system.

Aniseed • Balm of Gilead • Balsam of Peru • Balsam of Tolu • Bloodroot • Coltsfoot • Comfrey • Elder Flower • Elecampane • Garlic • Goldenseal • Grindelia • Hyssop • Iceland Moss • Irish Moss • Licorice • Lobelia • Lungwort • Marshmallow • Mouse Ear • Mullein • Pleurisy Root • Senega • Skunk Cabbage • Squill • Thuja • Thyme • Vervain • Horehound • Wild Cherry.

Febrifuge • Antipyretic

The febrifuges help the body to bring down fevers.

Chinese Angelica • Balm • Blessed Thistle • Boneset • Borage • Cayenne • Elder Flower • Eucalyptus • Hyssop • Lobelia • Marigold • Onion Pennyroyal • Peppermint • Peruvian Bark • Plantain • Pleurisy Root • Prickly Ash • Raspberry • Sage • Thyme • Vervain.

Galactagogue

The galactogogues can help the breast-feeding mother to increase the flow of mother's milk.

Aniseed • Blessed Thistle • Centaury • Fennel • Goat's Rue • Raspberry • Vervain.

Hepatic

The hepatics aid the liver. Their use tones and strengthens it and increases the flow of bile from the liver.

Agrimony • Aloes • Balm • Balmony • Barberry • Black Root • Blue Flag • Boldo • Bogbean • Cascara Sagrada • Celery • Centaury • Cleavers • Dandelion • Elecampane • Fennel • Fringetree • Fumitory • Gentian • Goldenseal • Horseradish • Hyssop • Mountain Grape • Motherwort • Prickly Ash • Wahoo • Wild Indigo • Wild Yam • Wormwood • Yarrow • Yellow Dock.

Hypnotic

Hypnotics will induce sleep.

Hops • Jamaican Dogwood • Mistletoe • Passion Flower • Skullcap • Valerian • Wild Lettuce.

Laxative

The laxatives promote the elimination of the bowels.

Balmony • Barberry • Buckthorn • Burdock • Cascara Sagrada • Cleavers • Dandelion • Flaxseed • Fringetree • Mountain Grape • Pellitory of the Wall • Rhubarb Root • Senna • Wahoo • Yellow Dock.

Mucilage

The mucilaginous herbs contain gelatinous constituents and will often be demulcent and emollient.

Comfrey • Fenugreek • Flaxseed • Iceland Moss • Irish Moss • Mallow • Marshmallow • Quince Seed • Slippery Elm.

THE ACTIONS OF HERBS

Nervine

The nervines have a beneficial effect on the nervous system and tone and strengthen it. Some act as stimulants, some as relaxants.

Balm • Black Cohosh • Black Haw • Blue Cohosh • Bugleweed • Chamomile • Cramp Bark • Damiana • Ginseng • Hops • Kola • Lady's Slipper • Lavender • Lemon Balm • Lime • Lobelia • Mistletoe • Motherwort • Oats • Pasque Flower • Passion Flower • Peppermint • Red Clover • Rosemary • Skullcap • Tansy • Thyme • Valerian • Vervain • Wild Lettuce • Wormwood.

Oxytocic

The oxytocics stimulate the contraction of the uterus and can thereby help in childbirth.

Beth Root • Blue Cohosh • Goldenseal • Rue • Squaw Vine.

Pectoral

Pectorals have a general strengthening and healing effect on the respiratory system.

Aniseed • Chinese Angelica • Balm of Gilead • Balsam of Peru • Balsam of Tolu • Bloodroot • Coltsfoot • Comfrey • Elder • Elecampane • Garlic • Goldenseal • Horehound • Hyssop • Iceland Moss • Irish Moss • Licorice • Lungwort • Marshmallow • Mouse Ear • Mullein • Pleurisy Root • Senega • Skunk Cabbage • Vervain.

Rubefacient

When rubefacients are applied to the skin they cause a gentle local irritation and stimulate the dilation of the capillaries, thus increasing circulation in the skin.

Cayenne • Cloves • Garlic • Ginger • Horseradish • Mustard • Nettle • Peppermint • Rosemary • Rue.

Sedative

The sedatives calm the nervous system and reduce stress and nervousness throughout the body.

Black Cohosh • Black Haw • Bladderwrack • Blue Cohosh • Bloodroot • Boldo • Bugleweed • Chamomile • Cowslip • Cramp Bark • Hops • Jamaican Dogwood • Lady's slipper • Lobelia • Motherwort • Pasque Flower • Passion Flower • Red Clover • Red Poppy • Saw Palmetto • Skullcap • St. John's Wort • Valerian • Wild Cherry • Wild Lettuce • Wild Yam.

Sialagogue

The sialogogues stimulate the secretion of saliva from the salivary glands.

Bloodroot • Blue Flag • Cayenne • Centaury • Gentian • Ginger • Prickly Ash • Senega.

Soporific

The soporifics induce sleep.

Compare 'Hypnotics'.

Stimulant

Stimulants quicken and refresh the body, giving it a boost.

Chinese Angelica • Balm of Gilead • Balmony • Bayberry • Benzoin • Bladderwrack • Caraway • Cardamom • Cayenne • Cinnamon • Dandelion • Eucalyptus • Galangal • Garlic • Gentian • Ginseng • Gravel Root • Ground Ivy • Horehound • Horseradish • Juniper • Marigold • Mustard • Pennyroyal • Peppermint • Prickly Ash • Rosemary • Rue • Sage • Southernwood • Tansy • Wild Yam • Wormwood • Yarrow.

Styptic

Styptics reduce or stop external bleeding by their astringency.

THE ACTIONS OF HERBS

Tonic

The tonic herbs strengthen either certain organs or the entire body.

Agrimony • Chinese Angelica • Aniseed • Balm • Balmony • Bayberry • Bearberry • Beth Root • Bistort • Black Cohosh • Black Haw • Black Root • Bogbean • Boldo • Boneset • Buchu • Buckthorn • Bugleweed • Burdock • Calumba • Carline Thistle • Cayenne • Centaury • Chamomile • Cleavers • Coltsfoot • Comfrey • Condurango • Couch Grass • Cranesbill • Damiana • Dandelion • Echinacea • Elecampane • Eyebright • False UniCorn Root • Fringetree • Fumitory • Garlic • Gentian • Ginseng • Goldenseal • Gravel Root • Grindelia • Ground Ivy • Hawthorn • Horse Chestnut • Hydrangea • Hyssop • Iceland Moss • Lady's Slipper • Licorice • Lime • Marigold • Mistletoe • Motherwort • Mountain Grape • Mugwort • Mustard • Myrrh • Nettle • Oats • Parsley • Periwinkle • Poke Root • Raspberry • Red Clover • Rue • Sarsaparilla • Skullcap • Squaw Vine • Tamarind • Tansy • Thyme • Vervain • Virginia Snake Root • Wild Yam • Wood Betony • Wormwood • Yarrow • Yellow Dock.

Vulnerary

Vulneraries are applied externally and aid the body in the healing of wounds and cuts.

Aloes • Arnica • Bistort • Black Willow • Burdock • Calendula •Chickweed • Cleavers • Comfrey • Cranesbill • Daisy • Elder • Elecampane • Fenugreek • Flaxseed • Garlic • Goldenseal • Horsetail • Hyssop • Irish Moss • Marigold • Marshmallow • Mullein • Myrrh • Plantain • Poke Root • Shepherd's Purse • Slippery Elm • St. John's Wort • Thyme • Witch Hazel • Wood Betony • Yarrow.

SAFETY COMES FIRST- INDENTIFICATION

Safety Comes First: The Importance of Plant Identification

In the world of botany and herbal medicine, understanding the plants we interact with is crucial. Plants have been used for centuries to treat various ailments, enhance well-being, and even in culinary applications. However, with such a rich diversity of plant species, ensuring their correct identification is essential. Misidentifying a plant can lead to harmful or even toxic reactions, posing significant risks to health and safety.

Accurate plant identification is the foundation of safe and effective use. Many plants look similar but can have vastly different properties. For instance, some edible plants have toxic look-alikes that could cause severe illness if consumed. Thus, it's vital to develop the skills and knowledge necessary to distinguish between them.

There are several ways to ensure correct plant identification. Consulting reputable resources, such as plant guides, botanical databases, or seeking advice from experienced botanists and herbalists, can provide clarity. Additionally, taking note of key identifying features such as leaf shape, flower structure, and growth habits can aid in accurate recognition.

In summary, placing safety first by correctly identifying plants before use is an essential practice for anyone involved in their collection or usage. This precaution not only protects our health but also enriches our understanding and appreciation of the natural world.

There is a workbook please be sure to download it.

WHY STUDY BOTONY, TAXONOMY, & GROWING

Botanical Names

In this lesson we will introduce the terminology associated with the classification of plants. Such classification is called taxonomy or as some may say now systematic or as others would say nomenclature system.

Plants are classified according to their structure, function, and development. The system of organizing was developed in the 18th Century by the Swedish naturalist Carl von Linné (Linnaeus.) The highest classification according to the Linnaean system is the kingdom. The ladder of the plant kingdom is further divided as follows:

Division > Class > Order > Family > Genus > Species

These categories are sometimes divided further (e.g., subdivision, super class, subclass, subspecies, etc.) As an example, the taxonomic classification of a rose is presented below:

Kingdom: Plant
Division: Tracheophyta
Subdivision: Pteropsida
Superclass: Spermatophyta
Class: Angiospermae
Subclass: Dicotyledonae
Order: Rosales
Family: Rosaceae
Genus: Rosa
Species: Rosa multiflora

Note that the names of classes usually terminate with -ae, orders usually terminate with -ales, and families terminate with -aceae.

A species is always identified by two names; the botanical name and the species name. Botanical names are in Latin and are used all over the world. Such species names should always be either underlined or printed in italics and the first word, which always identifies the genus to which the species belongs, should be capitalized.

Now to some botanical names, scientific names can be overwhelming and confusing. So take your time and don't stress. Learning new botanical names can be frustrating and overwhelming the important thing to remember is that no one expects you to remember them all, so my advice to you is to make a botanical name journal or chart for you to keep on hand.

The Linnaean system of classification is used uniformly all over the world by most botanists, scientists, some herbalists, and so on. However the common names of plants are not. Common names are mostly used by laypersons. When we use only the common name, there can be room for misunderstanding. For example, there are many plants that are referred to as "honeysuckle." Honeysuckle is actually a family of plants (Caprifoliaceae family). To identify the exact plant, we must designate the genus and species. A lot of herbalists and lay persons are using the botanical name along with the common name.

WHY STUDY BOTONY, TAXONOMY, & GROWING

Some herbalists believe that all herbs in the same Genus or family have the same medicinal properties, however some herbalists do not. Now you may think that this isn't correct. For example if we look at the Chickweed species; common chickweed (Stelleria media), mouse-ear chickweed (Cerastium vulgatum), and the star chickweed (Stellaria pubera), they are from the Caryophyllaceae family, meaning the pink family, carnations. The chickweed holds very potent medicinal healing properties, however how do we know which one holds the strongest potency of the medicinal properties? This is where the view that some herbalists say that the 'chickweeds' can be all used for the same medicinal properties, the potency however is different. According to scientists the common chickweed has been tested and proven to hold the most medicinal properties. If you are uncertain about the scientific/botanical name of an herb please refer to the reference books and course books for the specific name to be used.

The English language contains many words from Latin. As a result, some of the Latin names will look familiar, and a few will be quite recognizable, and some will not. For example, let's take the Red Clover (Trifolium pretense), the English word "foliage" comes from the Latin, folium, meaning "leaf." When we see the botanical name for red clover, Trifolium pratense, it will not be hard to figure out that this is a three-leafed plant. Red clover indeed has 3 leaves, tri- meaning 3, and folium meaning leaf, so put it together and you have a 3 leaved plant.

I can not include all of the Latin used in naming herbs. One word that you will often see in the species name is officinalis. Officinalis means medicine, so anytime you see this in a scientific/botanical name remember this herb has been tested, and studied to show it contains medicinal properties.

Some examples are:

Althaea officinalis (marshmallow)
Calendula officinalis (garden marigold)
Euphrasia officinalis (eyebright)
Morinda officinalis (Morinda or noni)
Smilax officinalis (sarsaparilla)
Taraxacum officinalis (dandelion)
Valeriana officinalis (valerian)

The Latin annuum, meaning "annual" (living only one year, or one plant season) also appears commonly in botanical names. So when looking at botanical names, if you see an annuum you will know that the plant lives only once a year.

Sometimes the botanical name indicates where the plant originates from, the Latin version of the common name, the color of the bloom, traditional uses and more. Once you learn to recognize these 'Q' words I call them you will better understand the system better.

Taxonomy

Taxonomy is the system that identifies the characteristics of a plant by leaf shape, petal shape, color of bloom, stem structure, and the chemical components of a plant to classify them into groups and species.

Taxonomy can be fun and interesting for all ages. An herbalist must be familiar with botany and taxonomy when wild harvesting for herbs. Knowing what plant is what is very important when you are making a remedy from an herb, say Wood Sorrel, that you are going to wild harvest. Wood Sorrel can not be purchased so quickly in a dried form in the health food stores or dried herb retailers, or that I have found anyway.

WHY STUDY BOTONY, TAXONOMY, & GROWING

Review

In this lesson we introduced the branch of Botany, the classification and naming of plants. Unless you are a botanist, it is not necessary to know every Latin name that you come across. However, if after completing this lesson you find yourself paying a little more attention to the botanical names of herbs, then our goal will have been met. As time goes by, you will be surprised at how many you will remember.

Does this mean that I am advocating the use of botanical names to the exclusion of common names? By no means! The common names are very useful, often descriptive, but there are times when it helps to know the botanical name of a plant to prevent confusion and to name exactly which plant we mean. For instance if we grow our own medicinal garden then we need to be sure to order the correct seeds or purchase the correct plants.

Some herbalists believe that a genus of herbs (and or family) but the species of an herb may indeed have over thousands of species that have the same medicinal properties; this meaning that all of the genus, say for example angelica, have the same or similar medicinal properties. However, some herbalists believe that each separate plant in the same species contains separate medicinal properties.

Nomenclature and Botanical Classification

The system of binomial nomenclature, introduced by Carl von Linné, serves as the universal method for naming plant species. This scientific naming system assigns each plant a unique name composed of its genus and species. The primary advantage of this system is that it eliminates confusion that often arises from vernacular names, which can vary significantly across different regions and languages.

Botanical classification organizes plants into a structured hierarchy, which includes levels such as family, genus, species, and, in some cases, subspecies or variety. Plants that belong to the same botanical family usually share similar morphological characteristics, chemical compounds, and even medicinal properties. This classification system is crucial for understanding the relationships and characteristics of various plants.

The APG IV classification, published in 2016, is the latest system that reflects the evolutionary relationships among different groups of flowering plants. For those involved in the study and use of medicinal plants, mastering nomenclature and botanical classification is vital. This knowledge ensures the traceability and quality of medicinal plants, helps prevent adulteration, and facilitates accurate referencing in scientific literature.

For herbalists, navigating botanical classification is essential. It enables them to accurately identify medicinal plants, comprehend their relationships, and select the appropriate species for various therapeutic situations. Understanding these classifications not only enhances the effectiveness of herbal practices but also contributes to the broader field of botanical sciences.

BASIC PLANT IDENTIFICATION

Basic Plant Identification: A Beginner's Guide

Identifying plants is a rewarding skill that connects us to the natural world, and starting with common herbs is a great way to begin. By focusing on the leaves, flowers, and growth patterns, you can quickly learn to recognize various plants. Here's how you can enhance your plant identification skills.

Leaves as Key Identifiers

Leaves are one of the most distinctive features of plants. Pay attention to their shape, size, color, and texture. Some herbs have broad leaves, like basil, while others, such as rosemary, have needle-like leaves. Observing these characteristics can help differentiate between plant families.

Flower Features

Flowers provide another layer of identification. Not only do their colors and shapes vary greatly, but so do their arrangements. For instance, the small, clustered flowers of thyme are quite different from the larger, solitary blooms of lavender. Noting these details is crucial for accurate identification.

Growth Patterns Matter

The way plants grow—whether they sprawl, climb, or stand upright—can also offer clues. Mint, for example, tends to spread rapidly and can be identified by its growth habit as much as its scent.

Utilizing Field Guides

Field guides are invaluable tools. They typically include photos and detailed descriptions, making it easier to compare and contrast different species. Investing in a good field guide focused on local flora will greatly enhance your learning experience.

Participating in Local Plant Walks

Joining local plant walks is a wonderful way to learn from experts and enthusiasts alike. These walks provide hands-on experience and offer the opportunity to see plants in their natural habitat, making it easier to remember their characteristics.

By combining these methods—studying leaves, flowers, and growth patterns, using field guides, and participating in plant walks—you can quickly become adept at identifying common herbs. Happy exploring!

Plant Morphology and Anatomy

Plant morphology and anatomy are integral components of botany, focusing on the external and internal characteristics of plant organs. These disciplines are essential for identifying medicinal species and understanding their therapeutic potential.

Plant Morphology: External Features

Plant morphology examines the shape, structure, and external appearance of plant organs. The primary organs include roots, stems, leaves, flowers, and fruits, each with distinct morphological characteristics crucial for the identification of medicinal species.

- Roots: Roots come in various forms and textures. Some are particularly valued for their medicinal properties.
- Stems: The stem supports leaves, flowers, and fruits. Its morphology is a significant factor in plant identification.
- Leaves: Leaves display a wide array of shapes, edges, venation patterns, and arrangements on the stem, all vital for recognizing medicinal plants.

- Flowers: The morphology of flowers, including their symmetry, number, and color of floral parts, is a key aspect of botanical identification and often indicates family affiliation.
- Fruits: Fruits can be dry or fleshy, and either dehiscent or indehiscent. Some fruits are used in herbalism for their medicinal benefits.

Plant Anatomy: Internal Structure

Plant anatomy delves into the internal structure of organs and tissues, facilitating the understanding of where active principles are located and optimizing extraction methods. This knowledge is pivotal for the effective use of plants in medicinal preparations.

The Role of Herbalists

Herbalists must cultivate their expertise in plant morphology and anatomy through meticulous observation, utilizing resources such as floras, identification guides, and botanical plates. Proficiency in these areas is crucial to ensuring the quality and traceability of medicinal plants, from their initial identification to their conversion into therapeutic products.

In summary, mastering plant morphology and anatomy is essential for anyone involved in the study or use of medicinal plants, ensuring both accurate identification and the effective application of their therapeutic properties.

Botanical Identification for Herbalists: Ensuring Quality and Safety

Precise botanical identification is a fundamental aspect for herbalists committed to ensuring the quality, safety, and efficacy of medicinal plants. The accurate identification of plants is not only crucial for harnessing their medicinal properties but also for avoiding potentially dangerous confusions with toxic species. Here's an overview of key tools and methods used in botanical identification:

1. Determination Keys:

Determination keys are invaluable tools that guide users through a step-by-step process based on the morphological characteristics of plants. These keys help in distinguishing one species from another by focusing on specific traits, making them essential for precise identification.

2. Floras:

Floras are comprehensive reference works that describe the plant species of a particular region. They include detailed descriptions, illustrations, and determination keys, providing an extensive resource for understanding the diversity of plant life in a given area. Floras are indispensable for anyone seeking to gain in-depth knowledge about regional plant species.

3. Herbariums:

Herbariums are curated collections of dried and labeled plant specimens. These serve as tangible references for identification and comparison, allowing herbalists and botanists to examine the physical characteristics of various species. Herbariums offer a historical record of plant diversity and are pivotal for accurate identification.

4. Digital Resources:

The advent of digital resources, such as online databases and mobile applications, has revolutionized botanical identification. These tools provide easy access to vast amounts of information, enabling quick identification and verification in the field. They complement traditional methods and enhance the efficiency of the identification process.

5. Importance of Botanical Identification:

Identifying medicinal plants accurately is especially critical for differentiating them from toxic look-alikes. This skill helps prevent the risks of poisoning and ensures that herbal preparations are both safe and effective. The medicinal properties of plants are intrinsically linked to their specific identity, emphasizing the need for precision in identification.

6. Developing Identification Skills:

Botanical identification is a skill that evolves through continuous observation, practice, and experience. Engaging with peers and experts in the field further enriches this learning process, allowing for the exchange of knowledge and techniques crucial for mastering the art of plant identification.

In conclusion, mastering botanical identification is essential for herbalists who strive to provide safe and effective herbal remedies. By employing determination keys, floras, herbariums, and digital resources, and by continuously developing their skills, herbalists can ensure the highest quality of their medicinal plant preparations.

HERBAL PREPARATION METHODS

Herbal Preparation Methods: A Guide to Simple Techniques

Harnessing the power of herbs through simple preparation methods is a rewarding way to incorporate natural healing into your daily routine. Mastering techniques such as teas, infusions, decoctions, and tinctures can enhance your understanding and use of herbal remedies.

Teas are perhaps the most familiar method of herbal preparation. They involve steeping herbs in hot water, much like your regular cup of tea. This method is ideal for delicate plant parts, such as leaves and flowers, which release their beneficial properties quickly and efficiently.

Infusions are similar to teas but require a longer steeping time to extract more potent benefits. Infusions are typically made with leaves and flowers as well, and are left to steep for several hours or even overnight. This method is perfect for herbs that are more robust and need more time to release their full potential.

Decoctions involve boiling tougher plant materials like roots, bark, or seeds. This method requires simmering the herbs in water for an extended period to break down the tough structures and extract active ingredients effectively. Decoctions are often richer and more intense than teas or infusions due to the concentrated manner of preparation.

Tinctures are alcohol-based extracts that involve soaking herbs in alcohol for several weeks. This method is excellent for preserving the medicinal qualities of herbs for long-term use. Tinctures offer a concentrated dose of herbal benefits, and their alcohol base enhances the extraction of certain compounds that water alone cannot dissolve.

By mastering these simple yet effective methods, you can unlock the healing potential of herbs and incorporate them into your wellness routine with confidence. Whether you're looking for a soothing cup of tea or a potent tincture, understanding these preparations will empower you to harness the natural benefits of herbs in your everyday life.

Herbal Preparations

Herbalism is often referred to as herbal preparation, and 'alternative medicine' is defined in the dictionary as the use of remedies such as homeopathy or naturopathy that are not considered part of the mainstream of medicine. However, in different parts of the world, 'alternative medicine' is considered the norm and is the mainstream of medicine, such as in the Western world.

For me, herbalism means traditional herbal preparation. My ancestors practiced herbalism, and licensed physicians would often recommend herbal remedies for various respiratory problems, the flu, and other ailments. As a child, I remember being told to use Plantain for bee stings when out in the field. Therefore, I believe it is important for people to take control of their health and not just rely on 'modern medicine' to treat symptoms with drugs and surgery. While 'modern medicine' is necessary in certain life-threatening cases, I think it can be avoided in many cases with the right herbal education and information.

The purpose of this course is to provide you with the knowledge, tools, and resources to make responsible decisions about your own health and the health of those you care for. After all, who knows your body and health better than you? This course is not meant to criticize governments or healthcare systems, but rather to empower individuals to seek the best and most efficient healthcare available. Many other countries, such as Alaska and Europe, have increased the use of herbal pharmaceuticals and are seeing positive results.

In this course, Herbal Medicine will be referred to as an herbal preparation.

HERBAL FORMS

Herbal Teas

There are two methods of making herbal teas: infusion and decoction. Infusion involves steeping lighter parts of the plant (leaves, flowers, and light stems) in boiled water for several minutes. Decoction involves boiling tougher parts, such as roots or bark, for a longer period of time. You will learn more about making medicinal and herbal teas, including the difference between tinctures and decoctions. Not all herbal teas are considered medicinal based on the way the tincture or decoction is prepared.

Herbal Tinctures

Steeping a medicinal plant in alcohol extracts the herbal properties into a liquid form that can be stored for long periods. There are also non-alcoholic tinctures that substitute alcohol with apple cider vinegar.

Herbal Poultices

Poultices use the plant material itself mixed with water and placed into a muslin cloth that is then applied to the skin for a topical remedy. They have the shortest life span of any herbal remedy and must be made fresh for every use.

Powdered Herbs and Tablets

Herbs that are dried and then diced into a powder can be placed into a vegetable glycerin capsule, or formed into a tablet using a mold to make herbal medicine more convenient.

Herbal Ointments

An ointment or salve or rub is a semi-solid preparation made to be applied to the skin topically. Depending on the purpose for which it is designed and its method of preparation, the texture can vary from very greasy to a thick paste. The simplest ointments use beeswax as a base, along with carrier oil. While some OTC herbal ointments and salves have a hardening agent added in, the best medicinal salves are those that are homemade and contain no synthetic agents.

Essential Oils

Extraction of volatile liquid plant materials and other aromatic compounds from plants produces essential oils. These plant oils may be used internally in some forms of herbal medicine, as well as in aromatherapy and generally for their perfume.

Perfume oils and fragrance oils are not the same as essential oils. It takes several pounds of herbs to make just one bottle of essential oil. There are infused oil methods that can be used as a substitute for using essential oils.

Herbal Supplements

Herbal supplements are commercial products in tablet or capsule form that are made and marketed by the health food industry to sell to the general public. Some supplements and products are only sold to licensed healthcare professionals as a prescription. Herbal supplements are standardized, meaning they are formulated to contain levels of active phytochemicals. However, many herbalists prefer to use the whole plant rather than just the targeted phytochemical. When an herb is standardized, the targeted phytochemical is extracted from the plant into pill or liquid form, leaving the rest of the plant's properties and other essential phytochemicals behind.

In the US, most herbal remedies are considered dietary supplements. However, not all supplements are true to their label. The Food and Drug Administration (FDA) regulates all healthcare products and herbal supplements. However, the FDA treats homeopathic remedies differently than conventional medicines. Homeopathic products do not need FDA approval before sale, and they do not have to be proven safe or effective. They do not have to be labeled with an expiration date, and they do not have to undergo finished product testing to verify contents, strength, or potency. Many herbs for home use can be grown in a small home garden. However, the government is working to get the FDA to test and study the herbal and homeopathic supplements that are on the market.

FORMS OF HERBAL MEDICINE

Medicinal plants known as herbs can be used by anyone throughout their normal daily routines. For example herbs can be part of a salad, a tea, or supplement. You would be amazed at all of the herbs that you have right in your kitchen, for example an onion. Think of all of the spices that you have in your spice rack, or the culinary herbs that you cook with everyday.

Medicinal herbs can be used in various forms:

Herbal Teas

There are two methods of making herbal teas, infusion and decoction. Infusion is steeping lighter parts of the plant (leaves, flowers, light stems) in boiled water for several minutes.

Decoction is boiling the tougher parts, such as roots or bark for a longer period of time. There are several techniques that you will learn later on about making medicinal and herbal teas, and the difference between them, not all herbal teas are considered medicinal based on the way that the tincture or decoction is prepared.

Herbal Tinctures

Steeping a medicinal plant in alcohol extracts the herbal properties into a liquid form that can be stored for long periods. There are non-alcoholic tinctures as well substituting the alcohol with apple cider vinegar.

Herbal Poultices

Poultices use the plant material itself mixed with water and then placed into a muslin cloth that is then applied to the skin for a topical remedy. They have the shortest life span of any herbal remedy and must be made fresh for every use.

Powdered Herbs and Tablets

Herbs that are dried and then diced into a powder can then be placed into a vegetable glycerin capsule, or formed into a tablet using a mold to make herbal medicine more convenient.

Herbal Ointments

An ointment or salve or rub is a semi-solid preparation made to be applied to the skin topically. Depending on the purpose for which it is designed and its method of preparation, the texture can vary from very greasy to a thick paste. The simplest ointments use beeswax as a base, along with carrier oil. Some OTC herbal ointments and salves have a hardening agent added in but the best medicinal salve is those that are home made using no synthetic agents.

Essential Oils

Extraction of volatile liquid plant materials and other aromatic compounds from plants gives essential oils. These plant oils may be used internally (which I do not recommend or teach) in some forms of herbal medicine as well as in aromatherapy and generally for their perfume.

Perfume oils and fragrance oils are not the same as essential oils. It takes several pounds of herbs to make just 1 bottle of essential oil. There are infused oil methods that can be used as a substitute to using the essential oils.

Herbal Supplements

Herbal supplements are commercial products in tablet or capsule form that are made and marketed by the health food industry to sell to the general public. However, there are some supplements and products that are only sold to licensed health care professionals as a prescription. Herbal supplements are standardized, meaning formulated to contain levels of active phytochemicals. The majority of herbalists may not agree with the standardization of the active ingredients, preferring to use the whole plant instead of just the phytochemical that is targeted. When an herb is standardized it is a process of taking the targeted phytochemical out from the plant into pill or liquid form leaving the rest of the plant's properties and other needful phytochemicals behind.

FORMS OF HERBAL MEDICINE

In the US, most herbal remedies are stated as being dietary supplements. However, not all supplements are true to their label.

The Food and Drug Administration (FDA) regulates all health-care products and herbal supplements. However, the FDA treats homeopathic remedies very differently than conventional medicines. Homeopathic products do not need FDA approval before sale; they do not have to be proven either safe or effective; they do not have to be labeled with an expiration date; and they do not have to undergo finished product testing to verify contents and strength or potency. Many herbs for home use could also be grown in a small home garden. However, the government is working on getting the FDA to test and study the herbal supplements and or homeopathic supplements that are out there on the market.

PREPARATION OF HERBAL REMEDIES

We can think of so many different kinds of remedies out there. The best ones are the ones that can be done right at home.

Preparations for internal use

Besides consuming herbs, it can be consumed through tea, tinctures, supplements, and tablets.

Infusions

Infusions are hot water extracts that are made from dried or fresh herbs, preferably the leaves, and blooms. The most common infusion is making tea. The recipe calls for ½ to 1 ounce of dried herbs steeped in hot boiling water for 10 minutes to 20 minutes, then strain with a cheesecloth or muslin cloth into another glass jar or container. Infusions should be made as needed for they do not have a long shelf life. Some herbalists like to take 2 teaspoons of dried herbs per cup of boiling water that is 8 oz cup to 1 or 2 rounded tsp of dried herbs. After 20 minutes the infusion is no longer hot so therefore making a large amount of infusion to drink will need to be reheated. My friend boils gallons of green tea for her dog's skin condition. She makes the infusion of green tea then allows cooling then pouring it over her dog and rubs it in for medicinal purposes for the skin.

For pleasure drinking tea or infusion you need to shorten the boiling time and add a little sweetener to the cup. Some herbal teas are very bitter.

Infusions are made like making a cup of tea. You can take 1 tsp of dried herb to 1 cup of water, and 2 tsp or a small handful of fresh herbs to 1 cup of water. There are many different types of infusions and teas to fit the medicinal needs of each individual. If I need to make what is know as a medicinal tea or infusion then I place my herbs in a muslin tea bag and simmer for 10 minutes then I add another tsp of herbs in the infusion water and simmer for another 10 minutes this allows the potency of the herb infusion to be greater. You can also use a coffee pot as well to make an infusion a lot faster.

You can also follow this as well; 1 ounce or 25 grams of dried herbs, or 2 ounces or 50 grams of fresh herbs, should be added to 1 pint or 600 ml of water, which is at boiling point. You can put herbs in a warm teapot, add boiling water, cover for ten minutes, and strain and drink it.

Decoctions

Decoctions are preparations that are made just like an infusion but with herbs that may need to be soaked in the infusion before the decoction process can be completed. The herb measurement is the same for a decoction as an infusion.

Decoctions are similar to infusions but are made from the roots and bark of the herb. Roots, and bark take a longer time in expelling their medicinal properties. Instead of steeping, you bring the water to a boil, reducing the heat and allow it to simmer for around 20 minutes no less than 10, then strain, and store.

Syrups

Children and teens like syrups, and those that use syrups as a substitute for alcoholic tinctures. Infusions and decoctions can be added to the syrup, mix 12 ounces or 325 grams of sugar into 600 ml of liquid and heat till the sugar has dissolved. Cool and store the syrup in a refrigerator. Once you weigh the infusion or decoction you can add a quarter of its weight of honey into it. This should be heated slowly and brought down to a thick liquid, and remove the scum that can form on top of the liquid mixture.

- However, there is another preparation, where you have to pour 1 pint of water and start boiling it, add over 2.5 lbs or 1,25 kg of brown sugar and start stirring it over low heat till the sugar dissolves completely and the solution is boiling. After it is removed from the heat, add 1 part of herbal tincture to 3 parts of syrup and set aside.

Tinctures

Tinctures are made from herbal infusion with alcohol, usually vodka, gin or brandy is recommended. To prepare a tincture, use 1 part of dry herb to 5 parts of liquid and if they are fresh herbs, then you can use 1 part of herbs to 2 parts of liquid. Place all the herbs in a big jar and pour the alcohol and water in it, leave it aside to mix, shaking it 2 times a day for 2 weeks only. Press out the liquid and throw the herbs. Store in dark bottles or glass jars kept away from heat and light and make sure they are labeled.

Non-Alcoholic Tinctures are made with warm but not boiled apple cider vinegar instead of water. You follow the same recipe as for an infusion but replace the water with vinegar, steep for 10-20 minutes, strain then store in an air tight, colored glass container away from the sun or heat. You can make alcohol tinctures using vodka or brandy but I do not teach using alcohol. Also vegetable glycerin tinctures, known as glycosides, or syrups are made as well in place of the alcoholic tinctures.

Suppositories

Suppositories can be prepared with ease at home itself, add finely powdered dried herbs to melted cocoa butter and pour this mixture into molds, allowing it to cool for some time. You can store it in the refrigerator and it can be packed in aluminum foil also. Vegetable glycerin with a little beeswax can be done as well for a suppository.

Tablets and capsules

Capsules are powdered herbs packed inside a vegetable glycerin capsule or gelatin capsule. I prefer the veggie caps. Capsules come in different sizes. Before making capsules please read about capsule sizes and recommended dosages for each herb. Capsule making also requires a little plastic pill making equipment see Herbal Blessings for more info on purchasing a capsule making tool.

Though herb tablets and capsules are available in herbal shops or health food shops, it can easily be made at home too. The capsules can be made at home by utilizing gel capsules and filling them with the herb mixtures. If you use a capsule maker, then you can make larger quantities and the process is much easier. There are two standard capsule sizes, which are 0 and 00. Size 0 can hold approximately 0.35 grams of powdered mixture for a person to consume 3 tablets to be taken 3 times a day according to the dose. Size 00 can hold 0.5 grams of the powdered mixture for two capsules to be taken 3 times a day on a daily basis.

Preparations for external use

The skin can be easily used as a pathway for the remedy to reach the body through the hair follicles into the bloodstream.

PREPARATION OF HERBAL REMEDIES

Herbal baths

A warm bath with fragrance and herbal medicines in it could be quite a good experience and made easy especially if it is for treating children and babies. You can fill a muslin bag with fresh or dried herbs and leave it under the tap. Strong herb infusions can also be added to bath water, and you can soak in it for about 15 -20 minutes. Hand and foot baths are a great way for pregnant women to relieve some of the swelling from the extra body weight.

Salves and creams

Salves to me are the most fun way to prepare a remedy. 1 cup of infused herbal oil to 1 oz of beeswax is required. Making the infused oil is the key, there are two ways to make infused oil. 1) heat processed, 2) cold processed. The heat process only takes 10 minutes while the cold processed infused oil takes about 2 weeks. To make a salve or cream place 1 oz beeswax into a double boiler to allow melting, then pour in 1 cup of infused oil, heat slightly until the oil and beeswax is mixed, then pour into prepared containers. Allow to cool, label, and place in a dark place to store. You can also add about 50 drops or 1 tsp of essential oil to the salve as well before pouring into prepared containers.

Ointment

To prepare an ointment, you have to melt the beeswax in a double boiler, add 1 tsp of cocoa or shea butter or vegetable glycerin, add the herb powder, leave it on heat for 2 hours till the herbs become infused. Transfer the mixture into a jelly bag or cheesecloth tightened with a rubber band or a string and pour the mixture till the rim of the jar. You must wear rubber gloves when working on this mixture and make sure you pour the mixture into the jar while it is warm, as it can solidify as soon as it starts cooling. Some herbalists say to use paraffin wax or petroleum jelly but those are processed and contain synthetic hardening agents. I do not recommend using them to make any remedy.

Poultices

Poultice is a dampened mixture, which is applied on the part of the body, which needs the remedy. Fresh or dried herbs are used as poultice. They are placed between two pieces of gauze and applied on the area or a cabbage leaf may be used as well. If you are using fresh leaves, stems or roots, then you should break them or crush them before utilizing them. If dried herbs are being used, then a little warm water or jojoba oil can be added to the herbs, which are either finely chopped or powdered. After the mixture is ready to use, and then spread the paste into gauze or cabbage leaf. Bind the gauze poultice to the area which is affected, a light cotton bandage can be used for this purpose and after binding it to the affected area; you can keep it warm with a hot water bottle or warm towel. I have even used a warm rice sachet.

You can also make an infused poultice by making a hot processed infusion.

Oils

Essential oils are a product of aromatic plants, which cannot be extracted at home; it has to go through a method called steam distillation. These oils can be purchased from health food shops.

If you are keen on making herbal oils at home, then you can infuse finely chopped herbs into pure vegetable oils. Oils like almond oil, sunflower oil and olive oil can be used for this purpose. This process can take approximately two weeks or longer and requires a large amount of herbs.

Place the herbs and pour the oil into a tight fitting glass jar and make sure you keep it covered. Place the jar by the windowsill where a lot of sunlight can come in and make sure you shake it everyday. After two weeks, once the oil has absorbed the constituents, filter this mixture through a muslin cloth and store it in an airtight dark colored bottle. A tool called the Flora Lab can also be purchased to make herbal oils from Herbal Blessings.

PREPARATION OF HERBAL REMEDIES

Infused oils

Massage oils, ointments and creams consist of active plant ingredients, which are used externally. Infused oils can be preserved up to one year if kept properly in a cool and dark place, but making small and fresh quantities of infused oils are more effective. There are two types of technique to make infused oils. The hot process is best suited for comfrey, chickweed or rosemary. The cold process is most appropriate for marigold and St. John's wort. The process for the cold infused oil can be repeated by using new herbs and the oil, which is infused once, can be set aside for storage for a few weeks.

In the process of hot infusion: put the oil and the herb into a glass bowl placed over a pan of boiling water or in a double saucepan and let it cook for 3 hours. Once the mixture is ready pour it into a jelly bag or cheesecloth fitted tightly to the rim of the wine press and strain the mixture into the jar.

In the process of cold infusion: fill a big jar full of herbs and pour oil into it covering the herbs completely. Close the lid tightly and leave it on a window, which has a lot of sunlight coming in or in a greenhouse for about 2-3 weeks. Once the mixture is ready pour it into a jelly bag or cheesecloth secured with an elastic band to the rim of the jug. Squeeze the oil through the bag and you can repeat this process a few more times with newer herbs added to it and after a few weeks it can be strained again and set aside for storage.

There are many more herbal remedy procedures. I just covered a few. Refer to the videos for more tips and techniques.

HERBAL FORMS IN DETAIL

There are many different kinds of herbal preparation available, but the best ones are the ones that can be done right at home. This document provides information on various preparations for internal use.

Infusions

Infusions are hot water extracts made from dried or fresh herbs, preferably the leaves and blooms. The most common infusion is making tea. To make an infusion, steep 1/2 to 1 ounce of dried herbs in hot boiling water for 10 to 20 minutes, then strain with a cheesecloth or muslin cloth into another glass jar or container. Infusions should be made as needed since they do not have a long shelf life. For medicinal purposes, some herbalists like to take 2 teaspoons of dried herbs per cup of boiling water that is 8 oz cup to 1 or 2 rounded tsp of dried herbs. After 20 minutes, the infusion is no longer hot, so making a large amount of infusion to drink will need to be reheated. To make a medicinal tea or infusion, place herbs in a muslin tea bag and simmer for 10 minutes, then add another tsp of herbs in the infusion water and simmer for another 10 minutes to increase the potency of the herb infusion. Infusions can also be made in a coffee pot for faster preparation.

Decoctions

Decoctions are similar to infusions but are made from the roots and bark of the herb. Roots and bark take a longer time to expel their medicinal properties. To make a decoction, bring the water and herb mixture to a boil, reduce the heat, and allow it to simmer for around 20 minutes (no less than 10), then strain and store.

Syrups

Infusions and decoctions can be added to syrups. To make a syrup, mix 12 ounces or 325 grams of sugar into 600 ml of liquid and heat until the sugar has dissolved. Cool and store the syrup in a refrigerator. Once you weigh the infusion or decoction, you can add a quarter of its weight of honey into it. Heat slowly and bring it down to a thick liquid, and remove the scum that can form on top of the liquid mixture. An alternative preparation involves boiling 1 pint of water, adding over 2.5 lbs or 1,25 kg of brown sugar, and stirring it over low heat until the sugar dissolves completely and the solution is boiling. After it is removed from the heat, add 1 part of herbal tincture to 3 parts of syrup and set aside.

Tinctures

Tinctures are made from herbal infusion with alcohol, usually vodka, gin, or brandy. To prepare a tincture, use 1 part of dry herb to 5 parts of liquid, and if they are fresh herbs, use 1 part of herbs to 2 parts of liquid. Place all the herbs in a big jar and pour the alcohol and water in it, leave it aside to mix, shaking it 2 times a day for 2 weeks only. Press out the liquid and throw the herbs. Store in dark bottles or glass jars kept away from heat and light and make sure they are labeled. Non-alcoholic tinctures can be made with warm but not boiled apple cider vinegar instead of water. You can make alcohol tinctures using vodka or brandy, but it's not recommended. Vegetable glycerin tinctures, known as glycosides, or syrups can be made as well in place of alcoholic tinctures.

HERBAL FORMS IN DETAIL

Suppositories

Suppositories can be prepared with ease at home. Add finely powdered dried herbs to melted cocoa butter and pour this mixture into molds, allowing it to cool for some time. You can store it in the refrigerator, and it can be packed in aluminum foil. Vegetable glycerin with a little beeswax can be done as well for a suppository.

Tablets and capsules

Capsules are powdered herbs packed inside a vegetable glycerin capsule or gelatin capsule. Capsules come in different sizes, so before making them, please read about capsule sizes and recommended dosages for each herb. Capsule making also requires a little plastic pill making equipment. Though herb tablets and capsules are available in herbal shops or health food shops, they can be easily made at home too. The capsules can be made at home by utilizing gel capsules and filling them with the herb mixtures. If you use a capsule maker, then you can make larger quantities, and the process is much easier. There are two standard capsule sizes, which are 0 and 00. Size 0 can hold approximately 0.35 grams of powdered mixture for a person to consume 3 tablets to be taken 3 times a day according to the suggested intake plan. Size 00 can hold 0.5 grams of the powdered mixture for two capsules to be taken 3 times a day on a daily basis of the suggested intake plant.

Preparations for external use

The skin can easily absorb remedies through hair follicles and into the bloodstream, making it a convenient pathway for treatment.

Herbal Baths

A warm bath infused with fragrant herbs can be a relaxing experience and is especially helpful for treating children and babies. You can fill a muslin bag with fresh or dried herbs and place it under the tap. Strong herb infusions can also be added to the bath water, and you can soak in it for about 15-20 minutes. Hand and foot baths are a great way for pregnant women to relieve some of the swelling from the extra body weight.

Salves and Creams

Salves are a fun and effective way to prepare remedies. To make a salve or cream, you need 1 cup of infused herbal oil to 1 oz of beeswax. The key is making the infused oil, which can be done through two methods: heat processed or cold processed. The heat process takes only 10 minutes, while the cold process takes about 2 weeks. To make the salve or cream, place 1 oz of beeswax into a double boiler to allow melting, then pour in 1 cup of infused oil. Heat slightly until the oil and beeswax are mixed, then pour into prepared containers. Allow it to cool, label, and store in a dark place. You can also add about 50 drops or 1 tsp of essential oil to the salve before pouring it into the containers.

Ointments

To prepare an ointment, melt the beeswax in a double boiler, add 1 tsp of cocoa or shea butter or vegetable glycerin, add the herb powder, and leave it on heat for 20 minutes (some say 2 hours) until the herbs become infused. Transfer the mixture into a jelly bag or cheesecloth tightened with a rubber band or string and pour the mixture till the rim of the jar. Be sure to wear rubber gloves when working with this mixture and pour it into the jar while it is warm, as it can solidify as soon as it starts cooling. I do not recommend using paraffin wax or petroleum jelly to make any remedy, as they are processed and contain synthetic hardening agents.

HERBAL FORMS IN DETAIL

Poultices

A poultice is a dampened mixture applied to the part of the body that needs the remedy. Fresh or dried herbs can be used as a poultice, and they are placed between two pieces of gauze or a cabbage leaf. If using fresh leaves, stems, or roots, break or crush them before utilizing them. If using dried herbs, a little warm water or jojoba oil can be added to the finely chopped or powdered herbs. After the mixture is ready to use, spread the paste into the gauze or cabbage leaf. Bind the gauze poultice to the affected area with a light cotton bandage, and keep it warm with a hot water bottle, warm towel, or warm rice sachet. An infused poultice can also be made by making a hot processed infusion.

Herbal, Aromatic, and Fragrance Oils

Essential oils are products of aromatic plants, extracted through a method called steam distillation. They can be purchased from health food shops. To make 'herbal oils' at home, infuse finely chopped herbs into pure vegetable oils such as almond, sunflower, or olive oil. This process can take approximately two weeks or longer and requires a large amount of herbs. Place the herbs and oil into a tight-fitting glass jar, keep it covered, and place it by the windowsill where sunlight can come in. Shake it every day. After two weeks, once the oil has absorbed the constituents, filter the mixture through a muslin cloth and store it in an airtight dark colored bottle. A tool called the Flora Lab can also be purchased to make herbal oils from Herbal Blessings.

Infused Oils

Massage oils, ointments, and creams consist of externally used active plant ingredients. Infused oils can be preserved up to one year if kept properly in a cool and dark place, but making small and fresh quantities of infused oils is more effective. There are two types of techniques to make infused oils. The hot process is best suited for comfrey, chickweed, or rosemary. The cold process is most appropriate for marigold and St. John's wort. The process for the cold-infused oil can be repeated by using new herbs, and the oil infused once can be set aside for storage for a few weeks.

Plant Juice - Definition: The liquid obtained by pressing and crushing freshly harvested plant material (plant parts). - Preparation: Prepared from freshly harvested plant parts, expressed juice primarily contains water-soluble plant constituents. - Storage: Once opened, the bottle should be closed and stored in a refrigerator. The contents should be discarded after one week, or after the expiration date specified on the label. - Medicinal Action: Usually relatively weak, except in rare cases (expressed Echinacea juice, for example).

Distillates - Definition: Formulations obtained by extracting active principles from fresh or dried plant material by steam distillation. - Preparation: Obtained by separating the steam-volatile constituents of fresh or dried medicinal plants by vaporization. - Storage: See p. 5. - Medicinal Action: Determined by the water-volatile constituents (e.g., mustard oils, essential oils) contained in the distillate.

Oily Extracts - Definition: The preparation obtained by dissolving the fat-soluble constituents of a medicinal plant in, for example, olive oil, almond oil, or peanut oil. - Preparation: Prepared by immersing the freshly cut or dried plant parts in a vegetable oil and allowing them to stand, usually at room temperature, until the fat-soluble constituents have been extracted.

Storage: These preparations are relatively unstable and should therefore be prepared in small quantities (see p. 5 for storage instructions).

PREPARATIONS FROM FRESH PLANT MATERIAL

Oily Extracts – Definition: The preparation obtained by dissolving the fat-soluble constituents of a medicinal plant in, for example, olive oil, almond oil, or peanut oil. – Preparation: Prepared by immersing the freshly cut or dried plant parts in a vegetable oil and allowing them to stand, usually at room temperature, until the fat-soluble constituents have been extracted.
Storage: These preparations are relatively unstable and should therefore be prepared in small quantities (see p. 5 for storage instructions).
Extracts
Definition: Extracts are prepared by dissolving medicinal plants in a solvent to separate their active principles from extraneous substances. The type of formulation (aqueous, alcoholic) depends on the type of solvent used (water, alcohol). Extracts are characterized as either dry or liquid depending on the concentration of residual solvent in the final product. Note: The composition of and uses for preparations from the same plant may differ between the various preparation techniques. Hence, any extract produced by a special preparation technique is a unique active substance.
Aqueous Extract – Definition: An extract prepared using water as the extracting agent. These extracts mainly contain water-soluble constituents and few lipid-soluble components. – Disadvantages: The individual constituents are relatively unstable, and microorganisms can multiply rapidly.
Alcohol Extract – Definition: An extract prepared using ethanol and water mixed at various ratios and concentrations, called the menstruum. – Preparation: In Germany, the standard procedure calls for the plant material to be cut into pieces and then steeped in the menstruum (macerated) for several hours; in the North American standard, the fresh or dried and powdered plant material is macerated in the menstruum for a week to 10 days and the liquid is then pressed out with a hydraulic press (if available). The drug is repeatedly steeped in the menstruum, strained and concentrated (percolation) until completely extracted. – Advantages: Ethanol (grain alcohol) is an excellent extracting agent. At higher volume concentrations, it can also extract lipophilic drug constituents, such as essential oils. Alcohol preserves the extracts for a longer time (up to 2 to 3 years) and assists rapid absorption of the active ingredients.
Tincture – Definition: A solution prepared by macerating or percolating a medicinal herb in various concentrations of ethanol. According to the German Pharmacopeia (DAB 1996), dry extracts made by using suitable concentrations of ethanol are also defined as tinctures.
Preparation: Tinctures are made by mixing 1 part drug with 5 parts extractant. However, for high-potency constituents like atropine from belladonna, the ratio is 1 part drug to 10 parts extractant. The process of extracting the active ingredients from herbs and plants can be a complex and nuanced process, but it is important to understand the different types of extracts available and how they are made.
Labeling: A dried herb to extract ratio (HER) of 1:5 or 1:10 means that the preparation was made using 1 part plant material and 5 or 10 parts of the menstruum. This ratio can help consumers understand the potency of the extract and how it was prepared.
Storage (see p. 5): Tinctures should not be stored for more than one year because some compounds in the extract may become unstable. Bauer and his co-workers found that echinacea tincture is stable for 2 to 3 years under normal conditions, with about 30% reduction in some important constituents per year (Personal communication, Rudi Bauer, Ph.D., 1987). It is important to carefully monitor the shelf life of tinctures and other extracts to ensure that they are still effective.

PREPARATIONS FROM FRESH PLANT MATERIAL

Note: Many tinctures should not be used undiluted. It is important to follow the instructions provided by the manufacturer and consult with a healthcare professional before using any herbal supplements.

Fluid extract (fluid extract) Definition: An alcoholic preparation of a medicinal herb containing higher concentrations of plant constituents than are found in conventional tinctures. One part of fluid extract corresponds to one part of the parent herb calculated on a dry-weight basis. This concentration is achieved by evaporating off some of the alcohol. Fluid extracts are a powerful and concentrated form of herbal medicine that should be used with caution.

Preparation: Fluid extracts are prepared in the same way as tinctures, but involve additional steps to increase the concentration of active ingredients. The process can be complex and may involve specialized equipment and techniques.

Dry extracts (powdered extracts),Definition: Solid preparations obtained by condensing and drying fluid extracts. A powdered extract generally contains 95% solids and 5% water residue (moisture). A native extract or native dry extract contains only plant extract material and is free of additives. Powdered extracts are a convenient and easy-to-use form of herbal medicine that can be added to food or drinks.

Preparation: Powdered extracts are made by carefully drying and condensing fluid extracts to create a concentrated powder. Adjuvants and carriers such as highly dispersed silica, lactose, and methylcellulose are sometimes added to prevent caking and to adjust the final extract concentration. Extracts that are adjusted to 5:1 (meaning that 1 part of the finished extract is equivalent to all the desirable and active constituents of 5 parts of the dried herb) are typical.

The package labeling provides information on the parent plant or plant part, the extractant, and the dried herb/extract ratio (HER). An HER of 10:1 means that 10 parts of the plant material yielded 1 part extract. A low HER (such as 1:2) indicates a high concentration of the active compounds in the plant material.

Special extracts Definition: Extracts that undergo special extraction and purification processes to separate, concentrate, and free them from toxic and undesirable substances. Special extracts are a highly concentrated and potent form of herbal medicine that should only be used under the guidance of a healthcare professional.

Preparation: Special extracts are made from raw extracts and undergo additional extraction and purification processes to increase the concentration of desirable active principles. Toxins and undesirable substances that do not contribute to the medicinal action of the preparation are removed. This treatment reduces the risk factors associated with the native material, and often provides a finished product that is many times more concentrated in one or more active constituents than is the parent herb, such as the highly concentrated and standardized ginkgo extract typically sold in consumer products (50:1). Hence, the effects of the special extract can no longer be compared with those of the raw materials. It is important to carefully consider the potential benefits and risks of using special extracts and to consult with a healthcare professional before use.

PREPARATIONS FROM FRESH PLANT MATERIAL

Medicinal teas are a type of herbal tea that are known for their strong medicinal properties. While some milder teas, such as ginger, peppermint, and chamomile, are considered safe to use at home, it is best to use medicinal teas under the guidance of an experienced healthcare professional like a naturopathic practitioner or herbalist. The concentrations of active principles in medicinal teas are dependent on several factors, including the proportion of herbs to extractant (water), the degree of cutting or grinding of the herbs, the recommended water temperature, and the steeping time.

Despite their many benefits, there are some disadvantages to using medicinal teas. It can be difficult to determine the exact dosage, and combined components may become separated. Additionally, cutting or powdering of herbs can often drastically reduce their shelf life by allowing oxygen to reach and degrade active constituents.

If you're interested in trying medicinal teas, there are many suppliers to choose from, including pharmacies, drug stores, health food stores, herb shops, and supermarkets. When preparing medicinal teas, it is important to cut leaves, flowers, and other plant materials coarsely to finely, while wood, bark, and root materials should be cut finely or pulverized. To ensure that your medicinal teas retain their potency, it is important to store them in metal tins or dark jars to prevent direct light exposure. The expiration date should be indicated on the label.

There are several types of tea preparations to choose from, including loose tea, tea bags, and instant teas. Loose tea is available as single-herb preparations and as tea mixtures, while tea bags are small filter bags in which finely chopped herbal teas are enclosed. Instant teas are tea preparations that readily dissolve in water, and are available in both powdered and granular forms.

When preparing your medicinal teas, there are several methods to choose from, including infusion, decoction, and maceration. Infusion is a preparation made by pouring boiling water onto the fresh or dried herbs and allowing them to steep to extract their medicinal principles. This method is suitable for the preparation of delicate or finely chopped herbs with volatile and thermolabile constituents. Decoction, on the other hand, is prepared by boiling fresh or dried herbs in water for 10 to 60 minutes to extract their medicinal principles. This method is suitable for the preparation of hard or very hard plant materials or herbs with sparingly soluble constituents. Finally, maceration, or cold extract, is prepared by allowing a tea herb to steep in cold water for several hours to extract its active principles. This method is suitable for the preparation of mucilage-containing herbs such as flaxseeds or psyllium seeds whose high concentrations of starches and pectins would cause them to gelatinize if prepared with boiling water. It is also used to prevent the extraction of undesirable constituents that dissolve in hot water.

THE IMPORTANCE OF DOSAGE

The Importance of Dosage: Ensuring Safety and Effectiveness with Herbs

Herbs have been used for centuries as natural remedies to promote health and treat various ailments. Their popularity has surged in recent years as more people seek alternatives to conventional medicine. However, while herbs can provide numerous health benefits, it is crucial to understand the importance of dosage in ensuring their safety and effectiveness.

Herbs are powerful substances that contain active compounds capable of producing significant physiological effects. Like any medication, the right dosage can mean the difference between achieving the desired therapeutic outcome and encountering unwanted side effects. This is why understanding and adhering to the correct dosage is paramount when using herbal remedies.

Taking the correct dosage of herbs ensures that you receive the maximum benefit while minimizing potential risks. Too little of an herb may not provide the desired effect, while too much can lead to toxicity and adverse reactions. Therefore, it is essential to follow recommended guidelines or consult with a healthcare professional knowledgeable in herbal medicine.

Moreover, individual factors such as age, weight, and overall health can influence how an herb affects a person. Different people may require different dosages to achieve the same therapeutic effect. Personalized assessment helps cater to these individual needs, ensuring both safety and efficacy.

The correct dosage also varies depending on the form in which the herb is consumed. Herbs are available in various forms, including teas, tinctures, capsules, and extracts, each with its own concentration of active ingredients. Understanding these differences is key to determining the appropriate dosage.

In conclusion, while herbs offer a natural and effective means of enhancing health, their potency necessitates careful consideration of dosage. Ensuring the correct dosage not only maximizes the benefits but also safeguards against potential side effects. Always prioritize safety by consulting with professionals and adhering to recommended dosages, allowing you to harness the full power of herbs responsibly.

MEDICAL INTERACTION

It is crucial to consult with a licensed physician before using herbal remedies and supplements, as some of them may interact with drugs, including over-the-counter drugs. The negative consequences of combining an herbal remedy that lowers blood pressure with prescription medicine that has the same effect can be quite serious, resulting in dangerously low blood pressure. For instance, ylang ylang is known to lower blood pressure, and therefore, it is important to exercise caution while using it.

Moreover, it is advisable to avoid many herbs during pregnancy to ensure the safety of both the mother and the child. However, not all physicians may be well-versed in the effects of different types of herbal medicine. Therefore, it becomes our responsibility to take control of our health and acquire as much information as possible to make informed decisions. In this regard, www.drugs.comLinks to an external site. can be a useful resource to research drug interactions between herbs and drugs.

It is important to remember that while herbal preparations and supplements can provide a natural approach to healing, it is crucial to use them with care and under professional guidance. Taking the necessary precautions and making informed decisions can help ensure a safe and effective use of these remedies.

The Role of Plants in Medicine: A Comprehensive Overview

Introduction

Long before the advent of modern pharmaceuticals, humanity relied on the therapeutic properties of plants. Traditional medicine utilized various botanical substances to treat ailments, laying the foundation for contemporary medicine. Today, over 100 active pharmaceutical ingredients derived from plants are utilized in modern drugs. This document provides a foundational overview of several key plants known for their medicinal properties, along with their scientific names and relevant uses. While this is not an exhaustive list, it serves as a useful starting point for further research.

Understanding Plant Nomenclature

When researching medicinal plants, it's important to recognize the distinction between common names and scientific names. Common names can vary by region and culture, often leading to confusion as they may refer to entirely different species. Therefore, the scientific name (usually in Latin) is provided alongside the common name to ensure accurate identification and facilitate further research.

List of Drugs Derived from Plants

1. Willow (Salix alba)
   - Active Ingredient:
   - Salicin
   - Uses:
   - Anti-inflammatory and analgesic properties; the basis for the synthesis of aspirin.
2. Foxglove (Digitalis purpurea)
   - Active Ingredient:
   - Digoxin
   - Uses:
   - Treatment of heart conditions, particularly heart failure and atrial fibrillation.
3. Opium Poppy (Papaver somniferum)
   - Active Ingredients:
   - Morphine, Codeine
   - Uses:
   - Pain relief; morphine is a powerful analgesic, while codeine is often used for mild to moderate pain relief.
4. Cinchona (Cinchona officinalis)
   - Active Ingredient:
   - Quinine
   - Uses:
   - Treatment of malaria; historically significant in the reduction of fever.
5. Eucalyptus (Eucalyptus globulus)
   - Active Ingredient:
   - Eucalyptol
   - Uses:
   - Antimicrobial and anti-inflammatory; used in respiratory treatments.
6. Ginger (Zingiber officinale)
   - Active Ingredients:
   - Gingerol, Shogaol
   - Uses:
   - Antiemetic; effective in treating nausea and digestive issues.

- Turmeric (Curcuma longa)
  - Active Ingredient:
  - Curcumin
  - Uses:
  - Anti-inflammatory and antioxidant; used in treating arthritis and other inflammatory conditions.
- Aloe Vera (Aloe barbadensis miller)
  - Active Ingredients:
  - Aloin, Aloe-emodin
  - Uses:
  - Wound healing, skin conditions, and digestive aid.
- Chamomile (Matricaria chamomilla)
  - Active Ingredients:
  - Apigenin
  - Uses:
  - Calming effects, used for anxiety and sleep disorders.
- Peppermint (Mentha piperita)
  - Active Ingredients:
  - Menthol
  - Uses:
  - Relief of digestive issues and headaches; commonly used in topical analgesic

HERBAL PREPARTION INTAKE AMOUNTS

In the following pages, we will discuss how to use herbs safely. Not all herbs are safe for everyone. Each individual is different and so are their bodies. For example, some people are allergic to eucalyptus, while others love its smell. We all have unique chemical makeups and body chemistry, so when using herbal remedies, you will find that one remedy for a 100 lb. a person may be totally different for a 150 lb. person.

There is no set recommended intake amount for herbal preparations, but most prepackaged herbal remedies or supplements have dosage instructions set for a 150 lb person. However, if you weigh only 100 lbs., you need to decrease the dosage accordingly. Always check the label of all products. For children, divide the recommended dosage by their body weight. For instance, a child would only need 1/3 of the recommended dosage, unless the product is formulated for a child's dose. Make sure you understand how to read the product label correctly. Failure to do so can result in harm.

It is important to know the herb you are taking. Some prescription drugs and over-the-counter (OTC) drugs can react with herbal remedies. As previously mentioned, some prescription drugs originated from herbs. For instance, atropine, which is used to regulate heartbeat, is from belladonna leaves, and morphine, a narcotic, is from opium poppy seeds. Ephedra, which is used in diet pills, is from the ephedra plant, which can be lethal to humans.

Some herbs are harmful to humans and animals. For example, bloodroot, comfrey, pennyroyal, and mistletoe can be toxic. Please make sure you know which herb you are using or picking in the wild. I once picked jewelweed or wild impatiens without wearing gloves because I thought it was pretty and grew by the roadside everywhere. However, as soon as I got back into my house, my hand began tingling and became numb. Unfortunately, I was experiencing a reaction to the weed. I rushed to the bathroom and cleansed my hands with a soft scrub with lemon and orange.

Later that day, I saw the tulip vine, which has a similar orange trumpet as jewelweed. I have seen cows and horses graze on this vine, but little did I know they were experiencing a horrible reaction. Later that day, I noticed that the cows and horses in that field became bloated, weak, and had diarrhea. Some of them soon died within weeks. So please remember to wear gloves and know what you are picking, even by the roadside. Some say that a little trumpet vine to an animal aids in their digestion, but a lot can be deadly.

There are guidelines to making and taking herbal remedies. Just like with prescription medicine, some herbal remedies have side effects. There are dangerous herbs, not only for humans but also for animals. Here is a checklist of guidelines to follow:

- Before you take any herb, read about it. Get to know the herb you are about to take and its possible side effects and interactions.
- Stick with the recommended dosage and never exceed it.
- Remember that we are all different. Our body weight, chemistry, skin color, and age make a difference, so be aware of your body's reactions to herbal remedies.
- If you are over 65, start with a low, diluted dose and work your way up. You will be able to tell the difference from dose to dose.

If you are pregnant or nursing, be very cautious of the herbs you use and touch. In my opinion, it is best to avoid ALL herbs.

HERBAL PREPARTION INTAKE AMOUNTS

- Do not give healing herbs to children under 2 years old.
- Be aware of herbal interactions with prescription medicine and over-the-counter drugs. Know what you are taking. Most of today's medicine is derived from herbs. Be sure to check the medicinal values of an herb along with your prescription medicine and over-the-counter drugs. For example, buckthorn is an herb that has a laxative value; using an OTC laxative with this herb is lethal and can cause severe abdominal pain and dehydration.
- Keep a list of the herbs you are using and notify your physician, dentist, or any other medical doctor of any herbs that you take or use on a daily basis.
- Discontinue any and all herbs before surgery.
- Proper dosage of herbal medicine is crucial when it comes to clinical practice. To determine the proper dosage, several factors should be taken into account. These factors include the cultural context in which the herb is used, federal or state regulations, the potential toxicity or strength of each herb, the relative concentration or strength of the product, the dose form (such as tincture or standardized extract), the age, strength, and needs of the individual taking the preparation, and the duration of administration.
- When it comes to cultural context, different cultures use different amounts of an herb or herb preparation for a dose and over different periods. For instance, while Native Americans used to drink several cups of strong tea made by boiling herbs, most technologically developed nations today would not find this acceptable. In China, a common herb prescription contains 5 to 10 herbs, and the daily dose for each is in the range of 3 to 12 grams. Moreover, many herb tea prescriptions given for therapeutic use contain about 60 to 200 grams of dried herbs. These are to be boiled for up to an hour, and 2 to 3 cups of the strong brew are consumed over the course of a day.
- Standardized extracts are commonly prescribed in tablets and capsules, as well as teas and hydroethanolic tinctures, in Germany, other European countries, and North America. Some standardized extracts are highly concentrated. For instance, Ginkgo biloba leaves are extracted to produce a 50:1 concentrate. One part of the finished extract represents the active flavonoids and terpenes from 50 parts of the leaves. In Europe, teas and tinctures tend to be of lower concentration than in North America, and the recommended daily dose also seems to be lower. In Germany and Europe, mother tinctures made with an extract ratio of 1:10 are often favored. This means that 10 parts of the finished tincture represent most of the desirable and active constituents from only 1 part of the herb, and this is called a "mother tincture." For instance, an ounce of echinacea mother tincture made at this concentration would represent 1/10 of an ounce of dried echinacea root or leaves, or about 3 grams. If the recommended dose were 1-2 mL, 3 times/day, the patient would receive the equivalent of about 100-200 mg of dried herb, 3 times/day, or up to 600 mg/day.
- To determine the appropriate dose for each individual for any given clinical encounter, consider the strength of the herb, the strength of the preparation, the quality and freshness of the herbs that went into the product, and the size, weight, age, and needs of the patient. For instance, hydroalcoholic tinctures are usually manufactured at a concentration of anywhere from 3:1 to 10:1, and most are around 5:1. The recommended dose listed on bottles of these tincture products tends to be 20 to 80 drops, several times daily. More experienced western herbal practitioners tend to prescribe up to 5 mL of a hydroalcoholic tincture, 3 to 5 times/day, as an initial therapeutic dose, and about 1-2 mL, 2 to 3 times/day as a maintenance dose.
- We recommend adjusting the dose within this range of doses based on the individual situation. Smaller people need a smaller dose than a very large person. Young children need a smaller dose than an adult. Very young children usually need only a few drops to obtain a therapeutic response. Weak or sensitive individuals need (or can tolerate) a smaller dose than a robust, healthy person.
- Usually, it is best to start a person on a new herb or formula at the minimum dose to check for sensitivity and response before going on to a larger dose if no response is noted. For long-term use, the dose can often be half of the therapeutic dose as a maintenance dose. It is important to note that the dose should never be thought of as static and fixed for all circumstances. Use your best judgment, taking into account the situation, and always adjust the dose rather than dispensing an herb in the same dose for every situation and person.

SAFETY FIRST GUIDELINES

Some herbs are dangerous to our health, or they haven't been tested yet. Please, read carefully!

Ajowan
Arnica
Bitter Almond
Boldo Leaf
Buchu
Calamus
Camphor
yellow or brown
Caraway
Cassia
Cinnamon
Clove
Elecampane root
Horseradish
Jaborandi
Mugwort
Mustard
Parsley seed
Pennyroyal
Peru Balsam
Rue
Sage
Santoina
Sassafras
Savin
Savory
Southernwood
Tansy
Thuja
Tonka Bean
Wintergreen
Wormseed
Wormwood

DANGERS & SAFETY OF HERBS

Avoid During Pregnancy

Here are some Herbs to AVOID during pregnancy, or pre-pregnancy. If you think you are pregnant do not use these herbs. This is just a common list. Please, avoid all herbs in pregnancy, and breastfeeding.

Aniseed
Armois
Basil
Birch
Cornmint
Fennel
Hyssop
Lavender
Stoechas
Lavender
Cotton
Marjoram
Myrrh
Oregano
Pimenta
racemosa
Star Anise
Tarragon
Rose
Rosemary
Parsley

Irritant Herbs

Allergic Reaction Herbs & Plants for Sensitive Skin
Almond Oil
Lanolin
Cocoa Butter
Primrose
Cucumber
Violet Leaves
Glycerin
Lemon

- POISONOUS PLANTS and OTHER TOXIC AGENTS
- The following list is composed of those agents known to be deadly. Numbers indicate more than one plant with that name.
- Abrus
- Aconite/Monkshood
- Aconite, Carmichael's
- Adonis
- Alder Buckthorn
- Ambrosia-2
- Anemone (all)
- Apple, Bitter
- Apple, Balsam
- Arnica
- Arrowwood
- Arum
- Asarabacca
- Ash, Mountain-1
- Asthma Weed
- Baneberry, Red
- Baneberry, White
- Bearded Darnel
- Belladonna
- Belladonna, Japanese
- Birthwort
- Birthwort, Frail
- Bittersweet, American
- Black Cohosh
- Blackroot
- Bloodroot
- Blue Flag
- Bog Rosemary
- Bonduc Nut
- Borax
- Boxthorn
- Boxwood
- Broom, Scotch
- Broom, Spanish
- Bryony
- Bryony, White
- Buttercup (all)
- Butterfly Bush
- Butterfly Weed
- Cabbage, Skunk
- Calabar Bean
- Camphor (all)
- Casca Bark
- Castor Bean
- Centipede
- Columbine
- Foxglove
- Hemlock

- Henbane
- Jack-in-the-Pulpit
- Lily-of-the-Valley
- May Apple
- Melon, Bitter Indochinese
- Peony
- Poinsettia
- Pokeweed
- Stargrass
- Wormwood

DANGEROUS PLANTS

The following plants have mild to severe cautions attached to their use.

Achryanthes Root
Alder Buckthorn
Alexander, Golden
Ambrosia-2
Anemarrhena
Angelica
Apricot
Apricot, Japanese
Ars smart
Ashwagandha
Asparagus
Avens
Avens, Water
Bahia Powder
Barberry, Common
Barrenwort
Bay
Bayberry
Bead Tree
Bearberry
Bee Pollen
Beechdrops
Bergamot
Bethroot
Bindweed
Bindweed, Hedge
Bindweed, Jalap
Birch (all)
Bishop Flower
Bisnaga
Black Cherry
Blackberry Lily
Bladderwrack
Blazing Star
Bogbean
Boldo

- Boneset (all)
- Borage
- Broom, Dyer's
- Broomweed
- Brucea
- Buchu
- Buckwheat
- Bugleweed
- Bupleurum
- Burdock
- Burnut
- Butter-and-Eggs
- Butternut
- Cactus, Living Rock
- Cajuput
- Calendula
- Canaigre
- Cannabis
- Caraway
- Cardamom, True
- Cascara Sagrada
- Cashew
- Cat's Claw
- Cattail
- Cayenne
- Cedar, White
- Celandine
- Celery
- Cereus, Night-blooming
- Chamomile
- Chervil
- Chicory
- Cinnamon
- Clover, Red
- Cohosh, Blue
- Coltsfoot
- Comfrey
- Crampbark
- Echinacea
- Elder
- Ephedra, American
- Fennel
- Feverfew
- Figwort
- Fo-ti
- Geranium, Scented
- Ginkgo
- Ginseng
- Ginseng, Siberian
- Goldenseal
- Hops
- Horseradish
- Juniper
- Licorice
- Linden
- Lobelia
- Mug wort
- Mullein
- Nettle, Stinging
- Parsley
- Poplar, Balsam
- Poppy
- St Johnswort
- Sassafras
- Sorrel
- Stoneroot
- Tansy
- Thistle, Blessed
- Walnut, Black
- Willow (all)
- Wintergreen
- Yarrow

SAFETY WHEN MAKING DIFFERENT FORMS OF HERBS

Before we begin to get our supplies to make an herbal remedy we must use all safety and health precautions that we can.

- Always wear gloves
- Protect the work surface
- Use special pots to cook with, not the ones you cook food in
- Use stainless steel, carbon steel, or glass pots and containers and utensils
- Always wash each item before transferring to a new remedy
- Make sure all containers, utensils, work surface is clean and dry before use
- Wear an apron to protect clothing
- Do not use metal tea balls or spoons, the herbal oils can interact causing a chemical reaction
- Warning some pots, containers may be stained with the herbal dye.
- Follow all Food Safety, GSM, FDA & USDA Guidelines with ingredients, labeling, dispensing, batch record, and so on.

For making the different forms of herbs you will need some supplies; See additional PDF.

- Medium size cooking pot
- Small size cooking pot
- Wooden spoons
- Strainer Plastic
- Double boiler
- Quart and pint glass jar with lids
- Muslin or cheesecloth
- Rubber bands
- Measuring spoons and cups plastic or wooden
- Distilled water
- Colored glass jars with droppers for oils
- Glass Jars with lids 2oz or 4oz
- Plastic Cosmetic Grade small containers with lids
- Whisk
- Address labels
- Permanent marker
- Cloth Tea Bags
- Wooden Stir Sticks
- Wooden or Ceramic Mortar and Pestle
- Hot Plate
- Vegetable Parchment Paper
- Ceramic Tile
- Wooden Craft Sticks
- Brown Paper Bags
- Syringe or pipette

TOPICS TO REMEMBER

Remember these important topics for creating safe and effective herbal remedies:

- Always wear protective clothing, including gloves. Lotions, medicines, nail polish, and even nicotine can contaminate the remedy.
- Use separate spoons or wooden stir sticks for each ingredient or combination of ingredients. Clean each stick with white vinegar after use.
- Have designated herb cooking supplies, such as pots, spoons, measuring cups, and measuring spoons, that are not used for everyday cooking to avoid cross-contamination.
- Keep your cooking area clean and free of food particles.
- Use ceramic hot plates to cool remedies.
- Have flour or cornmeal on hand in case of spills.
- Do not make remedies for others while sick. Have an understudy make the remedy instead.
- Use clean pots, pans, and stir sticks, and clean them with white vinegar (not bleach) or a mixture of lemon juice and baking soda. Use a clean brush, sponge, or loofah to clean herb pots and paper towel or muslin cloth to dry.
- Store your herbal kitchen supplies separately from everyday cooking supplies.
- Use glass or culinary/cosmetic grade remedy containers with labeled dates. Avoid using tin containers as some herbs interact with them. If using glass, use plastic seal lids and protect the jar rings with muslin cloth to avoid mold and rust.
- Never heat herbal remedies in plastic measuring cups. Use glass instead as formaldehyde can interact with the remedy.
- While it is not recommended, microwaves can be used to create herbal remedies in a pinch. However, gas stoves, wood burning stoves, and portable camping stoves can contaminate the remedy. The best option is an electric stove or hot plate, although some herbalists believe that no heating of remedies is safe.
- Keep a remedy making journal and back it up electronically and in writing to avoid losing important formulas.
- Safety is paramount when creating and using herbal remedies. Know your herbs and how to use them correctly and safely to protect your reputation and produce effective remedies.
- Keep your recipes safe and put a copyright logo and date on them to prevent theft. However, it is acceptable to alter a recipe to fit specific needs.
- Sanitization and safety are critical when dealing with herbs, both in purchasing and preparing them. Importance should be placed on preparing the food or sanitizing medical equipment to avoid harmful bacteria.
- Even experienced herbalists may not realize the importance of safety and cleanliness. Nicotine on hands, lotions, and other substances can contaminate remedies. Use separate utensils and follow guidelines to avoid reactions between herbs.

PRACTICE SAFE FOOD HANDLING

WASH YOUR HANDS!

To maintain good hygiene, follow these guidelines:

- Wash your hands often, especially after touching food, handling garbage, smoking, using the restroom, or handling chemicals/cleaner.
- Keep your hands away from your face and hair to prevent the transfer of germs from the nose to the mouth.
- Keep all areas clean, including the stockroom, freezer, and fridge.
- Use separate equipment for herbs.
- Keep garbage covered and away from the remedy making area.
- Store herbs/foods six inches above the floor in a cool, dry area away from sunlight.
- Seal everything and label it with the expiration date and/or creation date. Make sure all ingredients are listed in order from greatest to smallest.
- List the potency as 1X, 2X, and/or 3X.
- Place warning labels on items when necessary.
- Cross Contamination-

Cross contamination can occur in three ways:

1. People to food
2. Food to food
3. Equipment to food

To Prevent Contamination-

- Wear gloves.
- Use sanitized tools.
- Sanitize the workspace.
- Keep all uncooked foods away from cooked foods.
- Have separate herbal cooking equipment from everyday cooking equipment.

Studying each individual herb can take a lifetime. There are so many herbs out there. You can use the common backyard herbs that you can wild harvest, or you can purchase them from a company, co-op, or farmer's market. The choice of herbs is entirely up to the herbalist. Studying an herb may only come to some for specific health reasons and/or symptoms rather than a general broad study. However, studying herbs can benefit an herbalist in becoming a professional and master of herbs.

GUIDELINES

- Read and study the herb.
- Don't take herb identity for granted. Not all 'organic' herbs are organic or safe.
- Stick with the recommended dose.
- Know your allergies.
- Be aware of yourself, how you feel, and reactions.
- 65 and older should start with a low, diluted dose.
- If pregnant or nursing use herbs with caution or do not use herbs at all.
- Do not give healing herbs to children under 2.
- Use caution when giving to children under 12.
- Know the interactions with other drugs, and herbs.
- Think before using a new found herb or remedy.
- Be sparingly when using oils.
- Pay attention to symptoms of toxicity.
- Keep all of your physicians informed including pharmacists.
- Discontinue herbs before any surgery, including oral surgery.

RESPECT FOR NATURE OF HARVEST

Embracing Ethical Wildcrafting: A Pathway to Respecting Nature

In an era where sustainability and environmental consciousness are at the forefront of global discussions, the practice of ethical wildcrafting stands out as a profound way to connect with and respect nature. This ancient tradition, which involves gathering plants, herbs, and other natural resources from the wild, emphasizes sustainable harvesting and gratitude for what nature provides.

Understanding Wildcrafting

Wildcrafting is a practice that dates back centuries, rooted in the knowledge of indigenous peoples who understood and respected the ecological balance of their surroundings. It involves collecting plant materials from their natural habitats—forests, fields, and meadows—while ensuring that these ecosystems are not harmed in the process. This requires a deep understanding of the local flora and fauna, as well as a commitment to preserving the natural environment for future generations.

The Principles of Ethical Wildcrafting

To practice ethical wildcrafting, one must adhere to several key principles:

1. Sustainable Harvesting: This involves taking only what you need and ensuring that enough of the plant remains so it can continue to thrive. Overharvesting can lead to the depletion of resources and disrupt the delicate balance of ecosystems.
2. Gratitude and Respect: Approaching wildcrafting with a sense of gratitude is vital. This means acknowledging the gift that nature provides and understanding the importance of every plant and organism within an ecosystem. It's about forming a reciprocal relationship with nature—taking only what is needed and giving back whenever possible.
3. Knowledge and Awareness: Ethical wildcrafting requires a deep understanding of local plant species, including those that are endangered or at risk. Educating oneself about these plants and their roles within ecosystems is crucial to ensuring that wildcrafting activities do not contribute to their decline.
4. Minimal Impact: Wildcrafters should strive to leave no trace. This means minimizing impact on the land, not disturbing habitats, and ensuring that the natural beauty and integrity of the environment are preserved for others to enjoy.

The Benefits of Ethical Wildcrafting

Practicing ethical wildcrafting offers numerous benefits, both for individuals and the environment. On a personal level, it fosters a deeper connection with nature and encourages mindfulness and appreciation for the natural world. It also provides an opportunity to learn about local ecosystems and the medicinal and nutritional benefits of various plants.

For the environment, ethical wildcrafting helps maintain biodiversity and supports the health of ecosystems. By practicing sustainable harvesting, wildcrafters play a role in conserving plant species and ensuring that natural resources remain available for wildlife and future generations.

Conclusion

Incorporating ethical wildcrafting into our lives is a powerful way to honor and respect the natural world. By harvesting sustainably and with gratitude, we can enjoy the bounties of nature while ensuring that they remain available for years to come. As more people embrace this practice, it holds the potential to inspire a broader movement towards environmental stewardship and sustainability, paving the way for a healthier planet.

HARVESTING HERBS

Introduction

Herbs are a versatile addition to culinary practices, and they can be utilized in various forms: fresh, dried, or fresh-frozen. Understanding the harvesting and drying processes is essential for preserving their flavor and aroma.

Guidelines for Herb Usage

- Use twice the amount of fresh or frozen herbs compared to dried herbs, as the dried form is more concentrated.

Harvesting Process

1. Timing:
   - The ideal time to harvest most herbs is when the flower buds begin to form, just before they bloom.
   - Harvesting in the morning, after the dew has dried, is recommended since volatile oils are at their peak during this time.
2. Preparation:
   - Rinse the herbs the night before harvesting by gently spraying off any dirt to ensure cleanliness.
3. Harvesting Technique:
   - For annual plants, you can harvest up to 50% of the plant by cutting the stem at least 4 inches above ground, above active growth, allowing for potential regrowth.
   - For perennial plants, limit the harvest to one-third of the plant, or focus on only the growing tips to promote health and regrowth.
4. Tools:
   - Use sharp shears or a knife to avoid damaging the root systems, which can affect growth in subsequent seasons.
   - If harvesting roots, cut them into small pieces and dry them using mechanical methods to ensure proper dehydration.

Drying Methods

- Air Drying: The simplest and most traditional method, allowing for preservation of volatile oils.
- Food Dehydrators: These devices circulate a gentle flow of air to speed up the drying process and are a worthwhile investment for those who regularly store large quantities of food and herbs.

Conclusion

Proper harvesting and drying techniques are vital for maintaining the quality of herbs. By following these guidelines, you can ensure that your herbs retain their flavor and aroma, enriching your culinary creations.

Harvesting, Drying, and Preserving Medicinal Plants

The process of harvesting, drying, and preserving medicinal plants plays a pivotal role in ensuring the quality and efficacy of plant-based remedies. These steps, deeply rooted in both traditional know-how and scientific research, are designed to preserve the active ingredients from the moment of harvest to their eventual transformation into medicinal preparations.

Harvesting

Ethical and ecological principles guide the harvesting of medicinal plants to sustain plant resources and maintain high-quality raw materials. It is crucial to gather plants from pollution-free environments, respecting their natural life cycles. Harvesting should be conducted sustainably, taking only a portion of the plants and ensuring the regeneration of wild populations. For rare or threatened species, sourcing from specialized producers or cultivated varieties is advised.

The timing of the harvest is critical. Different plant organs, such as roots, leaves, flowers, and fruits, should be harvested at stages when they are richest in active compounds. For instance, flowers are typically collected at the start of blooming, leaves just before flowering, and roots in autumn when the plant's reserves are highest.

The time of day also influences the quality of the harvest. Plants should be collected in the morning, post-dew and pre-sunrise heat, to prevent the loss of volatile compounds. Harvesting during dry weather further mitigates the risk of microbial growth.

Drying

Post-harvest, rapid and proper drying is essential to preserve the plants' active ingredients and prevent deterioration. The purpose of drying is to remove free water from plant tissues while maintaining their chemical integrity.

Drying techniques vary depending on plant organs and tradition. Air drying in a dry, ventilated, and shaded area is the simplest and most common method. Plants are spread thinly on drying racks or hung in bunches, turned regularly for even drying. For denser or more water-laden organs like roots and fruits, low-temperature drying (30-40°C) in an oven or dryer may be required. This controlled method is faster but can result in the loss of volatile compounds.

Drying must reduce the moisture content to below 10% to prevent degradation. However, excessive heat or rapid drying can damage active compounds, reducing plant quality.

Preservation

Once dried, plants must be stored correctly to retain their medicinal properties. Key factors include controlling humidity, light, temperature, and preventing insect or fungal infestations.

Dried plants should be kept in airtight containers, shielded from moisture and light, with tinted glass jars or kraft paper bags being ideal. Plastic containers should be avoided due to potential chemical interactions. Storage temperatures should be cool and stable, between 10 and 20°C, as temperature fluctuations can degrade active principles and encourage mold growth.

Regular inspections for insect infestations or fungal growth are imperative. Contaminated plants should be discarded, and containers cleaned to halt the spread. The shelf life of dried plants varies: aromatic plants and flowers last 1 to 2 years, leaves 2 to 3 years, and roots 3 to 5 years. Labeling containers with harvest dates and routinely renewing the stock ensures optimal quality.

Besides drying, some medicinal plants can be preserved as mother tinctures or medicinal oils, offering longer-term preservation of active compounds. These preparations demand specific expertise and strict manufacturing conditions.

Historical Insight

The story of the 16th-century Pharmacist of Venice highlights the importance of quality plant materials. Renowned for his effective plant-based remedies, he harvested his plants personally, adhering to ancestral harvesting and drying methods. Using terracotta pots for storage, he protected his plants from moisture and insects, illustrating how meticulous attention to each step ensured the quality and reputation of his preparations.

By mastering these practices, modern herbalists uphold the tradition of ensuring high-quality plant raw materials, which in turn guarantees the efficacy and safety of their remedies. This expertise is crucial for the traceability and quality of plant-based products, from fresh plants to the final medicinal preparation.

A Guide to Purchasing Dried Herbs: Ensuring Quality and Freshness

As an herbalist, the quality and freshness of your herbs are paramount to achieving the desired effects in your remedies and formulations. This guide will walk you through the essential steps to ensure you are purchasing the best dried herbs available.

Understanding Quality in Dried Herbs

Before purchasing, it's important to understand what constitutes quality in dried herbs:

1. Color: High-quality dried herbs should retain a vibrant color similar to their fresh state. Fading often indicates poor handling or old stock.
2. Aroma: The scent should be strong and characteristic of the herb. A weak or musty smell can suggest degradation or improper drying.
3. Texture: Herbs should be crisp and break easily, indicating they have been dried properly. Any sign of dampness or stickiness is a red flag.
4. Origin and Harvesting: Knowing where and how the herbs were grown and harvested can provide insight into their quality. Organically grown herbs are generally preferred as they are free from pesticides and other chemicals.

Where to Buy Quality Dried Herbs

When it comes to purchasing dried herbs, consider the following sources:

Herb Shops and Apothecaries

- Specialty Stores: These often have a curated selection of herbs and knowledgeable staff who can assist with specific needs.
- Local Apothecarists: They might offer herbs grown in optimal conditions and with appropriate harvesting techniques.

Online Retailers

- Reputable Websites: Look for online stores with positive reviews and transparent sourcing information.
- Direct from Farmers: Some farmers sell directly to consumers, offering fresh, high-quality products.

Factors to Consider When Purchasing

To ensure you obtain the best quality dried herbs, keep these factors in mind:

Packaging

- Airtight Containers: Herbs should be stored in airtight containers to preserve freshness and potency.
- Opaque Packaging: Light can degrade herbs, so opt for packaging that protects from exposure.

Certifications and Labels

- Organic Certification: Indicates that the herbs are grown without synthetic fertilizers or pesticides.
- Fair Trade Certification: Ensures ethical practices in the production process.

Supplier Reputation

- Customer Reviews: Check reviews and testimonials to gauge the reliability of the supplier.
- Longevity in Business: Established suppliers are more likely to have consistent quality standards.

Storing Dried Herbs

Proper storage is crucial to maintaining the quality of your dried herbs:

- Cool, Dry Place: Store herbs away from heat and moisture, which can cause spoilage.
- Dark Environment: Protect them from light to prevent degradation.
- Labeling: Keep track of purchase dates to ensure you use the oldest stock first.

Conclusion

Purchasing dried herbs requires careful consideration and attention to detail to ensure you are getting high-quality products. By understanding the markers of quality, choosing reputable suppliers, and storing your herbs properly, you can maintain the potency and effectiveness of your herbal remedies. As an herbalist, your commitment to quality not only enhances your practice but also the health and well-being of those you serve.

UNDERSTANDING HERBAL ENERGETICS

Herbal Energetics: A Guide to Nature's Healing Properties

In the world of herbal medicine, the concept of energetics offers a fascinating lens through which we can understand the healing properties of plants. Herbal energetics involves recognizing the inherent qualities of herbs—such as warming, cooling, drying, and moistening—that affect the body in unique ways. By understanding these basic energetics, we can select the right herbs to support our health and balance.

Warming Herbs

Warming herbs are known for their ability to stimulate and invigorate. They are particularly beneficial when the body feels sluggish or when circulation needs a boost. These herbs, such as ginger and cayenne pepper, increase warmth and vitality, making them ideal for cold conditions. Their stimulating nature can also enhance digestion and relieve cold-related discomforts.

Cooling Herbs

In contrast, cooling herbs provide relief from excessive heat or inflammation. They help soothe and calm, making them ideal for conditions characterized by excess heat, such as fevers or skin irritations. Peppermint and chamomile are classic examples of cooling herbs. They work to gently reduce heat and restore balance, offering a sense of relief and tranquility.

Drying Herbs

Herbs with drying properties are beneficial when there is an overabundance of moisture in the body. They help to absorb excess fluids and can be particularly useful in cases of congestion or dampness. Sage and nettle fall into this category, helping to dry up mucus and reduce swelling. These herbs are often employed when dealing with respiratory issues or fluid retention.

Moistening Herbs

Moistening herbs, on the other hand, are ideal for dry conditions. They help to hydrate tissues and alleviate dryness within the body. Marshmallow root and licorice are well-known for their moistening abilities, soothing irritated tissues and providing relief in conditions like dry coughs or skin irritations. These herbs work to restore moisture, promoting comfort and healing.

Finding Balance

The true art of using herbal energetics lies in finding balance. Just as each herb possesses distinct energetic qualities, so does each individual. By understanding our body's needs and identifying imbalances, we can choose herbs that complement and restore our natural equilibrium. Whether it's warming a cold body, cooling an overheated system, drying excess moisture, or adding hydration, the right herbs can profoundly impact overall well-being.

Incorporating herbal energetics into our daily lives allows us to tap into the wisdom of nature. As we learn to listen to our bodies and understand the energetic properties of herbs, we open up new pathways to health and healing. Embrace the journey of discovering herbal energetics, and let nature's remedies guide you towards a harmonious and balanced life.

SIMPLERS' METHOD OF CALCULATING PROPORTIONS

In this lesson, we will discuss common herbs that can be found not just in Kentucky, but also in our own planted gardens or at an herb store. These herbs can be prepackaged and have a variety of uses. However, the uses for each individual herb can be overwhelming. In this lesson, we will discuss some of these herbs, their common uses, how to make them, what part of the herb to use for different needs, and common recipes.

To assist you in using the Simpler Method for recipes that use parts as measurements, we have included a measuring equivalent chart for quick reference. When making a recipe, the first thing to do is to choose your pot, double boiler, glass jar, or cup. For example, if you choose an 8 oz mug and your salve recipe calls for 1 part dandelion, 1 part chamomile, 1 part comfrey, 1 part lavender, olive oil, and beeswax, that's 4 parts of herbs. Four parts of an 8 oz mug equals 2 oz, since 4 divided into 8 equals 2. Therefore, each part equals 2 oz.

The amount of olive oil you need depends on the amount of herbs you have. The oil should barely cover the top of all of the herbs combined, with a little extra added just in case the remedy gets too hot. For the beeswax, ¼ of a cup or 1 oz is normally used for 8 oz, but sometimes you need to add a little more to make the salve thicker or a little less to make it thinner.

It is recommended to use local beeswax that is rich in color, rather than store-bought beeswax that has been condensed and does not hold the necessary constituents or phytochemical properties.

If you want to make a smaller amount of salve, you can use a tablespoon as 1 part. Fill a glass measuring cup with your herbs as indicated in parts, then add your oil with a little extra, and place the mixture in a glass jar in a pot of simmering water. Simmer for at least 2 hours, being careful not to burn or over-boil the mixture, and ensuring that the cooking area is well-ventilated. For herbs that are very aromatic, like eucalyptus, place a jar lid with punched out holes over the jar. Once the oil has turned colors, strain the oil from the herbs using muslin cloth, assisted with a rubber band on another glass canning jar.

After straining, place the oil back in the pot with the simmering water, add the beeswax, and stir until the beeswax is melted. You can test a small amount of the mixture to see the thickness of the salve. After straining, discard the fused herbal fragments.

To make the salve more potent, you can add more herbs after the first time of straining and simmer again for another hour before straining again.

To thicken the mixture, add a teaspoon of beeswax at a time and test to see if the consistency is correct for a salve. When the mixture is complete, fill your colored container with the mixture, apply an airtight lid, keep it out of sunlight in a dry area, and label it. The salve's shelf life is about 3 months. Remember that after the salve has time to harden, the color may become darker. Allow the salve to cure for at least 24 hours before using.

TIP- For allowing the salve to cool, you can place it in the freezer for 1 hour, but make sure you take it out and cure it. Some herbalists do not cure their recipes before using, but it is important for all of the ingredients to settle.

TIP- 1 pint or 16 oz of oil will normally need about 1 ½ oz of beeswax. 1 oz of oil will need ½ tsp of beeswax.

POTENCY METHOD (MY METHOD)

Not many herbalists practice what I call the Potency Method. This method is based on the properties or components of the chosen herbs when making a remedy for a specific purpose. The potency of a remedy is just as important as knowing which herbs complement each other and which ones counteract each other if combined in a remedy. It's important to follow a few steps before understanding the potency method: 1) know the components of the herbs, 2) know which herbs can and cannot be combined, 3) know the potency levels for each individual, such as a child, 4) know how to make the remedy, 5) create a recipe from scratch, 6) record data from proven cases and tests of success, and 7) process the remedy for sale.

To begin, you need to know the herb's components. You should have studied this in the Introduction to Herbalism lesson. You may use the reference given in that lesson, along with the chart above and the PDF chart of Healing Herbs, to help you learn about an herb's properties or components. First, you need to ask and answer a few questions about the remedy you need, for example, if you are making a first aid salve for burns, cuts, scrapes, etc.

What type of herbs do you need? For example, you may need vulnerary, anti-inflammatory, and antiseptic herbs. As a general rule, it's best to choose no more than three herbs to start with.

By looking at the Healing Herb PDF chart and referring to the lesson Introduction to Herbalism, can you name some herbs we could use?

Examples:

- Calendula
- Comfrey
- Aloe
- And many more...

According to the reference from the lesson Introduction to Herbalism and the Healing Herbs PDF chart, calendula and comfrey are both listed as vulneraries, which are healing agents. Therefore, to avoid potential adverse effects, it is recommended to only pick one of those herbs, calendula with aloe, or comfrey with aloe.

If you are making a remedy for a child, the elderly, or pregnant or nursing women, it is important to consider the safety of the herbs used. Calendula and comfrey are not considered safe for internal use in these groups. Therefore, it is recommended to use calendula and aloe for external use only.

To determine the potency levels of the herbs, it is important to refer to the chart provided in the document. Calendula and comfrey have stronger components than aloe, so more of those herbs should be added to the recipe.

A recommended recipe for a 1x potency salve includes:

- 2 tsp of calendula
- 1 tsp of aloe gel or oil
- 1 cup of extra virgin olive oil
- 1 oz of beeswax

It is recommended to follow the basic recipe for making the salve, and to label and cure the salve for 24 hours before testing. To test the recipe, 5-10 volunteers should try the recipe for 1 week and keep a provings journal. If the recipe proves successful for at least 7 out of 10 volunteers, there is no need to make any changes to the recipe.

POTENCY METHOD (MY METHOD)

To make a cold processed herbal infused oil, it is recommended to use the same herbs as before, calendula and aloe, and a 1x potency recipe. A recommended recipe includes:

- 6 tbsp of calendula
- 2 tbsp of aloe gel
- 1 cup of carrier oil

After placing the herbs in a glass jar with the carrier oil, secure with an unbleached muslin cloth or un-dyed paper towel, and sit in the window seal for 1 week. Shake daily, then strain and place the oil into the salve.

It is important to note that internal formulary is different than external, and administering home remedies to infants and young children is not recommended without professional guidance. It is recommended to follow the suggested intake consumption plan for internal remedies, and to consider safety guidelines when making any remedy.

BUILDING A HOME APOTHECARY: FIRST AID

Building a Home Apothecary: A Beginner's Guide

In recent years, there's been a growing interest in natural remedies and holistic health practices. One way to embrace this lifestyle is by building your own home apothecary. A home apothecary allows you to create natural remedies for common ailments, promote wellness, and even add delightful flavors to your culinary creations. If you're new to this endeavor, starting with a few versatile and easy-to-grow herbs is a great first step.

Chamomile: A Calming Classic

Chamomile is a staple in any home apothecary due to its calming properties. Often used as a tea, chamomile can help alleviate stress and promote restful sleep. Its anti-inflammatory effects also make it useful for soothing skin irritations. Growing chamomile is relatively easy; it thrives in sunlit areas and well-drained soil. With its gentle, apple-like aroma, chamomile can quickly become a favorite in your herbal collection.

Peppermint: Refreshing and Revitalizing

Peppermint is another essential herb that should be part of your apothecary. Known for its invigorating scent, peppermint can be used to relieve headaches, improve digestion, and even boost mental clarity. Its leaves can be brewed into a refreshing tea or used in homemade balms and lotions. Peppermint grows well in containers, which helps contain its vigorous spreading nature, making it perfect for small spaces or indoor gardens.

Lavender: The Versatile Soother

Lavender is celebrated for its soothing scent and myriad uses. Whether used as an essential oil, in sachets, or as a culinary herb, lavender's calming properties are well-documented. It can help reduce anxiety, improve sleep, and even repel insects naturally. Lavender plants thrive in sunny spots with well-drained soil, producing beautiful purple flowers that add both visual and aromatic appeal to your apothecary.

Getting Started

To start your home apothecary, you'll need to consider where to grow your herbs. A sunny windowsill, balcony, or garden plot can all serve as excellent locations. Additionally, you'll need basic supplies like pots, soil, and gardening tools. Once your herbs are growing, you can explore different ways to use them—whether through teas, tinctures, or homemade beauty products.

Conclusion

Building a home apothecary is a rewarding journey that encourages self-sufficiency and a deeper connection to nature. By starting with versatile herbs like chamomile, peppermint, and lavender, you'll lay a strong foundation for creating natural remedies that support your health and wellbeing. As you expand your apothecary, you'll find endless opportunities to learn and grow, both in your garden and in your understanding of herbal medicine.

FIRST AID HERBS

Herbs have been used in First Aide ever since I can remember. If I got stung by a sweat bee or bit by a mosquito while in the garden harvesting my dad would grab some plantain by crushing the leaves with his fingers then he would smear it and rub it all over the area. The plantain took away the skin and or the bite. My skin was a little green but it worked.

There are so many remedies that my dad, grandparents, and great grandparents knew but as a child you miss those things until you get older and then realize how important it was to pay attention. If I only had documentation of all of those remedies, that's why it is important to pay attention to older people, but also for them to write it down somewhere for the future generations.

In First Aid it is always a good idea to have these items stored up ready to use just in case of an emergency for you see emergencies occur faster then you have time to prepare some herbal remedies.

I like to use melted beeswax cooled to cover over a small wound to protect the skin from water and bacteria. I also like to use sage, basil, and thyme for anti-venom remedy of spider bites in a poultice. When you are pregnant and have got bitten you have to act fast. Believe me I have got bitten during both of my pregnancies at work no doubt where there were no herbs to use. So if you work out of the home carry a small First Aid Remedy kit with you in your car, office, or locker. Least to say I ended up at the emergency room where I had to wait 1 hour before seeing anyone good thing it wasn't a poisonous spider! When I got home the poultice was applied and within 1 hour the area was cured. The spider was a Crab Vegetation Spider, it bit hard, and left a whole to remember him/her by. If you ever get bit by a spider, keep the spider in between clear tape to look the spider's name and species up, that is if you did what I did, stomped it.

Herbs are very universal when it comes to their uses, and properties. Ex. Sage works great as a mosquito deterrent but it also works as an antiseptic-reducing or preventing infection. With sage I could make an antiseptic spray, salve, cream, oil, candle and much more. If you wanted to make a First Aid salve for inflamed skin, first you would look to see what herbs are used for anti-inflammatory and healing. I like to use chamomile, or carrot oil, or aloe, or calendula, sometimes I blend them together in beeswax. Petroleum jelly can be used but you have to remember it is not an all natural substance. I like to use even liquid glycerin if I want to make an antiseptic soap for first aid remedies.

RECORD KEEPING

Record Keeping Keep a herbal journal to document experiences, recipes, and observations.

In the age of digital everything, the timeless practice of keeping a journal holds its own, especially for herbal enthusiasts. A herbal journal is more than a mere notebook; it's a personal compendium of experiences, recipes, and observations that enrich your journey through the world of herbs.

Why Keep a Herbal Journal?

At its core, a herbal journal is a tool for growth and learning. It allows you to document your interactions with various herbs, noting how they affect your well-being or influence your culinary creations. This record-keeping can enhance your understanding of each plant's unique properties and uses.

Documenting Experiences

Every time you engage with herbs, whether through gardening, cooking, or crafting remedies, your journal becomes a canvas for your experiences. Record the conditions in which your plants thrive, the challenges you face, and the triumphs you celebrate. These notes can be invaluable when planning future herbal adventures.

Recipe Repository

A herbal journal serves as a personal cookbook, capturing your favorite recipes and concoctions. Whether it's a soothing tea blend, a healing salve, or a flavorful seasoning, jotting down these creations ensures that your culinary and medicinal experiments are never lost to memory. Plus, revisiting these pages can provide inspiration for new endeavors.

Observing Nature

Herbal journaling encourages you to become a keen observer of nature. Regularly documenting how plants change through the seasons, their growth patterns, and their interactions with wildlife deepens your connection to the natural world. These observations can also guide your gardening practices, helping you cultivate a more thriving herb garden.

The Creative Process

Journaling is not just about recording facts; it's a creative process. Use sketches, pressed leaves, or photographs to complement your written entries. This artistic expression can make your journal a beautiful and inspiring reflection of your herbal journey.

Getting Started

To start your herbal journal, choose a notebook that resonates with you. It could be a simple spiral-bound book or an ornate leather-bound journal. The key is to find something that encourages you to write and explore. Dedicate time regularly to update your journal, and soon it will become a cherished companion in your herbal exploration.

In essence, a herbal journal is a testament to your evolving relationship with the plant world. It captures the essence of your journey, preserving both the mundane and the magical moments. So, pick up a pen, open your journal, and let your herbal story unfold.

RECIPES & PROVINGS

Keeping a journal, or what I call a database, of your experiments, clients, recipes, and provings is a great way to analyze the success of your research. Please remember to keep clients' information confidential by using numbers as a reference to their identity. Provings are the results from volunteers using a new recipe.

Database software like Microsoft Access or Open Office is a great way to save and record client information. However, it may take some time to get the program up and running, so having a paper backup file is a good idea to begin with. Remember to have a backup copy on an external hard drive or on the web. I lost my entire database when my computer crashed, even though I had the paper copies. It will take a very long time to replace 20 years worth of data.

Recording in your journal or database should become a habit. When creating a recipe, the proper records and descriptions of the making process are important. I can't tell you how many times I have forgotten to write down an ingredient when creating a recipe. Later on, when I wanted to make the recipe again, I left out an important ingredient. Before attempting to make any recipe, please read and study the herb formula before using. Know what you are using. Follow all safety guidelines not only dealing with herbs, but also prepare the kitchen area to be sanitary.

I have created the worksheets that follow for you to begin proving your recipe. I suggest starting with one recipe using the sheets provided and creating a binder as you go. Don't get overwhelmed if you cannot complete all of the information at this time. You can always go back and record it later. If you refer back to your recipe while making the remedy, be sure to use sheet protectors over your records in your binder. Once you have my samples down, feel free to create or have someone create record sheets just for you. However, you are welcome to continue printing and using mine, but please do not sell them or the template.

You can also use the worksheets provided to research the success of several different methods of the same recipe. For example, hot infused herbal oil or cold infused herbal oil. Which method works better for which ailment? Keeping this information is very important if you intend to sell the products.

The scientific method is the best method to use for any experiment. For more information on the scientific method, visit www.wikipedia.org.

Problem
Hypothesis
Experiment
Observation
Conclusion

I have included an example of my herb journal and a blank herb journal for you to use. The blank one can be used as a guideline to go by later on in the course.

GSP & FDA

The Good Standard Process (GSP) is a quality management system that the US FDA utilizes to ensure that products are consistently produced and controlled according to established quality standards. This process is vital in regulating and monitoring the safety and efficacy of products sold to consumers. Although the GSP does not regulate herbs and plants, it has regulations regarding labeling and dispensing. These regulations aim to ensure that consumers are fully informed about the herbs and plants they purchase and that they are dispensed safely and appropriately. By adhering to these regulations, the GSP plays a critical role in protecting the health and well-being of consumers. It is important to note that one of the key regulations in place is regarding labeling. Manufacturers must adhere to labeling requirements to ensure that consumers are fully informed about the herbs and plants they are purchasing. The regulations regarding the label include details such as the product name, dosage information, expiration date, and any potential side effects. By having these details on the label, consumers can make informed decisions about the products they are purchasing, ultimately leading to better health outcomes.
I have included the GSP documentation for you as an Ebook.
The FDA's role in regulating the food industry includes ensuring that food is safe for consumption, accurately labeled, and free from harmful contaminants. They also monitor and regulate food additives, such as preservatives and coloring agents, to ensure that they do not pose any health risks to consumers.
In addition to food, the FDA also plays a crucial role in regulating the production and distribution of drugs in the United States. They ensure that drugs are safe and effective before they are approved for sale to the public. The FDA also regulates the labeling and packaging of drugs to ensure that consumers have access to accurate information about the drugs they are taking.
Overall, the FDA's role is to protect public health by ensuring that the food and drug industry is held to the highest safety standards.
As herbalists, it is crucial that we have a comprehensive understanding of all the regulations, stage guidelines, local guidelines, and laws that are relevant to our practice of herbalist consulting. Being knowledgeable about these aspects of our profession allows us to provide the best possible service to our clients, while also ensuring that we are in compliance with all relevant requirements at all times. This includes being aware of any changes or updates to these guidelines over time, as well as staying up-to-date on any new laws or regulations that may be introduced. By staying informed and always striving to improve our knowledge of these critical aspects of our work, we can continue to grow as herbalists and provide the highest level of service to our clients.

LEARNING FROM TRADITION & SCIENCE

Learning from Tradition and Science: A Balanced Approach

In today's rapidly evolving world, the pursuit of knowledge demands a harmonious blend of traditional wisdom and scientific inquiry. By embracing both the time-honored practices that have stood the test of time and the cutting-edge advancements of modern research, individuals can gain a more comprehensive and nuanced understanding of various subjects.

Studying traditional uses often involves delving into historical texts, cultural practices, and oral traditions that have been passed down through generations. These sources offer invaluable insights into how previous societies understood and interacted with the world around them. For example, traditional medicine has long utilized natural remedies, many of which are still relevant today. By studying these practices, we can appreciate the depth of indigenous knowledge and its contributions to contemporary health and wellness.

On the other hand, modern research provides a systematic and evidence-based approach to understanding phenomena. Scientific studies, peer-reviewed journals, and technological advancements offer concrete data and insights that help validate or challenge traditional beliefs. This rigorous approach ensures that our knowledge is continually refined and expanded, allowing for a more accurate interpretation of the world.

To effectively study both traditional uses and modern research, one must employ a variety of resources. Courses designed to offer this balanced perspective often include a diverse array of materials. These may range from ancient scripts and ethnographic studies to the latest scientific papers and experimental data. Additionally, engaging with experts from both fields—such as historians, scientists, and cultural practitioners—can provide invaluable firsthand knowledge and foster a deeper understanding.

A successful course will also encourage critical thinking, prompting students to question assumptions and draw connections between different areas of study. Through discussions, projects, and case studies, learners can develop the skills necessary to analyze information from both traditional and scientific viewpoints.

Ultimately, by integrating the wisdom of the past with the innovations of the present, we can cultivate a richer, more holistic view of the world. This balanced approach not only enhances personal growth but also contributes to a more informed and harmonious society.

I have included an eBook of Basic Skills in the course.

Herbal Basics Course book

Infusions

There are many different ways to prepare an infusion. I will discuss only a few in this lesson. There are also different potency recommendations for each individual's needs.

Water Infusion Recipe

You will need;

1 ounce of dried herb
1 quart (32 oz) of RO water
1 quart glass jar
Muslin strain cloth
Rubber band
Stirring stick
Cooking pot

How to make a water infusion:

1. Weigh out one ounce of dried herb and put it into a quart jar. Using dried plant material is very important, since drying the plant breaks down the cell wall which allows the nutrients to move from the plant material into the water. For woody herbs, crush the herbs with mortar and pestle before use.
2. Pour boiling water over the herb to fill the jar.
3. Stir, so that all of the plant material is covered by water.
4. Cap the jar and allow it to steep in the jar for at least four hours. Strain using the muslin cloth and the rubber band to secure and drink. You can drink this infusion at room temperature or heat it or chill it. You can also add honey, stevia, milk, cream, or mix the infusion with juice or another tea.

How to store your infusion:

Preparations like these infusions made with water as their base have a pretty short shelf life. They can be stored in the refrigerator for a couple of days.

Boiling Water Infusion

You will need;

1 cup of RO water
1 tsp of dried herb
1 ceramic cup
Muslin strain cloth
Rubber band
Stirring stick
Cooking pot

How to make boiling water infusion

1. place the RO water into a cooking pot and boil
2. place the 1 tsp of dried herb into the boiling water
3. simmer for 10-20 minutes until herb becomes translucent in color
4. strain the herb water using the muslin cloth and a rubber band to secure
5. then allow to cool come and drink
6. you can add honey, stevia, milk, or other juice to sweeten

I also love making infusions by using the coffee pot. I use the recipe 1 tsp of dried herb to 1 cup of RO water. However, for a stronger infusion I add additional herbs to the infused water and re-run the water through the coffee pot once again.

Infused Oils

There are many different infused oil recipes as well. I will only discuss the two that I have found to be effective. Infused oils are for topical application such as in salves, liniments, and or salad oils.

Hot Processed Infused Oil for salve making

You will need;

1-2 tbsp of dried herbs
1 cup of olive oil (you can also use soybean, almond, jojoba, coconut oils)
1 colored glass jar
Double boiler
Muslin strain cloth
Rubber bands or coated hair bands

How to make hot processed infused oil

1. place the cup of oil into the double boiler
2. add the herbs
3. allow to simmer for 30 minutes
4. strain with muslin cloth
5. store in airtight colored jar

Cold Processed Infused Oil

You will need;

1 pint glass jar
Dried herbs
4 cups of olive oil or others
1 colored jar or bottle
Muslin strain cloth
Rubber band or coated hair bands
Muslin cloth or un-dyed paper towel

How to make cold processed infused oil

1. place the dried herbs half way in the pint jar, should be around 2 cups of dried herbs
2. pour the olive oil over the dried herbs. The herbs will slightly float.
3. place the paper towel or muslin cloth over the jar secure with the rubber band
4. place in the window seal for 2 weeks
5. stir everyday
6. strain the oil
7. add 2 cups of dried herbs again
8. cover and secure
9. place in window seal for 2 more weeks
10. strain, place in colored jar or bottle

Now you can shorten the time of the oil being placed into the window seal. I use this to get the best results and the highest potency. Once the oil has cured you can use this in salves, and ointments, and so on.

Decoctions

Making decoctions is similar to a water infusion but instead of using fragile herbs or flowers you use roots, and hardier herbs like dandelion root, burdock and so on.

You will need;

1 ounce of herb/root

1 pint of RO water

Small cooking pan

Muslin cloth to strain

Rubber band

How to make your own decoction:

1. First measure out 1 ounce of herb/roots using our kitchen scale.
2. Place the herb/roots in a small pan. Add 1 pint of water.
3. Cover and bring the water to a boil.
4. Turn down the heat, leave covered, and simmer until the liquid is reduced by 1/2. This usually takes 20-30 minutes.
5. Strain and your decoction is ready to use. You can drink it warm, at room temperature, or chilled. You can also add a decoction to a bath or use it to make a compress.

Shelf life;

Decoctions have a relatively short shelf life. They can last as long as a week in the refrigerator.

Syrups

A syrup is an herbal preparation made by adding honey (or other sweetener) to an herbal decoction or infusion.

You will need:

1 - 4oz. dried herb or 1 cup of fresh berries or frozen

2 cups water

1 cup honey

A small saucepan

Fine mesh strainer

How to make syrup:

1. First put 1/2 cup of dried herbs into the saucepan, add 2 cups of water.
2. Cover and bring the water to a boil.
3. Turn down the heat, leave covered, and simmer until the liquid is reduced by 1/2. This usually takes 20-30 minutes.
4. Strain into a bowl and add 1 cup of honey.

How to store your syrup:

Store the syrup in a closed jar in the refrigerator. Syrups have a relatively short shelf life.

Vinegars

Herbal vinegars are made by infusing herbs in vinegar for 6 weeks. We can then use these vinegars in our cooking to add these vitamins and minerals to our diet.

You will need;

1 pint glass jar

Enough dried herbs to place ¼ of the way in the pint jar

1 pint of organic apple cider vinegar

How to make herbal vinegars:

- Fill the pint jar 1/4 full with dried herb.
- Warm one pint of balsamic vinegar (not to the point of boiling) or apple cider vinegar. Pour the warm vinegar over the herb to fill the jar. Stir to get rid of any air bubbles.
- Fill the other one pint jar 1/4 full with dried burdock root.
- Cap your jars with an un-dyed paper towel between the metal lid and the jar so that the vinegar won't corrode the metal.
- Label your jars.
- Stir or shake the jar every day for one week.
- Let sit for 5 more weeks. (6 weeks total)
- Strain through cheesecloth, squeezing the herbs to extract as much liquid as possible.
- Store in glass jars or bottles with plastic caps. Label your vinegar.

How to store your vinegars:

Store the vinegars in glass jars with plastic lids or use a muslin cloth in between the metal rings. Vinegars will last this way for about 1 year.

How to make this remedy with fresh herbs:

We generally make vinegars using fresh plant material. To do this would simply chop up your fresh herbs and loosely pack a jar.

Pour room temperature vinegar over the herbs to fill the jar, and follow the rest of the directions for making the vinegars.

Liniments

A liniment is an herbal preparation made by infusing herbs in rubbing or grain alcohol. The liniment will be applied to the skin and the alcohol will evaporate rapidly allowing the herbs to penetrate quickly.

You will need:

1 pint of rubbing alcohol or 1 pint witch hazel
1 pint glass jar
Muslin cloth for straining
Rubber band
1 ounce herbs (You can make liniments using whole, cut, powdered, fresh, or dried herbs. As a general rule you want to include 4 oz. of dried herbs or 8 oz. of fresh herbs to 1 pint of alcohol.)

How to make liniments;

1. Weigh out the appropriate amount of each herb and put them into a pint jar.
2. Pour rubbing alcohol OR grain alcohol (preferred) over the herbs to fill the jar.
3. Stir to release any bubbles, and put a lid on the jar.
4. LABEL the jar.
5. Stir or shake once each day for two weeks.
6. Strain through cheesecloth, squeezing the herbs to extract as much liquid as possible.
7. Pour into the new jar through a coffee filter to get out any extra particulates.
8. LABEL the jar you are storing the liniment in.

How to store your liniments:

Store the liniment in a spray bottle or small jar in your medicine cabinet. Be sure to label the jar with the words: "For topical use only." Rubbing alcohol is toxic if swallowed.

Tinctures

Tinctures are made by infusing herbs in alcohol. The alcohol will extract many of the medicinal constituents of the herbs using 100 proof vodka is 50 percent alcohol and 50 percent water.

You will need:

1 pint glass jar
Enough herbs to fill the pint jar ½ the way up
1 pint of vodka (also apple cider vinegar can be used)
16 oz glass jar
Muslin cloth for straining
Rubber band

How to make a tincture;

1. Fill your half pint jar half full with dried herb
2. Pour enough of your 100 proof vodka over the roots to fill the jar up to the point where the lid rings start.
3. Stir well to release any air bubbles and top off with vodka
4. Cap your jar with a metal canning or other lid.
5. Label your jar 100 proof vodka and the date
6. Stir or shake your tincture every day for a week.
7. Allow your tincture to infuse for 5 more weeks (six weeks total).
8. Strain your tincture through cheesecloth or muslin cloth, squeezing as much alcohol as possible.

How to store your tincture:

Store your finished tincture in a labeled tincture bottle for easy use. These tinctures will last for several years stored in this way.

Steams

Steams are used not only for stuffy noses but for beauty treatments as well. A steam is placing an herbal tea in a bowl, placing your face near the steaming tea, placing a towel over the head, and inhaling the steam.

You will need;

Herbal tea

Bowl

Large towel

How to make a steam;

1. you can make an herbal tea and place it in a bowl
2. set down place your face over the bowl of steam
3. place the towel over your head
4. breathe deep but normal

Salves

Salves are great for the skin for wounds, cuts, scraps, and burns.

You will need;

1 oz beeswax

1 cup of olive oil or herbal infused oil

Double boiler

Prepared containers with lids

How to make a salve;

1. place the beeswax in a double boiler, allow to melt
2. add the herbal infused oil or olive oil into the wax, allow to mix
3. add essential oils if want, 50 drops = 1 tsp
4. pour into containers with lids

Lip Balm

Lip balms are an all time favorite. To make a lip balm follow the same recipe for salve making but instead you need to add more beeswax instead of 1 oz you need about 2 oz. then follow the recipe.

Poultice/Compress/Fomentation/Wash

Poultice or compress can be very useful for spider bites, aches, and pains. A cabbage leaf can be used in replace of the muslin cloth to aid in nurturing the skin.

A compress is made by soaking a cloth in an herbal tea for 5 to 10 minutes, wringing the cloth out and then laying it on the affected area.

A fomentation is a compress applied to the body and kept warm.

A poultice is mashed plant material applied directly to the body on the affected area or wrapped in thin cloth or cabbage leaf and then applied.

A wash is simply an herbal tea splashed on an affected area of the body.

HEALING HERBS

Introduction

There are so many plants that can be used in healing. I call all plants herbs for I believe that all plants hold somewhat of a medicinal property even though we may have not found the component yet in a particular plant. In this lesson we will be discussing and researching Healing Herbs. Healing herbs are those that have healing properties. We will be discussing children's, women's and men's aliments along with the herb as a suggested remedy.

Remember this if or educational purposes only. This lesson is not meant to treat, prescribe, or diagnose any medical condition. Always discuss any herbal remedy with you licensed physician.

Remember to follow all safety guideline and study each herb before using in any remedy. Know what you are using and know the warnings of each herb.

Please see the chart in the CANVAS Classroom.

HERBS FOR CHILDREN

Herbal remedies can be used for children as long as the safety guidelines the dosage amounts are followed strictly and watching the child during the remedy for any side effects is very important. Children can not always tell us if something is hurting or bothering them so we must keep a close watch on the children's physical, emotional, and behavior reactions during the use of a home remedy. If your child experiences any reaction at all using an herbal remedy then it is recommended to stop using that herb or remedy. However, in some cases like a laxative for constipation causing diarrhea then you need to adjust the dose to less. You may also want to consider purchasing herb remedies or supplements specialized in the dosage for children.

- Herbal Dosage Suggestions for Children

- Infant to Two Years: For the newborn or children up to two years of age, the usual recommended dosage of herbal medication is equivalent to three drops of tincture thinned in one-fourth cup of water, formula, breast milk or two to three teaspoons of tea. Additionally, a woman who is breast-feeding may also use an adult dosage of the suitable herbal therapy. When she does so, the herbs will pass on to the breast milk and thereby to her baby.
- Two to Six Years: For children between the age of two and six years, the usual recommended dose of herbal medication is equivalent to six to ten drops of tincture thinned in one-fourth cup of water or the same amount of tea.
- Six to Twelve Years: The usual recommended dosage of herbal medications for children between six and 12 years of age is equivalent to 10 to 20 drops of tincture, half a cup of tea or one tablet or capsule.

HERBS FOR CHILDREN

- Twelve Years to Adults: The usual recommended dosage of herbal preparations for people above 12 years of age is equivalent to 20 to 40 drops of tincture, one cup of tea or two tablets or capsules.

- Baths prepared with herbs

In some cases an herbal bath is a great way to give an herbal remedy to a child. As of a matter of fact there are commercial baby product companies that are now adding fragrance oils to their products to promote being more herbal, however, a home made remedy is purer then most of the mass produced products. Not all products that are labeled organic, herbal or green are actually all of those things.
Some herbalist will use baking soda in the herbal bath preparation; however, by experience baking soda is not a good source of an organic agent. It can actually cause inflammation and blood pressure to increase. Instead using sea salt works best for a bath. A lot of the commercial bath powders contain baking soda or corn starch. I do not recommend using those. I good bath for a child is grounded up oatmeal, and or sea salt. Adding dried herbs into the mix can relieve many symptoms of discomfort, sickness, or sleeplessness. A good oil such as olive oil or jojoba oil mixed in works for drying of the skin after taking a warm bath.
If you do not prefer to directly place the herbs into the bath water, since children can drink the water it is a good idea to place them in a muslin tea bag or sachet. You can even hang them over the faucet to make an herbal tea bath by allowing the water to run over the sachet or bag. However, you do need to squeeze the bag out lightly to drain the tea. You can also use a 100% white cotton sock to hold the herbs in as well to tie to the faucet. Of course you can purchase the muslin refill bags and or sachets.

- Infusions (teas) prepared with herbs

Herbal Tea: You need to use 1 tsp of herb for each cup of hot herbal tea you make unless the label of the packet containing the herb instructs otherwise.
Never use plastic or metal containers for soaking herbs in hot water as they may result in a chemical interaction with the herb. It is recommended by experience to always steep the herbs in any glass or ceramic cup or teapot or a commercial coffee pot.
There are several methods of tea preparation as you have learned earlier. To prepare one cup of herbal tea, pour eight ounces of boiled water on the herbs and cover the container immediately with a paper towel or muslin cloth, add honey or stevia, then allow to cool. You may also prepare an herbal tea with non-alcoholic tincture or extract of the herb. In this case, put the recommended number of drops for a child dosage of the herbal extract into a cup of hot water. Allow the blend to rest for around five minutes. I do not recommend giving alcoholic tinctures to children, syrups, and teas are suggested.

HERBS FOR CHILDREN

- Herbal juices (Extracted from fresh herbs) and oils
-
- To prepare a fresh herbal juice like aloe or plantain you need wash the herb in cold water. Once air dried cut them into sizeable pieces with scissors. You can then place them in a juicer or small chopper. Conditions like burns, insect bites can benefit from the fresh juice. You can add a little RO water or bottles water to the mix, storing in an airtight container in the refrigerator for just a few days.
-
- You can also make fresh herbal oil. I love making these oils for travel. I place my fresh herbs that have been cut into olive oil, place an un-dyed paper towel or muslin cloth over and secure with a rubber band, sit in the sunlight for 1 week, then sprain, and place in colored bottle for use.

HERBS FOR WOMEN

There are so many kinds of medical problems that can off balance a women's body; menstruation cycle, conception, fertility, and so on. It is impossible to list all of the ailments and symptoms that I women faces everyday. In this lesson we are going to discuss just a few of the herbal remedies.
Throughout history there have been many plants in history to aid in treating the illness of women some are wormwood, mugwort, vulgaris, rose, dandelion, motherwort, and so on.

Menopause

Menopause can be very difficult for women with feelings of grief, hot flashes, mood changes, depression, headaches, irregular menstrual periods, nervousness, mental anguish, and so on. It can be a very touchy subject for women. The family can suffer as well from the changes that can occur in menopause.
Menopause can influence the endocrine glands which control body temperature, circulation, digestion, bone structure, emotions, mood changes, water balance, and weight. A healthy diet, rest and exercise, relaxation, prayer and laughter will help to cope with change and to keep the hormones balanced.
There are several foods which can be ingested to help such as high rich foods that contain calcium like milk, almonds, sesame seeds, dark-green leafy vegetables like spinach and broccoli, turnip greens and kale. High amounts of calcium can also be found in the herbs; oats, nettle, dandelion, horsetail, chickweed, and watercress. Seaweeds are very high in calcium as well.
Along with foods that are high in calcium, it is recommended to add a calcium supplement to the diet as well. However, magnesium, potassium, and fiber are needed and vitamin D to help the body absorb the calcium.

HERBS FOR WOMEN

- Supplements and Herbs
    - Calcium/magnesium: Very important in helping to prevent osteoporosis, which can begin with menopause when estrogen levels drop.
    - Potassium: Can easily be lost in sweats and hot flashes. Important for calcium assimilation.
    - Selenium: Involved in maintaining hormonal balance in the body.
    - Vitamin C: Also recommended for hot flashes and is easily lost through perspiration.
    - Vitamin E: Can help control hot flashes, increase the production of hormones, and combat vaginal dryness.
    - Lecithin: Acts as an emulsifier and can help in assimilating vitamin E.
    - Vitamin B complex: Helps with water retention and is good for emotional or mental disturbances. Vitamin B5 and B6 injections have been known to reduce hot flashes and minimize nervous disorders.
    - Acidophilus: Can help combat virginities and cystitis. Some postmenopausal women are more susceptible to bladder infections.
    - Motherwort: A uterine stimulant which also helps with heart palpitations and feelings of anxiety.
    - Black cohosh: Helps to stimulate natural estrogen production and is also a nervine tonic.
    - Ginseng: Helps with depression and in the production of estrogen.
    - Nutri-calm by Herbal Blessings-nervous system
    - Licorice: Can help to stimulate estrogen production.
- Sarsaparilla: Contains progesterone and cortin to help achieve glandular balance.

Recipes

HIGH-CALCIUM CANDY

- 1 cup sesame butter,
- 1/2 to 1 cup honey,
- Powdered milk (enough to thicken the candy),
- 1/4 cup ground or chopped almonds,
- 1/4 cup ground apricots,
- 2-4 tablespoons powdered calcium,
- 1/4 cup toasted sesame seeds and/or coconut flakes.

Mix honey and sesame butter together. Add remainder of ingredients. Adjust flavors. Thicken with powdered milk to form into balls. Roll in toasted sesame seeds or coconut flakes.

HIGH-CALCIUM SHAKE

- 2 cups fresh orange juice and/or pineapple juice,
- 1/2 cup yogurt,
- 1 frozen banana,
- 2-4 tablespoons calcium powder,
- 2 tablespoons sesame seeds,
- 1 teaspoon bee pollen,
- 1/2 teaspoon spirulina,

Place all ingredients in blender and blend on high speed until creamy. A frozen banana gives the shake a nice creamy consistency.

HERBS FOR WOMEN

MENOPAUSE TEA

- Lady's mantle
- Hop cones
- Sage leaves
- Melissa leaves
- Walnut leaves
- 1 cup water

- Make a tea or infusion. 1 tsp of herbs to 8 oz cup of RO water. The suggested dosage is to use the tea is over a 6- to 8-week period, with 2 cups (500 ml) of the tea being consumed over the course of each day. The tea therapy should then be stopped for at least 1 week. It can be resumed if needed.

Hot Flashes and Night Sweats

- Hot flashes can be mild to severe for some women; even pregnant women can suffer from hot flashes. Night sweats can also be an occasional discomfort. Try to avoid stress, sudden changes in temperature, over crowded areas, and stuffy rooms. The relaxed and calm that you remain while experiencing a hot flash the lighter the symptoms may become. Night sweats can be lessened by wearing thin layers of clothing to bed and have adequate ventilation in the room.

Supplements and Herbs

- Make sure to drink plenty of RO water. Vitamin E and selenium to control the hot flashed. (Avoid vitamin E if you suffer from high blood pressure, diabetes or heart disease; seek your practitioner's approval first.) The diet should consist of vitamin C, bioflavonoids, and calcium of course you need magnesium, potassium, fiber, and vitamin D along with Vitamin B complex to help absorb the supplements.

Recipes

- Remember follow the safety guidelines before using an herbal remedy, know what you are using!

TEA FOR HOT FLASHES

- 2 parts sage,
- 2 parts blessed thistle,
- 1 part blue vervain,
- 1/2 part rosemary,
- 2 parts motherwort ,
- 1/4 part ginseng.

Mix herbs together. Add one teaspoon per cup of water that has been boiled. Let steep, covered, for thirty minutes. Strain and drink in small amounts as needed throughout the day-one-fourth cup every hour, for example. NOT FOR PREGNANT WOMEN!

HERBS FOR WOMEN

Depression and Mood Changes

- Depression, moodiness, sadness, irritability, anxiety, and panic attacks can afflict many women going through menopause. Some women even experience severe manic depression, suicide tendencies, and much more. A good prayer life, diet change, pH balance, exercise, and herbal supplements can help.

Supplements and Herbs

- Vitamin B complex, Vitamins C and E, as well as calcium, magnesium Vitamin D, and fiber can help along with Evening Primrose oil; St. John's Wort, Nutri-calm, chamomile, lemon balm, rosemary, wild oats, borage, skullcap, motherwort, lavender, passionflower, valerian, rose, geranium, bergamot, Melissa, and vervain can all help with the sudden mood changes.
- Vaginal Dryness and Irritation
- One pesky symptom to menopause is vaginal dryness or even after having a hysterectomy. Estrogen when present has a mucus secretion that forms in the vagina to keep it moist and the walls thick, so therefore if there is no estrogen the walls become thin and dry sometimes even bleed or crack.

Supplements and Herbs

- Washing the area with vegetable glycerin soap can help with the tenderness, and cracking. Vitamin E oil, Calendula cream or oil, comfrey ointment outside areas only can help with healing. For hormone support; false unicorn root, sage, blue cohosh, calendula, hops, and motherwort. Vitamins B, C, and E and of course Evening primrose oil can be taken as suggested supplements.
- Even essential or herbal oils can be used in massage such as rose, jasmine, geranium, lavender, clary sage, and many more.
- Osteoporosis
- Osteoporosis is a bone mineral disorder affecting the density of bones. Women suffer from osteoporosis more then men do to hormonal reasons. If the minerals are depleted the bones become brittle, and porous. Not only does menopause, hysterectomy, play a role in osteoporosis but so do prescription drugs like blood thinners, anti-convulsion drugs, and thyroid drugs. These drugs deplete the body of calcium.

Supplements and Herbs

- Calcium, magnesium, potassium, Vitamins D and E, phosphorus, silicon, boron, copper, sulfur, manganese, and Zinc all play a role in the prevention of osteoporosis. Supplements of seaweed, kelp, folic acid, alfalfa, feverfew, horsetail, and oats can be very beneficial.

HERBS FOR MEN

Just like women male hormones play a great role in the physical condition of men. Testosterone the male hormone builds muscles, intensifies men voices, and of course for fertility. If the hormone levels are unbalanced then so will the rest of the male body including the glandular system, just like in the female body, can cause trouble with digestion, nervousness, and so on.

Hair loss and baldness

Hair loss is considered to come with age but in the majority of the cases hormones play a great role in the production and keeping of the hair. Hormones can cause the hair roots to shut down if there isn't enough or to much of the hormone so hair loss occurs. So it is advisable to use herbs to nourish the hair and scalp. Most of the commercial products that claim to restore the hair only put chemicals into the scalp that may even harm hair growth in the long turn. Herbs such as aloe vera, rosemary, nettle, olive oil.

In fact, the male steroid hormone testosterone aided by specific genetic factors cause the hair roots to close down. And in such situations, herbs are extremely beneficial as they help in retarding the hair loss process. Hence, it is advisable to use herbs to nourish the hair and scalp. Even women can have male pattern baldness as well. Face it there is no miracle hair restorer that is going to work over night. Special acupressure and massage techniques specialty designed to penetrate blood circulation to the hair roots can also be very beneficial.
Please remember that any hair products need to be tested before use. Certain herbs can lighten or darken different hair pigments. Remember to test a patch of unseen hair before trying any suggested recipe.

Rosemary hair oil

- 1/2 ounce jojoba oil
- 1/2 teaspoon rosemary essential oil

Mix the ingredients together and put a small amount of the formula on the tips of your fingers. Using a circular motion, rub the hair oil into your scalp. Put the oil into your hair twice weekly and leave it in for at least a few hours, then wash it out. It makes your hair greasy, but it is worth it.

Hair formula

- 1 cup aloe vera gel
- 1 tablespoon nettle tincture
- 4 tablespoons apple cider vinegar
- 1/2 teaspoon rosemary essential oil
- 1/2 teaspoon vitamin E oil
- ½ tsp jojoba oil

If you can't find any nettle tincture, simply make it without the nettle. Blend the ingredients until they have a smooth texture. Take a small amount of your formula and rub into your scalp when you wash yourself every day in a circular motion.

HERBS FOR MEN

Herbal remedies for genital rash, infections, and irritations
Herbal genital soak

- 2 cups boiling water
- 1 teaspoon lavender flowers
- 1 teaspoon yarrow flowers

Empty a pot of boiling water over the herbs and let them steep. After about 20 minutes, strain out the herbs and let them cool off to room temperature. Fill up a large glass with the formula and soak the affected area twice daily for about 5 minutes.

Oil for genital infection/irritation

- 1/8 teaspoon tea tree essential oil
- 1/8 teaspoon lavender essential oil
- 1 ounce vegetable oil

Gather the ingredients needed and combine them together. Apply this formula to the affected area twice daily.

FIRST AID HERBS

Herbs have been used in First Aide ever since I can remember. If I got stung by a sweat bee or bit by a mosquito while in the garden harvesting my dad would grab some plantain by crushing the leaves with his fingers then he would smear it and rub it all over the area. The plantain took away the skin and or the bite. My skin was a little green but it worked.
There are so many remedies that my dad, grandparents, and great grandparents knew but as a child you miss those things until you get older and then realize how important it was to pay attention. If I only had documentation of all of those remedies, that's why it is important to pay attention to older people, but also for them to write it down somewhere for the future generations.
In First Aid it is always a good idea to have these items stored up ready to use just in case of an emergency for you see emergencies occur faster then you have time to prepare some herbal remedies.
I like to use melted beeswax cooled to cover over a small wound to protect the skin from water and bacteria. I also like to use sage, basil, and thyme for anti-venom remedy of spider bites in a poultice. When you are pregnant and have got bitten you have to act fast. Believe me I have got bitten during both of my pregnancies at work no doubt where there were no herbs to use. So if you work out of the home carry a small First Aid Remedy kit with you in your car, office, or locker. Least to say I ended up at the emergency room where I had to wait 1 hour before seeing anyone good thing it wasn't a poisonous spider! When I got home the poultice was applied and within 1 hour the area was cured. The spider was a Crab Vegetation Spider, it bit hard, and left a whole to remember him/her by. If you ever get bit by a spider, keep the spider in between clear tape to look the spider's name and species up, that is if you did what I did, stomped it.
Herbs are very universal when it comes to their uses, and properties. Ex. Sage works great as a mosquito deterrent but it also works as an antiseptic-reducing or preventing infection. With sage I could make an antiseptic spray, salve, cream, oil, candle and much more. If you wanted to make a First Aid salve for inflamed skin, first you would look to see what herbs are used for anti-inflammatory and healing. I like to use chamomile, or carrot oil, or aloe, or calendula, sometimes I blend them together in beeswax. Petroleum jelly can be used but you have to remember it is not an all natural substance. I like to use even liquid glycerin if I want to make an antiseptic soap for first aid remedies.

HERBS FOR THE HOME

Using herbs for the home has been around for centuries using lemons, vinegar, basil, and more to clean, protect, and enlighten their homes. In today's world manufacturers are trying to make their cleaning supplies using herbs or adding herbs to their recipes. Even the gas industry is building a plant here in Richmond, KY to make fuel using corn cobs. It becomes cheaper than adding all of the dangerous chemicals.

I have heard too many stories of children dying or becoming disabled due to swallowing a cleaning product. This scares me since I am a mother of 2 small children. So I have committed myself into making herbal recipes for the home for cleaning, enlightening, and protecting. Although, I have made recipes for years for the home to give away.

Herbs in the Kitchen (there will be a separate class on this?

The tradition of using herbs to flavor foods is nothing new. It is, in fact, almost as old as the human species itself. Archaeologists have found evidence which suggests that the earliest cooks used parts of certain plants to season and improve the flavor of particular foods. Mustard seed was chewed with meat, it seems, and the seeds of wild wheat and barley were sprinkled on other foods to add a nutty taste.

These herbs would, of course, have been found growing wild, and the cultivation of herbs for culinary and medicinal use came much later. In grand old gardens, a special section would be set aside for the growing of herbs, while in humbler plots herbs might be grown among other food plants. This delightful tradition is well worth continuing: what could be more satisfying than being able to pick fresh herbs from your own garden to add to the dishes for a summer lunch, or the evening meal? The aroma alone as you pick the herbs is the perfect appetizer.

The range of herbs, even for culinary purposes, is huge; and few of us nowadays will have either the space, time or inclination to grow all the varieties found in the traditional herb garden. Nevertheless, a small bed of the more common herbs - or just a selection of pots by the kitchen door, on a balcony or window sill will give your cooking a fresh and distinctive flavor.

HERBS FOR BEAUTY

There are hundreds of herbs and plants to use in skin care, hair care, facial herbs, and so on. This is my favorite use of herbs. I love making items and giving them away. You can not only make a wonderful recipe for someone with their favorite scent but the outward appearance can be just as beautiful. I have printed special colorful labels, printed gift bags, cello bags for the product wrapped in a ribbon of corn husks. (Yes you can make ribbon out of corn husks)

Herbs have been used cosmetically for years. The Egyptians' perfumed their hair with marjoram oil, and lavender. Roman soldiers would use herbs to heal their battle wounds and for insect repellants. Many of their spiritual ceremonies herbs were used as incense, even in death rituals herbs were used to prepare the body.

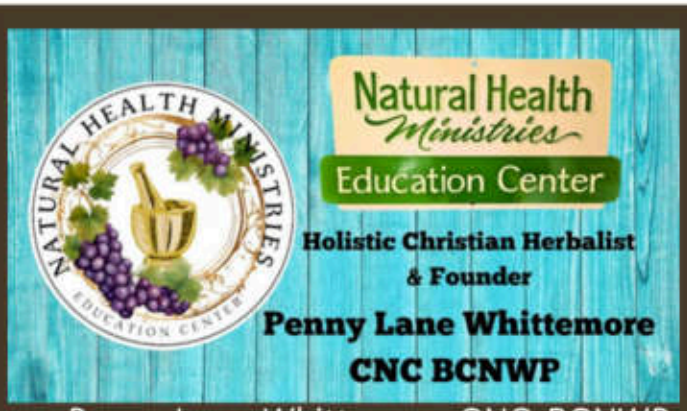
Even in Bible times Mary anointed Jesus' feet with spikenard which back then was lavender oil, to prepare his body for burial. Lavender was found largely on the shores of the Nile River.

People use herbs cosmetically for their beauty and for their herb aroma that produces a sense of well being, and a healthy atmosphere. Aromatherapy-is the art of using oils from herbs to heal by using their aroma. The first aromatherapy was created when a scientist burned his hand while creating an herbal remedy. He looked to find a container of water to submerge his hand into, he found lavender oil. Beauty herbs in cosmetics also take the place of using whale and dolphin skin, and fat that is found in most cosmetics these days now including shark bone.

Herbs have been used as beauty aids throughout recorded history. Ancient Egyptians employed plant extracts to outline their eyes, to redden their lips and cheeks, and to anoint and perfume their bodies. Romans applied herbal face packs and soaked in flower-scented baths. The basic recipe for cold cream dates to the Greek physician Galen in the second century A.D. Indeed, until mass-produced cosmetics became widespread in this century, most beauty products were concocted at home from herbs and other natural ingredients. The art of making beauty preparations in the kitchen is far from dead. Many people still prefer to make their own, both to save money and to have the assurance that the ingredients they are using are natural and pure. The chief advantage of making beauty preparations yourself, however, is that you can experiment with ingredients to find the combinations that work best on your skin and hair or to find the fragrances that are most agreeable to you.







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NATURAL HEALTH MINISTRIES

Module 3



THE HERBALIST'S PATH:

A COMPLETE GUIDE TO MASTERING HERBAL KNOWLEDGE

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